

# The Boston Globe

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MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 21, 2026

## Minogue’s pledge stirs self-interest concerns

Candidate vows to allow flavored pouches of nicotine as he holds stock of key firm

By Chris Van Buskirk  
GLOBE STAFF

Michael Minogue, the Republican nominee for Massachusetts governor, has built a somewhat quixotic plank into his campaign: Legalize the sale of flavored nicotine pouches — and in particular one brand, ZYN.

He posted a video on social media pledging to “deregulate the sale of ZYNs.” His campaign sells a T-shirt emblazoned with an image that resembles a can of ZYN, but adorned with political slogans. Massachusetts banned the sale of flavored tobacco products more than

six years ago, but Minogue says he “will allow” the flavored nicotine pouches to return.

“It’s more freedom for you,” Minogue says in his video.

But what Minogue doesn’t mention is that he could benefit financially if the flavored nicotine products ZYN sells are allowed to return to Massachusetts store shelves.

A financial disclosure Minogue filed with state regulators shows he,

either directly or through a business, owns stock in some of the industry’s biggest tobacco companies, including Philip Morris International, which through a subsidiary owns ZYN.

Minogue is a former medical device industry executive who made a fortune when Abiomed, the Danvers-based company he ran, was sold in 2022. He reported holding a

**MINOGUE, Page A7**

## T’s fixes on access will need fixing

Agency, disabled riders want changes now before new Green Line cars

By Diti Kohli  
GLOBE STAFF

In the next five years, the MBTA expects to make all but two stations along the Green Line ADA-accessible as part of a radical and costly transformation of the oldest branch of the system.

After all that work is done, though, the agency will face another reality: It will have to redo a lot of it.

The upcoming arrival of new Green Line trolleys is putting the T in a sticky position. It’s already investing hundreds of millions to expand or add platforms on the B, C, and E branches, but those platforms won’t be tall enough to allow riders with disabilities to board, without help, the more than 100 incoming “supercars” — the first of which will officially hit the tracks next year.

Eventually, Green Line riders will have to live through an additional bout of construction and shutdowns as the T reworks the platforms to make their height compatible with the so-called Type 10 cars.

It’ll require another pool of public money, and riders with disabilities who can board Green Line trains independently at some stations this year may later again need drivers’ assistance getting on and off with powered ramps, until the T can lift its platforms another 6 inches to align with

**ACCESS, Page A10**

## OF FLOWERS, SNOWFLAKES, AND SUGAR PLUM FAIRIES



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Kendall Jean danced with other 6- and 7-year olds auditioning Saturday for The Jose Mateo Ballet Theatre’s “Nutcracker” production at the Mateo studio in Cambridge. Dozens of children from different age groups skipped, and pirouetted, and danced. The first show at the Strand Theatre in Dorchester is Dec. 5. **B1.**

## A makeshift course of action by bicyclists

Duct-tape lane signals frustration

By Bryan Hecht  
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The death this summer of a prominent cycling advocate and city worker, who was hit by a recycling truck as she rode her bicycle on a busy road in Mission Hill, sparked a public outcry over persistent safety issues and delayed street improvement efforts.

Late last month, it appears someone took matters into their own hands, an act of practical resistance that symbolized the cycling community’s frustration.

At the intersection of Tremont and Parker streets, duct tape was used to create a makeshift bike lane near the spot where Louisa Gag, 36, was fatally struck, filling a gap between two existing bike lanes, which are both unprotected.

In an anonymous note posted to a nearby pole, the protesters who created the lane said it was meant as a practical response to improve biker safety and to raise awareness about stalled infrastructure improvements under Mayor Michelle Wu.

But after a man riding an electric scooter was struck by a

**BIKES, Page A10**

## Call it gritty and a bit ugly. Call it, also, a victory.

Patriots take home opener but offense was, again, lost

CHRISTOPHER L. GASPER

FOXBOROUGH — The Patriots’ home opener served as yet another reminder that the pixie dust that dotted last season’s run to the Super Bowl is gone, swept up into the dustbin of the past. It’s a new season and a new struggle for New England’s favorite football sons — emphasis on the struggle.

On a dishwater-gray Sunday at Gillette Stadium, they scored their first win of the 2026 season in a fashion more gritty than pretty. The Patriots upended the Pittsburgh Steelers, 20-3, evening their record at 1-1. No one was going to ruin coach Mike Vrabel’s day with caveats and concerns. He stiff-armed a postgame question in that vein.

But the triumph, their first home-opener win

since 2020, failed to provide the requisite reassurance about quarterback Drake Maye and an offense that has failed to launch so far. The Patriots only scored 13 points offensively after managing a meager 10 in their meltdown season-opening loss to the Seahawks.

Their New Year’s Day wasn’t Jan. 1. It was Sept. 9 in Seattle. Young Maye and the Patriots are learning that success in the NFL isn’t static, despite how elementary their Foxborough forebears, led by Tom Brady and Bill Belichick, made it look. It must be re-engineered and re-earned every season. These aren’t feel-good NFL up-and-comers any longer. They’re a team with high expectations and a target on their collective back.

“Yeah, it is tough in this league. It is tough. We

**PATRIOTS, Page C6**



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

For the Patriots, defense was the name of the game Sunday in Foxborough. Safety Kevin Byard and linebacker Robert Spillane did their part, putting the squeeze on Steelers running back Jaylen Warren in the fourth quarter.



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Patrick Clancy testified during the murder trial of his ex-wife, Lindsay Clancy, at Plymouth Superior Court on July 29.

## Clancy talks of forgiveness, grief, starting new family

Subject of ‘60 Minutes’ interview with his wife

By Nick Stoico  
GLOBE STAFF

Patrick Clancy and his wife, Rachel Danis, are starting a family, he revealed in an interview with “60 Minutes” on Sunday, as they spoke publicly together for the first time about rebuilding his life after the deaths of his three children.

In the interview, Clancy said he looks forward to telling his future child about Cora, Dawson, and Callan, who were killed by his former wife, Lindsay Clancy, in their Duxbury home in January, 2023.

“I think every parent can agree, you have different relationships with your kids, but they’re all your kids, and I can’t wait to tell them about their brothers and sister,” he said.

When asked if Lindsay Clancy had asked for his forgiveness, he said she hadn’t.

“But I gave it to her,” he said.

The comments came during Clancy’s first interview since Lindsay Clancy’s murder trial ended

**CLANCY, Page A7**

## A fade, then fall

**Monday:** Showers early, cloudy. High 63-68, low 53-58.

**Tuesday:** Sun returns, cool. High 59-65, low 52-57.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **B6.**

VOL. 310, NO. 83

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Suggested retail price  
\$4.00



**The Trump administration reportedly seeks to create a panel that has the power to veto biomedical research grants** that do not conform to its political agenda. **A4.**

**Private health insurers covered 112,000 fewer Massachusetts**

**residents’ GLP-1 weight-loss drugs** this year, according to a report. **D1.**

**President Trump said drones and snipers could be housed on** his proposed 250-foot arch of triumph in Washington, D.C. **A2.**

**Iranian-backed Houthi rebels intensified their battles with fighters aligned with Saudi Arabia** over territory in Yemen. **A3.**

**The Red Sox backed into the playoffs,** thanks to a loss by the Houston Astros. **C1.**



# The Nation

## Trump cites national security for arch

Project would house drones and snipers

By Zolan Kanno-Youngs

WASHINGTON — President Trump said on Sunday his planned 250-foot triumphal arch in Washington would be built to host “large numbers of drones,” snipers, and ammunition, as the administration appeared prepared to justify another construction project by citing national security.

Trump said the arch would be “a top grade Military Complex/Triumphal Arch, to house, store, and have the rapid ability to use large numbers of drones, plus Snipers, on both the roof and plaza areas, and additionally have and hold large quantities of sniper ammunition in storage.”

The proposal would appear to place an arsenal and military staging ground in the center of the nation’s capital.

“There will be no facility like this anywhere in the World,” Trump said in a social media post.

The administration has been rushing to clear the final hurdles to construct the arch in recent days, brushing aside concerns from architects, historians, and veterans who say it could disrupt the area between

the Lincoln Memorial and Arlington National Cemetery. Now, Trump appears prepared to return to a familiar playbook he has used to circumvent normal processes and defend some of his more contentious projects in court.

The White House did not immediately answer questions about the sudden need for a giant arch to host drones in a region with a high concentration of military bases and facilities. The Department of Defense declined to provide additional comment beyond Trump’s social media post.

After initially emphasizing that his ballroom was necessary mainly to host bigger crowds for social events at the White House, Trump shifted his argument as the \$400 million project faced legal scrutiny. He switched to arguing that the construction was a national security imperative because it included a major upgrade to the bunker beneath the now-demolished East Wing. That argument has appeared persuasive in the Supreme Court hearings over the project.

Trump has invoked national security concerns for a host of reasons since returning to office. He has cited it as the reason for deploying the military to the US-Mexico border, stripping union rights from thousands of federal workers, pausing the construction of wind farms off



ANDREW CABALLERO-REYNOLDS/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

President Trump held a model of the arch he has proposed be built in Washington during a fund-raising dinner at the White House last year.

the East Coast, and exempting oil and gas drilling in the Gulf of Mexico from protections for endangered species of whales.

Even before he said the arch would be turned into a drone-dispatching sniper station, the project had faced scrutiny. When a panel stacked with Trump allies earlier this year gave preliminary approval to the project, it also suggested significant changes to the construction plans.

And the Federal Aviation Administration released a hazard study this past week requesting the arch have a constant flame atop the structure to make it safe for planes to pass by in one of the busiest airspaces in the country. The arch would sit along a flight path less than a mile from Ronald Reagan National Airport.

Nicolas Sansone, an attorney with the Public Citizen Litigation Group, which is represent-

ing a group of Vietnam War veterans who have sued to stop construction, said Trump was “trying to paper over a patently unlawful project by giving it a veneer of national security justification.”

The project, he said, continues to be illegal “with or without this concocted justification.” Sansone added: “It simply has no legal foundation whatsoever unless and until Congress passes a law saying he can build it.”

## Rise of AI heightens threats of drones

Think tank warns of potential chaos

By Hurubie Meko and Maria Cramer

NEW YORK TIMES

The confluence of rapidly advancing artificial intelligence technology and cheaper and deadlier drones pose an increasing threat to cities and towns across the United States, according to a report from the Police Executive Research Forum, a Washington-based think tank.

The report, titled “A Clear and Present Danger,” is not the first time the group has warned about the growing threat from drones. While there have been no publicly reported major attacks by drones within the United States, the easier access to cheaper drones has dramatically increased the technology’s “potential to inflict chaos and carnage,” the report states, particularly if they were to be used with AI.

Most drones used in the United States are for commercial and civilian use, and fall under federal jurisdiction. Law enforcement should treat the dangers of the technology with the same urgency that federal investigators should have treated terrorism threats that led to the Sept. 11 attacks, the report states.

According to data collected by the group, unauthorized drones are flying into football stadiums on game days, highlighting how serious of a public safety issue this has become. In New York City, about 23,000 illegal drone flights are reported monthly, the report said. And during the World Cup this summer, hundreds of drones were seized this summer near World Cup games across the United States.

“Twenty-five years ago, our nation paid a terrible price for a failure of imagination,” Chuck Wexler, the executive director of the group, wrote in the report. “We cannot afford to make the same mistake again.”

Anxiety about artificial intelligence and its potential risks — to the environment and to safety — have reached a flashpoint in the nation. The growing use of drones in wars across the world and rising use of AI technology, has brought the issue of autonomous weapons back to the forefront.

Earlier this year, Ukrainian officials said a Russian drone was guided by AI when it killed three people after crashing into a wall and exploding. Ukrainian officials have said that Russia was testing self-targeting AI systems. In the war in Iran, the US military modeled and deployed low-cost drones to respond to Iran’s own arsenal of drones, called the Shahed drones.

In June, federal officials said they foiled a plot to attack the Ultimate Fighting Championship matches that took place on the White House lawn. According to charging documents, the plot involved explosive-laden drones and rifles.

Jessica Tisch, the commissioner of the New York Police Department, has spoken about the proliferation of drones, which were once limited to the military but are now in the hands of more individuals.

“If there is one threat that keeps me up at night, it is from drones,” Tisch said during a news conference in May as the city was preparing for the World Cup. “Commercial drones can be easily adapted into weapons of war. That reality matters in New York City.”

Last month, during the US Open, Tisch announced that the New York Police Department now had federal approval to bring down unauthorized drones during major events in the city.

That authority was granted under the Safer Skies Act, which Congress passed in December, giving local governments permission to disable and take down drones that are a threat to public safety.

### DAILY BRIEFING

## Tropical Storm Fay forms far out in Atlantic

MIAMI — A new tropical storm formed Sunday in the northern Atlantic Ocean but does not appear to pose a threat to land.

Tropical Storm Fay had maximum sustained winds of 65 miles per hour and was located late Sunday about 405 miles southwest of the Azores. There are no coastal watches or warnings in effect, according to the National Hurricane Center in Miami. Fay will likely dissipate by the end of the week.

Separately, Tropical Storm Odalys has formed southwest of Mexico’s west coast and is expected to strengthen into a hurricane in the next day or so.

The hurricane center said the storm’s center was becoming better organized and was about 1,345 miles west-southwest of the southern tip of Baja California, with maximum sustained winds of 50 miles per hour.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



NEW YORK TIMES

**BACK ONSTAGE** — Ed Sheeran performed during his Loop Tour at Lincoln Financial Field in Philadelphia on Saturday. At the beginning of the show, Sheeran acknowledged “mistakes” over the departure of supporting acts and discussed the “horrific” attack on Israel and the “humanitarian crisis” in Gaza. **A6.**

## ICE agent shoots and wounds man in Austin, Texas

AUSTIN, Texas — A US Immigration and Customs Enforcement officer shot and wounded a man Sunday afternoon in Texas’ capital of Austin, local authorities said, and anti-ICE protesters quickly gathered at the scene.

The unnamed man was in serious but stable condition at a hospital after being shot once in the torso on the city’s north side, Austin Police Chief Lisa Davis said at a news conference with the mayor.

The Department of Homeland Security, which oversees ICE, did not participate in the news conference and didn’t immediately respond to requests for details.

Austin police officers were not involved in the operation or the shooting, which occurred after a traffic stop, Davis told reporters.

Austin Mayor Kirk Watson, a Democrat, said he wants the city’s police department to be involved in the investigation so it can provide “clear, third-party eyes” in the process. Watson said he does not think it would be appropriate for ICE to investigate on its own.



JOEL ANGEL JUAREZ/ASSOCIATED PRESS

People protested where local authorities say an ICE officer shot a man in Austin, Texas, on Sunday.

Austin residents have “a right to feel safe in their city,” Watson said. A proper investigation will only enhance credibility, he added.

Davis said she did not yet know the nationality of the person who was shot. The chief said there were not many facts she could provide so soon after the incident, but added that her department’s special investigation unit was at the scene.

A Toyota Corolla was parked

under an overpass with damage to its passenger-side door and what appeared to be bullet holes, local media reported.

A large law enforcement presence was at the scene, along with a crowd of about a hundred protesters. Some demonstrators cursed at officers holding riot shields, while others yelled out as passing cars honked in support of the protest.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

## Man dies after Utah lightning strike

A 19-year-old man died Friday in a lightning storm while huddled with nine other people inside a metal structure atop a mountain in Utah, authorities said.

The man was at the summit of the peak, Mount Timpanogos, when scattered storm cells moved through late Thursday and early Friday, authorities said.

The man, who has not been publicly identified, was with the others inside a structure known as the Tin Shack when the storm struck, said Sergeant Ray Ormond, the public information officer with the Utah County Sheriff’s Office.

The shack, a well-known spot atop the peak, was built out of steel in 1927 as a lookout house, according to The Daily Herald in Provo, Utah.

Lightning struck it, leaving nine people with minor injuries, Ormond said. Hikers alerted authorities about 6 a.m. Friday.

The 19-year-old man was critically injured and was pronounced dead on the mountain, the sheriff’s office said in a news release.

There were 517 lightning-related deaths from 2006 through last year, according to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. Nearly 90 percent of people who are struck by lightning survive, the CDC said.

The storm system Friday was not abnormal, said Darren Van Cleave, the meteorologist-in-charge at the National Weather Service office in Salt Lake City.

The severe weather arrived during Utah’s monsoon season and in conjunction with a jet of moisture from the west, Van Cleave said, adding that each cell that passed through the area had been filled with lightning.

“It was a very electrically active day,” he said.

Mount Timpanogos, which is more than 11,740 feet tall and is about 50 miles south-east of Salt Lake City, features two main routes to the top, each a little more than 14 miles round trip, said Jim Steenburgh, a professor of atmospheric science at the University of Utah.

NEW YORK TIMES

# The World



JOHANNES SIMON/GETTY IMAGES

**JUMPING FOR FREUDE** — Members of the traditional Moriskens dancers’ costume group participated in the annual Traditional Costume and Marksman’s Parade following the opening day of the 2026 Munich Oktoberfest on Sunday. This year’s Oktoberfest, which runs through Oct. 4, is expected to draw millions of visitors to the German city once again.

## Houthis push to expand their territory

### Militant group steps up fighting with Saudis

By Vivian Nereim

NEW YORK TIMES

RIYADH, Saudi Arabia — The Iranian-backed Houthi militia in Yemen was engaged in fierce battles against fighters backed by Saudi Arabia on Sunday, as the group stepped up its push to expand its territory, according to local officials.

The ground fighting is the latest sign of how the war between Saudi Arabia and the Houthis that resumed in July is escalating. On Saturday, the armed group said it had launched missiles and drones at Riyadh, the Saudi capital, and at oil facilities, in retaliation for hundreds of Saudi airstrikes and other attacks inside Yemen.

On Sunday, battles were raging in al-Wazi’iyah, al-Madarib-ah, and al-Arah, mountainous territory in the southwest of Yemen, according to Abdul Basit al-Baher, an army officer with the Saudi-backed government. If the Houthis gain control of

the areas, they could cut off the city of Taiz from the southern capital of Aden and lay siege to Saudi-backed forces there, he added.

Fierce battles have also taken place in recent days around Kahboub, a mountainous territory that overlooks the Bab el-Mandeb Strait, a choke point for international shipping, according to two other Yemeni officials. The waterway became a critical trade route for Saudi Arabia after Iran effectively blockaded the Strait of Hormuz in the Persian Gulf. The officials spoke on the condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to speak to the news media.

Saudi officials have not responded to repeated requests for comment on the war. The government has not acknowledged carrying out recent airstrikes in Yemen or responded to a Houthi claim that the group shot down a Saudi fighter jet last week.

In a statement about the attack on Riyadh, Major General Turki al-Maliki, a spokesperson for a Saudi-led military coalition in Yemen, said that it



ABDULNASSER ALSEDDIK/ASSOCIATED PRESS

**People donated blood for war wounded at the National Blood Transfusion and Research Center, in Aden, Yemen.**

“holds the inherent right to take appropriate measures,” but provided no details.

One question hanging over Saudi Arabia’s deliberations is whether the United States, the kingdom’s most powerful ally, will increase military assistance against the Houthis, or become directly involved.

Saudi officials have been clear that the kingdom does not want to fight the Houthis alone. That is especially true because the earlier, yearslong military

campaign that Saudi Arabia led against the group turned into a quagmire. The conflict damaged the kingdom’s reputation, strained its finances, and contributed to the deaths of hundreds of thousands of Yemenis from violence, hunger, and disease.

President Trump rebuffed an appeal this month by Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman, the country’s de facto ruler, for increased military support to battle the Houthis,

according to officials with knowledge of the conversations.

Around the same time, the Houthis seized control of Yemen’s entire Red Sea coastline, giving the group greater control over shipping in the waterway.

“The Houthis are trying to consolidate gains on the West Coast and to take additional territory, particularly in Taiz and Marib governorates,” said April Alley, a Yemen specialist and senior fellow at The Washington Institute.

“What I am seeing now is the Houthis using a dual-track approach to expansion: military and narrative,” she added. “From the narrative perspective they are saying: We are all Yemeni, let’s push the Saudis out and then find solutions.”

The Houthis and Yemeni government forces have been at war since 2014, when the Houthis seized the country’s capital, Sanaa. Soon after, a Saudi-led military coalition began a bombing campaign to try to restore the government to power, plunging the impoverished nation into a devastating conflict.

## Kyiv launches large drone strike

### Called most massive of war; Moscow targeted

By Valerie Hopkins and Andrew E. Kramer

NEW YORK TIMES

MOSCOW — Moscow and its surrounding region came under attack by hundreds of drones, local authorities said Sunday morning, on the final day of parliamentary, regional, and local elections across Russia.

About 1,600 drones heading toward the Moscow region were shot down, Moscow Mayor Sergei Sobyenin said, including 450 that had been approaching the Russian capital. He called the attack the largest drone strike on Moscow of the war.

Two people were killed and 20 injured in the strike, Russian authorities said. An oil refinery and a warehouse were also hit.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky posted on Facebook that the bombardment included the first use of a newly developed Ukrainian ballistic missile to strike inside Russia. That missile does not have the range to reach Moscow, according to its manufacturer, Fire Point, so it would have been aimed elsewhere in Russia.

Neither Sobyenin’s comment about the scale of the attack nor Zelensky’s statement about the use of a ballistic missile could be

independently confirmed.

Zelensky, in a separate statement on social media Sunday, said that he had spoken to President Trump and that they had agreed to meet in New York. The United Nations General Assembly is taking place this week. The White House did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

“This meeting could change a lot,” Zelensky wrote. “There is diplomatic momentum.”

Russian officials have repeatedly said that they are holding elections under attack, possibly an implicit criticism of Ukraine, which has not held elections since the start of Russia’s full-scale invasion in 2022 because martial law forbids them. Russian President Vladimir Putin has repeatedly criticized Ukraine and Zelensky for not holding a vote.

The night was deadlier in Ukraine, where seven people were killed in strikes in the Kyiv and Sumy regions, according to Ukrainian authorities. Air alerts were on and off all night through most of the country.

Moscow’s mayor said “a few drones” had struck the Moscow oil refinery in Kapotnya, which had been taken out of commission by attacks in June. At the time, it was estimated that the repairs would last for six months. On Sunday, Sobyenin said the refinery had again been damaged.

In the neighborhood of Ramenskoye, a 21-story building caught fire and 600 residents were evacuated, said Moscow’s regional governor, Andrei Vorobyov.

A warehouse in the Moscow region was also struck, though no casualties were reported. For months, Ukraine has been targeting warehouses in Russia with long-range strikes.

All four airports in the Moscow region enforced temporary restrictions at the time of the attacks, and more than 30 flights were grounded, according to the newspaper Kommersant.

On Saturday, Sobyenin reported that a total of 2,022 drones had flown toward the Moscow region over the preceding seven days, 186 of which were shot down as they approached Moscow. Most of the drones had been shot down while they were still far from the city.

Trump said Sept. 14 that Kyiv and Moscow had agreed to stop campaigns of pounding each other’s energy infrastructure but neither side has confirmed that an agreement had been reached. The attacks have continued through the week.

The outcome of the Russian elections was expected to be a foregone conclusion: victory for the ruling party that supports Putin, because the Kremlin has engineered the vote to minimize competition.

## Russia wraps up wartime election

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Polls closed Sunday night in Russia’s first wartime parliamentary election, virtually devoid of opposition to President Vladimir Putin’s policies and all but certain to cement the Kremlin’s dominance. The last day of the three-day election came as Ukrainian forces fired more than 1,000 drones at Russia overnight, including hundreds that were launched toward Moscow. Russia’s Central Election Commission said turnout at the close of polls stood at 56.66 percent.

The vote began Friday for 111 million eligible voters and included residents of four Ukrainian regions that Moscow illegally annexed after the war began, but still doesn’t fully control, as well as those in Crimea, the Black Sea peninsula that was illegally annexed by Russia in 2014.

Authorities in Kyiv denounced the voting in the Russian-held areas as illegal and urged foreign governments not to recognize the result. The European Union on Friday called the action a “blatant violation of international law.”

As the polls closed in Russia and Russian-held areas of Ukraine, voting continued at embassies and consulates in timezones further west, including in the United States.

The Kremlin wants the parliamentary election — the first since the start of the full-scale invasion of Ukraine in 2022 — to showcase popular support for the war and legitimize its action. It has sought to avoid political risks by stamping out any dissent.

A massive state media campaign and tight control over the election in the absence of genuine opposition all but assure the Kremlin will keep tight control of Russian politics amid mounting economic costs and increasing Ukrainian drone attacks deep inside the country.

Voters cast two separate ballots, filling half of the Duma’s 450 seats by selecting political parties listed on the ballot. The rest are contested in single-seat constituencies, with voters choosing individual candidates.

Preliminary results are expected within hours of voting ending in the country’s west.

The main Kremlin party, United Russia, is widely expected to retain its overwhelming control of the lower house, the State Duma.

The liberal Yabloko party, the only registered political entity that dared to publicly criticize the war, was removed from the ballot last month by Russia’s Supreme Court, and only has a few dozen candidates in the single-constituency races.

### DAILY BRIEFING

## 18 accused of killing of Haiti’s leader extradited

PORT-AU-PRINCE — Eighteen suspects who were arrested in the July 2021 killing of Haitian President Jovenel Moïse were being extradited to the United States on Sunday, marking the end of a drawn-out judicial process in Haiti for a killing that shocked the troubled Caribbean country.

The suspects will face trial in Florida, according to Jason Redding Quiñones, US attorney for the Southern District of Florida.

“Today marks the next major phase in our pursuit of accountability for the assassination of President Jovenel Moïse,” he wrote on X. “We will follow the evidence wherever it leads, to those who financed it, facilitated it, supported it or committed crimes to make it possible. Five years later, we are still bringing defendants before American courts, and we are not finished.”

Quiñones did not identify the suspects, and a spokesperson for the US Department of Justice did not immediately respond to a request for comment on Sunday.

The suspects who remained in Haiti included more than a dozen Colombian soldiers and Joseph Badio, a former Haiti Ministry of Justice employee.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

## N. Korea launches 2 ballistic missiles toward the sea

SEOUL — North Korea launched two short-range ballistic missiles toward the sea on Sunday, South Korea’s military said, days after the North threatened to bolster its nuclear deterrent capabilities and respond to what it called US hostilities.

The launches were the latest in a series of weapons demonstrations by North Korea even after President Trump scaled back a joint military exercise with South Korea last month in an apparent effort to revive diplomacy with the North’s leader, Kim Jong Un.

The two missile launches were conducted from North Korea’s eastern coastal Wonsan area. The first missile flew about 280 miles while the second one flew more than 370 miles, both toward the North’s eastern waters, South Korea’s military said.

The missiles eventually ended up in the sea. South Korea’s presidential office urged North Korea to immediately halt ballistic missile launches that are banned by UN Security Council resolutions. The South’s military said it maintains readiness to repel any provocations by the North under a solid alliance with the US.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

## Israeli president pardons ex-soldier; shot injured man

Israel’s president on Saturday expunged the criminal record of a former soldier who fatally shot a severely wounded Palestinian assailant a decade ago, fulfilling a long-sought demand from Israel’s right.

The case of the soldier, Elor Azaria, set off intense public debate in Israel and abroad in 2016 over Israeli soldiers’ treatment of Palestinians in the occupied West Bank and whether Israel would prosecute members of the security forces accused of grave crimes.

Isaac Herzog, the Israeli president, said on Saturday that he had decided to clear Azaria’s criminal record after “examining all the circumstances of the case and the considerations related to the request,” and “after many years in which Azaria bore the consequences of his actions.”

Azaria was convicted of manslaughter for shooting the injured Palestinian man, Abdul Fattah al-Sharif, in Hebron, in the Israeli-occupied West Bank.

NEW YORK TIMES

# Pa. measles outbreak met with vaccinations

Still, defiance and resignation resound in state

By Pooja Salhotra, Mark Bonamo, and Kevin Williams

NEW YORK TIMES

Children played softball on a postcard-beautiful day. Business owners sold homemade doughnuts and fresh apple cider. And students studied on grassy lawns outside Westminster College.

The daily activities of life continued unabated in Pennsylvania, which is in the throes of a widespread measles outbreak that has killed four and hospitalized 150 since April.

The surge of cases has been met by a surge in vaccinations, with an 84 percent increase in August, state health officials say. But there has also been defiance and resignation, as the state becomes the latest to contend with the once-eradicated disease.

As the virus spreads through Pennsylvania, so have political and community tensions, stoked by a distrust of vaccines long proven safe and a disconnect between state and federal health agencies.

More than 3,400 measles cases have been reported this year

across 45 states, with Pennsylvania at the top of the list. Measles has been reported in 38 of the state's 67 counties.

Still, many remained undaunted about the spread of the highly contagious disease.

In Lancaster County, about 60 miles west of Philadelphia and the center of the outbreak, hundreds of people filled a farmers market Friday. On the streets was a steady flow of horse-and-buggy carriages, a primary mode of transport for many of the area's Amish and Mennonite communities.

"I'm not scared of measles," said Mervin Zook, 37, an Amish dairy farmer in Gordonville, Pa., who was selling his wares at the market. He said his brother and several nieces and nephews had gotten measles but had all recovered. "My family is not vaccinated because I don't feel that there is an advantage."

Neither the Amish nor Mennonite groups have a universal rule prohibiting vaccines, but their adoption has not been widespread.

According to one survey from 2022, 30 percent of Amish families in Lancaster County had their children vaccinated and believed vaccinations were safe and effective. Pennsylvania has the largest number of Amish in



RACHEL WISNIEWSKI/NEW YORK TIMES

Lancaster County is at the center of a measles outbreak that has sickened hundreds and killed four people in the state.

the country, according to the Young Center at Elizabethtown College.

"People are overloaded with all of the vaccinations coming at once," said John Riehl, 65, an Amish business owner who said he was vaccinated but added that outsiders do not understand the community's lifestyle. "They feel like they can't trust medicine anymore."

Declining vaccination rates across the country since the COVID-19 pandemic have helped fuel dozens of outbreaks of measles, a respiratory illness that can cause serious health

complications including pneumonia and brain swelling. Vaccination coverage among US kindergartners declined to about 92.4 percent in the 2025-26 school year, below the 95 percent needed to obtain herd immunity.

The United States has recorded more measles cases in 2026 than in any other year since the virus was declared eliminated in 2000, topping last year's record, when measles infected more than 2,200 Americans and killed three people.

A large outbreak in South Carolina took root in a close-knit

evangelical Slavic community earlier this year, and outbreaks are ongoing in several other states.

The largest and deadliest outbreak is now in Pennsylvania, where measles had sickened 767 people as of Friday, including 93 over the past week.

The outbreak has become political, with Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. disputing whether measles directly caused the deaths reported by state health officials. The Centers for Disease Control and Prevention did not include those deaths in the national tally, a departure from the typical practice of accepting data reported by states.

Dr. Debra Bogen, Pennsylvania's health secretary, said in a letter to the director of the CDC last week that the agency's choice not to publicly recognize the deaths "undermines our response." She said the state would accept emergency aid from the CDC only if the agency recognized the four deaths: two infants in Lancaster County, a 40-year-old in Jefferson County, and an 18-year-old in Mifflin County, all of whom were unvaccinated.

"Instead of leading with facts and reality, RFK Jr. has sowed distrust in science, stoked anti-vaccine sentiment by baselessly questioning their effectiveness

and misled the American people with his phony narrative," a statement from the state's health department read. "Pennsylvanians have died because of it."

On the social platform X, Kennedy accused Pennsylvania Governor Josh Shapiro of "fabricating" the measles deaths. He later seemed to attribute the state's measles outbreak partly to the governor for "refusing to cooperate with the CDC."

In a statement, the CDC said it was working with the Council of State and Territorial Epidemiologists to establish a standardized definition for measles deaths "to ensure consistent reporting across jurisdictions." The CDC also said it had supported the state with outbreak epidemiology, vaccination and contact tracing.

Warnings of possible exposures to measles are surfacing well beyond Pennsylvania.

California health officials said Friday that an unvaccinated passenger who traveled on trains and buses through at least six counties was hospitalized with measles, potentially exposing hundreds of commuters to the virus. In Colorado, health officials said an unvaccinated out-of-state visitor who tested positive for measles could have also exposed people.

## A long road and growing unease

Sikh truck driver stabbed at a Wyo. rest stop

By Miriam Jordan

NEW YORK TIMES

For years, Gurminder Singh has hauled energy drinks, snacks, and other items from California to supermarkets and big-box stores across the country, one of more than 100,000 Sikhs earning a living in the trucking business.

In the wee hours of Sept. 13, Singh pulled into a rest stop in Wyoming to use the bathroom. Moments later, he was ambushed and stabbed repeatedly by a white man. He was airlifted to a hospital in Casper, Wyo., where he was treated for 17 lacerations, including to the neck, chest, and arms.

"I am close to the sink and suddenly I am hit on the neck and then punched in the face," he recalled Saturday, after being discharged from the hospital.

"When I tried to push the man away, he got a knife and stabbed me 17 times," Singh said in a phone interview.

Local law enforcement arrested Andrew Kris Bzdak and charged him with attempted first-degree murder. His bail was set at \$1 million. Authorities have not yet determined a motive.

The attack occurred amid a surge in hostile rhetoric targeting Indians of Sikh faith. Members of the monotheistic religion, who traditionally wear turbans and maintain beards, have become the face of the



JASJIT SINGH VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

Gurminder Singh (right) spoke with Jasjit Singh (no relation) in a hospital in Casper, Wyo. The attack occurred amid a surge in hostile rhetoric targeting Indians of the Sikh faith.

Trump administration's efforts to bar certain immigrants from operating commercial vehicles.

Just days before the stabbing, the Department of Homeland Security posted an image on social media of a bearded man in a head covering with the caption "Get off our roads, you don't know how to drive Mr. Singh," the most common Sikh surname.

Published on Sept. 10, the eve of the 25th anniversary of the 9/11 attacks, the post drew immediate, widespread condemnation. Following the 2001 attacks, Sikh men were erroneously targeted in multiple anti-Muslim violent incidents because their turbans and beards were conflated with extremist groups.

DHS said the post depicted Harjinder Singh, a Sikh man (no relation to Gurminder Singh) accused of causing a fatal collision last year that left three people in a minivan dead in Florida. The agency removed the post the next day but dismissed complaints about it as "nonsensical drivel."

"It's impossible to separate the stabbing from the DHS post and the Trump administration's rhetoric," said Jasjit Singh, legal director of the Jakara Movement, a nonprofit that advocates for Sikhs in the United States.

"Just because we don't know the motive doesn't mean this was random," said Singh, a lawyer in Northern California whose father was a truck driver for four decades.

The DHS post and the stabbing have deeply shaken the 750,000-strong Sikh community, already reeling from a spike in online hate speech and threats, he said. And with upcoming national elections, which in the past have correlated with a rise in violence, Sikh houses of worship remain on alert.

As older truck drivers have

retired, immigrant drivers have increasingly filled the void. About 200,000 foreign drivers hold licenses that allow them to operate commercial vehicles, and about half of them are Sikhs.

The Trump administration has been pressuring states to revoke driver's licenses and restrict the issuance of new ones to certain immigrants, tightening language requirements and dispatching federal agents to stop drivers at checkpoints to verify their immigration status.

Munmeeth Soni, legal director of the Sikh Coalition, an advocacy group, accused the administration of fueling violence, such as the stabbing, by using Sikh truck drivers as "scapegoats for their campaign to remove immigrant drivers."

She said that some observant Sikh drivers have stopped wearing their head coverings, whether the turban or a bandanna called a rumal, and they have begun shaving their beards to avoid scrutiny.

"Are we ever going to be American enough for people who don't want us here?" she said.

Raman Dhillon, chief executive of the North American Punjabi Trucking Association, said that some drivers were now reluctant to take routes through red states.

"Somebody traveling in the middle of nowhere by themselves doesn't want to go to a state where they feel they could be attacked," he said.

Despite their tiny population, Sikh Americans consistently rank as the third-most targeted religious group for hate crimes in the United States, behind Jewish and Muslim Americans.

Between January 2023 and December 2025, online slurs targeting South Asians jumped 109 percent, according to Stop AAPI Hate, which tracks hate

against Asian Americans and Pacific Islanders.

Since arriving in the United States, Gurminder Singh has plied the nation's highways, driving up to 11 hours at a stretch and sleeping inside his big rig.

His most frequent routes take him from his home base in Sacramento, Calif., to Chicago and St. Louis. This time, he was headed to Bethlehem, Pa.

"I can't help but think that I was attacked because of my dark skin, features, and my religion," he said, adding that he was aware of the DHS social media post. His head was uncovered at the time, but he maintains a beard and wears a kara, a traditional silver steel bracelet symbolizing spiritual strength.

He had stopped at the Bitter Creek Rest Area on Interstate 80, in southern Wyoming between Salt Lake City and Cheyenne, Wyo., on previous trips. It was just after 3 a.m. Sept. 13 when he pulled in to use the restroom.

A man followed him inside and struck him from behind. When Singh turned around, the assailant, in a blue tracksuit, delivered blows to his face. Singh said he attempted to push him away, but the man drew a knife and began stabbing him repeatedly.

Staggering outside, Singh was met by a Latino family who rushed to his aid. They applied towels to his wounds, dialed 911, and provided details that assisted law enforcement in locating the suspect, he said.

"They gave me a second life," Singh said, adding that he wishes he could find them again.

Once he fully recovers, Singh plans to resume crisscrossing the country.

"I am a skilled driver," he said, pointing to his spotless safety record. "I am proud of being a truck driver."

## White House moves to take control of NIH research grants

By Carolyn Y. Johnson and Sheryl Gay Stolberg

NEW YORK TIMES

The White House has begun drafting a new executive order that could further cement President Trump's ability to control billions of dollars in scientific grants funded by the National Institutes of Health and expand the administration's pressure campaign against elite universities.

Discussed at a highly contentious meeting at the White House on Friday, the order aims to create a new external committee with the power to veto awards in the nation's vast biomedical research portfolio that do not conform to Trump's political agenda, according to people with knowledge of the effort.

During the meeting, Trump repeatedly complained about his administration's failure to bring Harvard University to heel. The administration has been unable to hammer out a deal with the nation's oldest and wealthiest university, a central plank of his broader push against "woke" ideology in higher education.

The White House has also lost a pair of lawsuits to Harvard, including one ruling that blocked cuts to the university's existing federal research grants. The government has said it plans to appeal.

Inside the White House, some of Trump's top lieutenants have expressed frustration about a perceived slowdown in the administration's attempt to force conservative cultural changes on academia.

The meeting, in the Oval Office, was called in part to discuss why the NIH hadn't done enough to push the administration's agenda on academia in general and Ivy League schools in particular, said two administration officials familiar with the planning.

The meeting was first reported by The Washington Post. Officials at the Office of Management and Budget, which is drafting the executive order, declined to comment. A spokesperson for the NIH, Joshua Pradko, declined to discuss details of the meeting.

"NIH remains committed to its mission of funding biomedical research to benefit the health of the American people," Pradko said in a text message.

Referring to reports that Russell Vought, director of the OMB, wants to rescind NIH funding, Pradko added, "There will be no rescissions to NIH grant monies. All NIH grant monies will be spent."

If the order moves forward, it would mark the latest attempt by the Trump administration to

usurp the scientific autonomy of the NIH, a \$48 billion agency that distributes a majority of its budget to labs across the country for research into areas such as heart disease, cancer and infectious diseases.

Traditionally, the NIH selects projects based on expert review of their scientific merit. But Trump has sought through a series of recent directives in his second term to bring that process under political review, arguing in part that the government has been funding "woke" liberal priorities.

Friday's meeting brought to a head months of conflict between two of the attendees: Vought, who wants to impose greater political control over NIH grant approvals, and Dr. Jay Bhattacharya, the NIH director, who is resisting those efforts, according to two people close to Bhattacharya.

Their relationship has grown so contentious that Vought had refused to meet with Bhattacharya, the people said. During the session Friday, Vought accused the NIH director of funding projects that were in conflict with administration priorities, such as supporting research related to diversity and equity.

One of Trump's executive orders, issued on his first day back in office, ended all administration programs involving "diversity, equity and inclusion." It has had far-reaching effects on NIH studies, including those investigating "health disparities" — why people of certain races and ethnicities may be more or less prone to certain diseases or to suffer worse outcomes.

The Harvard confrontation has placed Bhattacharya in an awkward position. Dr. Alan M. Garber, president of Harvard University, is his mentor and longtime friend. Both are physicians and health economists; they have authored academic papers together and remain close, according to The Harvard Crimson.

On Friday, Vought also sought access to funds for the current fiscal year that have not yet been spent, but he did not succeed.

The fundamental disagreement, however, appears to reflect a philosophical difference: Vought wants to cut federal spending for research; Bhattacharya does not.

Nor does Congress, which overruled Trump's proposal to cut biomedical research spending last year.

Moreover, Bhattacharya opposes Vought's push to give political appointees the final say over all federal spending, including health and scientific research.

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# Trump to visit Mamdani in New York City on Monday

President Trump will visit Mayor Zohran Mamdani of New York City on Monday at the mayor's official residence at Gracie Mansion, according to the mayor's office.

A spokesperson for the mayor said the meeting will “focus on issues affecting New York City and New Yorkers.”

The president will be in New York for the UN General Assembly, where he is scheduled to speak Tuesday. A White House spokesperson confirmed the visit.

This would be the president's first visit with Mamdani on the mayor's home turf but not the first time the two leaders have met.

Mamdani twice traveled to Washington to meet with the president, first as mayor-elect in November, and then as the sitting mayor in February.

During those meetings, the two leaders from opposing ends of the political spectrum managed to strike up a surprisingly amicable relationship, despite their history of mutual public derision, and despite members of Trump's party having used Islamophobic terms to demonize the city's first Muslim mayor. (Trump has attacked a Michigan Democratic Senate nominee who is Muslim but has been comparatively gentle with Mamdani, to a degree that has confused some of his own allies.)

It remains unclear what precisely the two men will talk about. The president's deportation agenda remains a source of tension between him and Mamdani, who has accused the Trump administration of criminalizing “the very act of being an immigrant.”

Infrastructure might also come up. During Mamdani's most recent visit to the White House, he pitched the president on Sunnyside Yard, an 180-acre train yard on which the city has long dreamed of building thousands of apartments. The city envisions building a platform

over the yards that it says would require at least \$21 billion in federal grants.

NEW YORK TIMES

## Trump proposes an ‘AI Force’ rather than new regulations

President Trump is so enamored of Space Force, a military command he created in his first term, that he keeps its flag by his desk in the Oval Office. He took personal interest in the design of its uniforms, which bear close resemblance to those of Galactic Empire officers in “Star Wars.”

On Saturday, Trump proposed a follow-on to Space Force: a new “AI Force.” But he left to earthbound speculation what, exactly, it was supposed to do.

Trump cast his announcement — along with his promise to appoint a new AI “Czar” for the White House — as an effort to boost the artificial intelligence industry, saying “we will cherish it, help it, and watch over it.”

In the roiling debate in Washington over regulating frontier AI models and the companies that produce them, or slowing down development until the mystery is solved about the summer in which AI agents went rogue, Trump continues to side with the “accelerationists,” who call for the government to stay out of the way.

Trump, in his social media post, compared warnings about AI with warnings about global warming and conspiracies that he said were created by “Radical Left Democrats,” ignoring concerns about AI shared by many Republicans.

Trump did not make clear whether he envisioned the new AI Force as a military command or a civilian agency or department. White House officials did not respond to an email seeking clarification.

NEW YORK TIMES

## Outlets express solidarity after Trump bars reporters

Many major media outlets and some high-profile Demo-



SAMUEL CORUM/GETTY IMAGES

**STATE BALLROOM** — Work continued on the White House ballroom in D.C. on Sunday. The Trump administration has also built a new helipad on White House grounds and is moving forward with plans for a “triumphal arch.”

crats panned President Trump's abrupt decision to ban CNN, MS NOW, and Politico from the White House.

Trump acted on his latest barrage of threats against the press Saturday morning, when reporters for the outlets were denied access to the White House and had their badges confiscated.

On Friday evening, Trump had accused the three outlets of running “purposely negative stories” that were untrue, though he provided no details. The Trump administration has not said what led to his decision, which many First Amendment groups called unconstitutional and unlikely to survive a court challenge.

Condemnation from leading news outlets was nearly universal, including from many that compete directly with CNN, MS NOW, and Politico.

“No news organization — or person — should be retaliated against by the government over the words they use,” said Lauren Easton, a spokesperson for the Associated Press, which filed

suit over restrictions that Trump tried to impose on its White House access last year.

The New York Times, The Washington Post, and press associations also released statements calling the ban an attack on free speech and the free press.

Journalists at Fox News have also taken issue with the ban.

Jacqui Heinrich, a Fox News anchor and president of the White House Correspondents' Association, said on social media that the right to First Amendment protections “does not depend on whether the president likes a news organization's coverage.”

Democrats pounced on Trump's ban as an attempt to hide his administration's shortcomings and to distract voters from other issues.

NEW YORK TIMES

## El-Sayed has unlikely defender in Tucker Carlson

Tucker Carlson, the influential far-right podcaster, spent more than three decades defending the Republican Party

before leaving it this year over his opposition to the war with Iran. He is known for his nativist rhetoric and once said immigrants were making the United States “poorer and dirtier.”

Abdul El-Sayed, a son of Egyptian immigrants, has spent his adult life pushing for progressive causes. Now El-Sayed is the Democratic Party's nominee in a pivotal Senate race in Michigan, running on a left-wing platform that calls for universal healthcare and abolishing Immigration and Customs Enforcement.

Yet, in a striking twist that underscores his shifting politics, Carlson has taken to defending El-Sayed. Both are vocal critics of the Israeli government and the war with Iran.

In recent weeks, Carlson has repeatedly spoken in positive terms about El-Sayed and castigated his Republican opponent, former representative Mike Rogers, a critic-turned-ally of President Trump with hawkish foreign policy views.

“I wouldn't vote for Mike Rogers at gunpoint,” Carlson

said on his podcast this month.

As the 25th anniversary of the Sept. 11 attacks approached, Rogers targeted El-Sayed for saying in 2021 that the military actions of the United States after the attacks had “scarred millions” around the world.

Carlson stepped in to defend El-Sayed.

“El-Sayed did not celebrate airplane hijackings or cheerlead Al Qaeda,” Carlson wrote in his newsletter, “he simply said that the U.S. conducting terrorism of its own in response to 9/11 was not exactly an appropriate reaction. He is obviously right.”

Political consultants were puzzled. Could Carlson really be endorsing El-Sayed?

In text messages with The New York Times, Carlson would not go that far.

“I'm a podcaster,” he wrote. “I don't make endorsements.”

NEW YORK TIMES

## California cracks down on undisclosed political ads

Governor Gavin Newsom of California signed legislation Saturday that will penalize social media influencers who do not properly disclose paid political content posted on the internet.

The state has required the disclosures for paid posts about state- and local-level campaigns since 2023, but until now, content creators couldn't be fined or prosecuted if they failed to comply. Now, California campaign finance regulators are empowered to impose fines on influencers of up to \$5,000 for each violation or to refer those violations to law enforcement as potential misdemeanors.

Politicians and advocacy groups are increasingly turning to influencers as a way to reach younger, more online audiences and, in some cases, are paying them for their support. But unlike traditional campaign advertising on television or billboards, there are no federal requirements to disclose payments for social media posts.

NEW YORK TIMES



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# German far right appears to fall short of power

## AfD improves its results in 2 states in new elections

**By Jim Tankersley**  
NEW YORK TIMES

BERLIN — Just two weeks after the far-right Alternative for Germany party, or AfD, scored a stunning victory in the small eastern state of Saxony-Anhalt, German voters in two other regions voted Sunday and delivered a new gauge of the AfD’s national prospects.

Voters in Berlin and in a lightly populated coastal corner of the former East Germany, Mecklenburg-West Pomerania, elected new state parliaments. Exit polls released after voting ended showed the AfD was on track to improve its performance in both states but not come close to governing either area.

The polls suggested that the AfD would finish first in Mecklenburg-West Pomerania but not

take power, because other parties refuse to work with it to form a government. The far-left party Die Linke appeared to be winning Berlin handily, outperforming its preelection polls, and could lead the next government there.

The AfD’s leaders have used Nazi slogans and played down the significance of the Holocaust, and German intelligence has classified the party as a “suspected extremist” group. Yet it has harnessed voter anxiety over the economy and immigration, as well as the widespread unpopularity of Chancellor Friedrich Merz, a mainstream conservative.

In both regions, the AfD fell short of its performance in Saxony-Anhalt, where it won 44 percent of the vote and could soon form a government. In Berlin, it finished well below expectations, based on preelection polls.

Election officials said Sunday that turnout was running higher than usual.



BRITTA PEDERSEN/DPA VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

**Alternative for Germany party members reacted to election projections for the House of Representatives on Sunday.**

Much of what fueled the AfD’s victory in Saxony-Anhalt is also present in Mecklenburg-West Pomerania, a state of 1.5 million residents. Unemployment there is higher than the national average, as in Saxony-Anhalt. Residents still resent how eastern Germany struggled after the reunification of Germany in

1990. And many are sympathetic to Russia and wary of immigration, which surged in Germany during the European migration a decade ago.

Goldie Nickel, a young voter in the city of Neubrandenburg, said this past week that she supported the AfD because she felt the government wasn’t tough

enough on immigrants.

“Migrants and refugees that either break the law or misbehave should be sent back to their home countries,” she said.

The AfD celebrated its gains but appeared on track for only a narrow win in Mecklenburg-West Pomerania. That’s because the state has a rarity for eastern Germany today: a popular leader from a mainstream party.

Manuela Schwesig, a Social Democrat, has governed the state since 2017. She has at times distanced herself from her national party leaders, who are the junior partners in Merz’s federal coalition government, and built an independent brand with voters. Her party finished a close second, exit polls suggested, and will almost certainly lead the next government.

As the state premier, Schwesig has said clearly what she intends to do and follows through on those promises, said Bettina Müller, also of Neubrandenburg. Her vote for the Social

Democrats on Sunday, she said, would be for Schwesig personally.

The Social Democrats may have been bolstered by center-right voters who hope to deny the AfD first place, said William Thay, the president of Le Millénaire, a French think tank tracking the race.

“In Mecklenburg, we believe we have strategic voters,” he said. “They will vote against the AfD.”

In Germany’s capital, the far-left Die Linke party surged, capturing one-quarter of the vote, after a campaign dominated by the price and scarcity of urban housing.

Die Linke has campaigned on an initiative to take public ownership of 270,000 apartments owned by private real estate giants, in a bid to make housing more plentiful and affordable.

“We want an end to speculation with our homes,” said Elif Eralp, the party’s mayoral candidate, on her Instagram.



SAMAR HAZBOUN/NEW YORK TIMES

**Israelis swam in an ancient reservoir on land belonging to Palestinian farmer Saad Nemer and his siblings last month.**

## Settlers draining Palestinians’ land dry

### Have vandalized water systems 80 times this year

**By Natan Odenheimer and Gabby Sobelman**  
NEW YORK TIMES

FASAYIL, West Bank — On a hot August morning in the West Bank’s desert, an Israeli teenager performed a backflip into the cool water of an ancient reservoir. It was filled with water diverted from Palestinians’ farms.

The farmers used to grow watermelons, eggplants, and cucumbers in the arid Jordan Valley. But in June, their main irrigation source — a pipeline that brought spring water to their crops and a surrounding community — was severed and redirected to the reservoir, according to the farmers and the Israeli military.

During a visit last month, water gushed from the pipe into the pool, where dozens of Israelis were splashing around while others picnicked nearby, trespassing on private land.

“One morning nothing came out of the pipe,” said Saad Nemer, a soft-spoken 69-year-old farmer, who owns the land and the reservoir with his siblings, and who has since watched his livelihood wither under the desert sun.

Within days, the pool became a summertime magnet for Israelis, drawing hundreds of visitors a week who traipsed over the Nemers’s land. A lawmaker in Israel’s parliament on social media promoted visiting the site as an enjoyable means of “occupying the land.”

No one claimed responsibility for cutting the pipe. But Israeli settlers have celebrated the refilling of the pool in videos shared on social media, while one Israeli lawmaker said that “heroic settlers” had returned the pool to “Jewish hands.”

In the West Bank, where water is already limited, settlers have vandalized water and sanitation systems at least 80 times so far this year, according to United Nations data. Settlers have also built illegal outposts close to springs, and then intimi-

dated Palestinians who come to bathe or water their livestock there.

The attacks, which often cut off entire communities from running water for days or even weeks at a time, are part of a surge of settler violence in the West Bank. Over the past three years, extremist settlers have violently driven thousands of Palestinians from their homes and set fire to cars, houses, and mosques.

Nemer sought help from the Civil Administration, an Israeli military body overseeing civilian affairs for Palestinians in parts of the West Bank. In a letter to his lawyer in July, viewed by The New York Times, the administration said that the pipeline would be reconnected, but it did not respond to his demand to have the trespassers evicted from his property.

Israeli forces reconnected the pipeline and made “efforts to prevent further damage to the water line,” a military statement said, adding that a fence was erected “to prevent lawbreakers from entering the area.” The mil-

itary also said that the pool was on private land and that the water diversion was “unauthorized.”

Water did flow back to Nemer’s fields — but only for a day before it was sabotaged again, he said. On a recent visit to the site, much of it remained unfenced.

Settlers from a nearby outpost refused to answer questions about the reservoir.

Some former senior Israeli generals and officials say that Israel’s right-wing government is not doing enough to stop the violence in the West Bank, aimed at ultimately driving most Palestinians out of the territory, which Israel has occupied since 1967.

Most of the people the Times spoke to at the pool said they were Israeli settlers. Many said that knowing the water came at the expense of local Palestinian farms was part of the draw.

“It’s good that this makes life here harder for the Arabs. This country belongs to the people of Israel,” said Ori, 15, a high schooler from Asael, a settlement on the southern edge of the West Bank.

## Sheeran tells fans he’s sorry in first show since debate

### Says ‘heart has been broken’ by Gaza deaths

**By Ben Sisario**  
NEW YORK TIMES

PHILADELPHIA — Ed Sheeran was all alone.

Stepping onto the stage Saturday night, after his stadium tour had been roiled by the removal of an opening act over comments about the war in the Gaza Strip, Sheeran acknowledged that he had made “mistakes” in how he handled the situation, and apologized for disappointing his fans.

“I’ve tried in my career to not be a political commentator of any kind because I want my music and shows to be about unity, not division, about humanity, not politics,” Sheeran said, standing on the darkened stage of Lincoln Financial Field in a plain blue T-shirt. “But this is a humanitarian issue and I cannot hide how I feel about it anymore.”

He called Hamas’s attack on Israel on Oct. 7, 2023, “horrific,” and said that “what is happening in Gaza is catastrophic and unjustifiable and disproportionate.” He added: “My heart has been broken by the scale of devastation and loss of civilians’ lives, children’s lives. And the systemic injustice we’re seeing unfold in the West Bank, it cannot be overlooked.”

With his voice breaking, Sheeran said his concerts were “still a place where everyone is welcome and everyone can stand beside people that have opposing views” and enjoy his songs of “love, hope, and unity,” before he played his soaring hit “Castle on the Hill” to cheers from the crowd.

His ballads, aching love songs, and pop earworms written for acts such as Justin Bieber and One Direction have been streamed billions of times, making Sheeran, 35, one of music’s biggest yet most benign hitmakers. But his Loop tour,

and possibly his career, had seemed on the verge of collapse last week after he appeared to acquiesce to the demands of a handful of powerful NFL team owners.

Those men, including Robert Kraft, whose company owns the New England Patriots and Gillette Stadium outside Boston, decided that Sheeran’s tour could not play in their stadiums if it continued with Macklemore, a Seattle indie rapper who proclaimed “Free Palestine” at two of Sheeran’s shows in New Jersey this month. Macklemore also sang a protest song that accused Israel of genocide in Gaza — a performance that drew condemnation from activist groups such as StopAntisemitism and the Israeli-American Council.

A statement by Sheeran, saying the decision to remove Macklemore was “not mine,” but belonged to the venues and his promoter, was followed within hours by the resignation of every other support act for the remainder of the tour, along with that of an Irish folk band that backed Sheeran up for part of his two-hour-plus set each night. Sheeran added, “Those who come to my shows do not expect a political forum.”

His response, especially his position of apolitical neutrality, drew harsh attacks. Online commentators found that posture not just untenable but also hypocritical, pointing out that Sheeran had taken political positions in the past, including signing an open letter opposing Brexit and taking part in a fundraiser for humanitarian relief in Ukraine.

Sheeran, at that point, seemed too radioactive for any other act to join him, even if he could manage to retool the show before the next scheduled date. During Saturday’s performance, Sheeran said that he had been urged by people around him to cancel the tour. Instead, he stepped into the spotlight to talk directly to fans.

## Trump rolling out the red carpet for Xi amid artificial intelligence race

### President’s tough talk on China no longer a strategy

**By Josh Boak**  
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — When President Trump first ran for office, he called out China as a menace to the US economy, saying it had gutted America’s factories and eroded the middle class.

That tough talk helped Trump get to the White House a decade ago, but since then, he increasingly speaks in glowing

terms about Chinese President Xi Jinping, the geopolitical rival Trump will fete on Thursday with a state dinner.

“He’s a great gentleman; we get along great,” Trump said this month. “We have a very good trading relationship and, you know, they’re a competitor and all of that, but we have a very good relationship with President Xi.”

On issue after issue, the Republican president has given Xi a pass.

Trump shrugged off reports that China had provided Iran with satellite imagery, saying, “I think he’s behaved reasonably well.” After accusing Beijing of accessing US voter files back in

2020, Trump indicated he was hesitant to retaliate: “I think China is maybe a little bit different today than it was then.”

Trump’s magnanimity comes as China and the United States are in a contest for global leadership, with some of America’s traditional allies rethinking their strategies. China has expanded its dominance in manufacturing and pushed into new technologies such as artificial intelligence and electric vehicles that create risks for the economies of the US, Germany, Italy, France, South Korea, and Japan, among others.

Unable to change Chinese behavior, Trump has resorted to hospitality.

He traveled to Beijing in May, and the two leaders could meet again two more times this year at international summits. Trump has readied a helipad on the White House South Lawn before Xi’s arrival and has lamented that his ballroom will not be ready to host the Chinese leader.

Trump has insisted that the US is comfortably ahead of China, but his efforts last year to confront China with a mounting set of tariffs backfired. China holds a relative monopoly on the rare earths used in electronics and deployed that to help force a trade armistice with Trump.

“Trump has dramatically shifted his approach to China

because his initial attempt to use super-high tariffs and export restrictions was unsuccessful,” said Michael Kovrig, a senior adviser at the International Crisis Group. “Xi and Trump got into a contest of leverage, and Xi came out on top.”

Meanwhile, Trump has largely undermined the economic and national security alliances that could previously apply pressure on China, said Kovrig, a former Canadian diplomat who was detained by China during Trump’s first term.

Trump has mocked French President Emmanuel Macron in speeches. He has run hot and cold on NATO after several of its members did not fully support

his choice to start a war with Iran. Trump has launched a potentially brutal trade fight with Canada, a longtime ally he has trolled as becoming the 51st American state.

“He’s executing Xi’s wedge tactics for him, and along the way, helping Xi to tell a story about China as the more stable and responsible power,” Kovrig said. “It’s led to a wave of Western leaders visiting Beijing and seeking to stabilize and improve their relations with Xi so they can focus more on dealing with problems Trump is causing them.”

Trump can point to some symbolic wins from having a pleasant relationship with Xi.

# Clancy, wife address theories, starting a family

►**CLANCY**  
*Continued from Page A1*

with a hung jury earlier this month.

He spoke at length about his grief, his decision to forgive Lindsay, and the online conspiracy theories he said have distracted from the legacy of his children and the issue of perinatal mental health.

Clancy said his forgiveness came in part from his belief that Lindsay’s mental illness caused her to kill their children.

“I saw headlines that said, you know, ‘Killer Mom,’ and ‘Baby Murderer,’ ‘Monster.’ And none of [them] were accurate,” Clancy said. “I believe that it was her mental illness that caused that.”

He said he also felt that forgiving her was necessary for him to move forward.

“I think when it comes to forgiveness, I also felt that if I didn’t get there, I would be eaten up inside forever,” Clancy said.

Clancy said he once asked Lindsay whether she remembered killing their children. She told him, “it was like a dream,” he said, and that she remembered it like someone would remember a dream after waking up.

Lindsay Clancy has admitted through counsel that she strangled Cora, 5, Dawson, 3, and 8-month-old Callan. She has argued she was suffering from postpartum psychosis at the time and should not be held criminally responsible.

Her murder trial ended in a mistrial on Sept. 4 after jurors were unable to reach a verdict. Patrick Clancy was the prosecu-

‘I think when it comes to forgiveness, I also felt that if I didn’t get there, I would be eaten up inside forever.’

PATRICK CLANCY, *in “60 Minutes” interview Sunday.*

tion’s first witness.

During the “60 Minutes” interview, Patrick Clancy described Lindsay’s worsening mental health in the months before the killings, including sleeplessness, severe depression, and intrusive thoughts.

He said he knew little about postpartum mental illness, as Lindsay made repeated emergency room visits and sought psychiatric treatment.

“I could piece together what it was like to be really, really anxious or depressed, but I didn’t know how to manage a postpartum illness,” Clancy said. “I think mental illness has this ability to be tragically deceptive. So I’m sure there are things that I didn’t see.”

Lindsay checked herself into McLean Psychiatric Hospital on New Year’s Eve of 2022, where she stayed for five days and was treated for depression before being released.

On Jan. 24, 2023, after Patrick left the family’s home to run



60 MINUTES/CBS NEWS

In his first television interview, Patrick Clancy spoke with “60 Minutes” about grief and the memories of his children.

an errand and pick up dinner, he returned to find Lindsay injured in the backyard after jumping from an upstairs window. He then found their three children strangled in the basement.

Cora and Dawson were dead. Callan initially survived and was airlifted to Boston Children’s Hospital.

Clancy said he clung to hope after learning doctors had restored Callan’s heartbeat.

“I really thought there was a chance that Callan would live,” Clancy said. “I remember just thinking, ‘Just gimme one. Just gimme one kid, and I would raise him as best I could, and I would give him the best life I possibly could.’”

Callan survived for four days.

Clancy said his son lay beside him at the hospital as he was telling him, “I’m so sorry.”

“And he died in my arms,” Clancy said.

During those final hours, Clancy wrote tributes to each of

his three children, typing with one hand while holding Callan’s hand in the other. He told “60 Minutes” he feared that if he did not write about them, they would be forgotten.

In the months that followed, Clancy said his grief became so overwhelming that he did not believe he would live to see his 35th birthday. He contemplated suicide himself;

“And I was completely fine with it,” he said.

Unable to stay in Duxbury, Clancy moved to New York City, where he said the anonymity gave him room to grieve.

He recalled going to St. Patrick’s Cathedral on what would have been Callan’s first birthday. He lit a candle and said, “I love you, buddy.”

When he walked back out onto Fifth Avenue, he began to cry. “And nobody cared,” Clancy said.

Asked whether he was grateful for that, Clancy said he real-

ized, “This is where I need to be. I need to grieve.”

He kept some of his children’s toys and personal belongings, which are now placed around his Manhattan apartment.

“Just things that reminded me of them,” Clancy said.

In Duxbury, a playground was also built with features honoring each of the children.

Clancy said he still dreams about them.

“All the time,” he said.

He met Danis, a 37-year-old reproductive medicine doctor, in a New York run club in January 2024. Danis said the two later went for coffee, where she noticed a photograph of children on the wallpaper of Clancy’s cellphone.

“I just asked, ‘Who are those cuties?’ And Pat said, ‘Those are my kids;’” Danis recalled.

She asked whether they lived in Massachusetts.

“Pat said, ‘They died;’” she said.

Their relationship deepened as they continued running together, and they married in New York City in April.

“My life has changed since I met Rachel in such a positive way,” Clancy said.

Danis said she tries to help Clancy carry his grief while continuing to honor his children.

“I know I can’t fix — I can’t bring his kids back,” she said. “But if I can honor them and allow Pat to grieve but also just continue to honor them in the present, I guess that’s all I can do.”

Clancy also pushed back on conspiracy theories that spread

online during his ex-wife’s trial, including unfounded allegations that he was involved in his children’s deaths.

“It’s deeply harmful to the legacy of my children,” Clancy said. “It is a huge distraction from what really matters here, which is perinatal mental health. And it’s done real harm to real people, myself included but also others.”

Clancy said the online theories have made it a struggle to leave his home.

“It’s painful to see,” he said. “And it makes it difficult to be in public, and it’s possible that some of those people, after seeing lie after lie after lie, they start to believe it, and that’s what we’re left with.”

Clancy also addressed criticism of his demeanor while testifying at the trial. He said he suffered a severe panic attack during a break before prosecutors played his 911 call from the night his children were killed.

Clancy said he was taken to an ambulance and offered medication, but he declined it because he wanted to return to the courtroom to finish his testimony.

When asked if he felt he failed his family, Clancy said he believed he did his best.

“I think I did the best I could with what I had at the time,” Patrick Clancy said. “And I live with the outcome. I live with it every day.”

*Camilo Fonseca of the Globe staff contributed to this report.*

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# Minogue’s pouch pledge stirs concern on conflict of interest

►**MINOGUE**  
*Continued from Page A1*

wide range of stocks, including in President Trump’s Truth Social platform and airplane manufacturer Boeing Co., according to the disclosure.

Michael Siegel, a Tufts University public health professor, said he personally supports legalizing flavored tobacco products because he believes they could help people quit smoking. But he said any public official who is proposing policy that would impact a product in which they have a financial interest “really has a responsibility to divest.”

“That is a conflict of interest,” Siegel said. “... That is contrary to the way that our government should operate.”

While the nicotine pouches hardly register as a public issue compared to the cost of living and economic issues that dominate the current political debate, for Minogue, they symbolize how, in Democratic hands, Massachusetts stifles businesses through overregulation.

“The policy is a result of a number of discussions with Massachusetts voters, particularly voters in their 20s and 30s, who are frustrated [with] government over-regulation,” Minogue said of his position. “It’s absurd someone has to drive over state lines to purchase flavored ZYN when unflavored is legal. And it’s absurd that anyone would try to diminish voters’ concerns with this type of story.”

But his singling out of ZYN in particular also underscores how the great wealth of a candidate such as Minogue could create potential conflicts with policy-making.

ZYN and similar products are typically small bags placed in the gums that contain a powder made of nicotine, flavorings, and other ingredients. They were banned under a 2019 law halting the sale of flavored tobacco products that was signed by then-Governor Charlie Baker, a Republican, out of fears that young people in particular would become addicted to them. At the time, the measure was hailed as one of the nation’s toughest restrictions on the products.

One of the co-sponsors of the law, State Senator John Keenan, took issue with how Minogue framed the debate over regulating the pouches.

“To have somebody under the guise of saying that it’s personal freedom to ... reintroduce a very, very addictive product, I



KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

just think is irresponsible,” the Quincy Democrat said. “He’s putting a generation of young people at significant risk of addiction.”

In his 238-page financial disclosure, which covers his finances through the end of 2025, Minogue reported owning stock in Philip Morris International, British American Tobacco, and Japan Tobacco.

The three businesses are the world’s largest tobacco companies. Minogue also owns stock directly or through a business in the Altria Group, a US-based company that produces tobacco, cigarette, and medical products.

In a statement to the Globe, Minogue said he does not have “day-to-day involvement” in the investments. Elizabeth Hopkins, his campaign spokesperson,

said the tobacco-related stocks are held in managed accounts, including two that separately track the S&P 500 and MSCI EAFE, an index that covers mid-range and large companies around the world.

“Mike has delegated responsibility to investment managers,” Hopkins said in a statement.

This is common for wealthy people and ordinary investors

**Michael Minogue, Republican candidate for governor, campaigned in Amesbury earlier this month. Among his campaign promises is a pledge to once more allow the purchase of flavored nicotine pouches. That pledge has been advertised on T-shirts, with a logo that resembles a can of ZYN, one of the pouches and a subsidiary of Philip Morris International.**

alike, many of whom use index funds for their retirement and other investment vehicles and thus do not have direct control over those holdings.

Philip Morris International and the Altria Group are both included in the S&P 500, and each represents less than 0.5 percent of the index’s total value. British American Tobacco and Japan Tobacco are included in the MSCI EAFE, according to Hopkins.

In his disclosure, Minogue also reported that one or more trusts in which he, as well as his wife, Renee, or children, were beneficiaries owned stock valued at more than \$1,000 in Philip Morris International and the Altria Group.

But details on the amount of

tobacco-related stocks that Minogue holds are limited. The state disclosure only asks candidates for public office to report any investments they own that have a “fair market value” greater than \$1,000 — but not the actual value of those holdings at the time of the filing.

In his disclosure form, Minogue reported making at least \$818,000 in income from his investments in 2025.

Hopkins did not say how much Minogue’s tobacco-related stocks were worth or whether he would divest from Philip Morris International, the parent company of ZYN, should he win office in November.

A spokesperson for Philip Morris International did not respond to a request for comment.

Minogue has pledged to “deregulate” the sale of ZYN’s flavored nicotine pouches, although as governor he would not have authority to do so on his own.

Douglas Levy, director of policy research at Massachusetts General Hospital’s Tobacco Research and Treatment Center, said the state’s effort on tobacco control over decades “has kind of denormalized tobacco and nicotine use in the state.”

“That’s a positive thing for public health,” he said.

The ban, however, has irked retailers. Robert Mellion, executive director of the Massachusetts Package Stores Association, argued it’s taken a “highly profitable” product off the shelves even though federal law allows its sale.

“Small, independent neighborhood stores have faced immediate drops in tobacco revenues,” he said in a statement, arguing they’ve also seen a decline in “ancillary, in-store purchases that typically accompany those transactions.”

A spokesperson for the state Department of Public Health said reversing the restriction on flavored nicotine pouches would require the Democratic-led state Legislature to change the law.

State Representative Danielle Gregoire, a Marlborough Democrat who helped write the law, said nicotine pouches are a “new way for big tobacco and big nicotine to get a new generation hooked.”

“[Minogue] can’t just flip-pantly go around saying he’s going to deregulate things that are in place by law,” Gregoire said.

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EDITORIAL

They powered the state’s economy once.  
Can the Gateway Cities flourish again?

“Brick by brick: How the Commonwealth’s Gateway Cities can build better futures.” A seven-part series from *Globe Opinion*, coming every Monday this fall.

In a landmark 2007 report, the Massachusetts Institute for a New Commonwealth coined a new term for an old problem: Gateway Cities.

These were struggling cities — generally old mill and manufacturing towns — that nonetheless had clear potential to anchor their regional economies. Many of them still had the “bones” of the thriving cities they once were before jobs moved south or overseas: strong infrastructure, civic institutions, colleges, museums.

The report made the case that helping the cities rebound wasn’t just charity. They were “important assets” for the state, waiting to be rediscovered.

The theory was that sustained investment could catalyze economic revitalization, and that the benefits would flow both ways. Rebuilding these cities would contribute to the whole Commonwealth by producing regional hubs with jobs, transit, and much-needed housing, which would diversify the state’s Boston-centric economy.

Defining a “Gateway City” helped move that partnership into higher gear. The Gateway City designation has become enshrined in law, and 15 separate state programs now provide funding either exclusively to or with priority given to the 26 officially designated Gateway Cities.

Boston is the state’s economic and political capital. But it is wrestling with extremely high housing costs and constraints on new development, some of them self-imposed. For the state to really thrive, the Gateway Cities might be the key.

For those cities, the state now offers programs to pay for tree planting and park restoration, to subsidize construction of market-rate housing, to rehabilitate blighted properties, and to employ young people. Gateway Cities are prioritized in programs that offer tax incentives and technical assistance to growing businesses.

Have those programs worked? Nearly 20 years after the stepped-up emphasis on the state’s Gateway Cities began, the *Globe* is publishing a series of editorials that will explore what’s working in these communities — and where the state’s push to revitalize them may need fresh thinking.

There are clear success stories. These programs have paved the way to



State Sen. John Cronin stands in front of the Iver Johnson Mills complex in Fitchburg, an old bicycle factory that a developer is trying to turn into a housing.



build new housing in Lowell, create a biotech hub in Worcester, and revitalize Hyannis’s downtown, among other projects.

The populations of the Gateway Cities have risen over the last two decades, from 1.74 million people in 2005 to 1.96 million people in 2025. Some cities, like Quincy and Malden, are doing so well — and are indistinguishable from other Boston-area bedroom communities — they may no longer warrant the Gateway City designation.

Others have not been so lucky. While the median income in Gateway Cities has risen, according to a *Globe* analysis of public data, it’s grown slower than the median income in Massachusetts overall.

In the Gateway Cities of Springfield, Holyoke, New Bedford, Fall River, and Lawrence, the median income between 2020 and 2024 was below \$61,000 at a time when the statewide median income was \$113,900.

The 2025 unemployment rate in each of those cities was above 6 percent, while the statewide unemployment rate was 4.5 percent.

Some of the cities that have had the most underperforming schools are Gateway Cities, with Holyoke and Lawrence spending years in state receivership as Springfield experimented with a state-local partnership to improve its schools.

Ben Forman, director of MassINC’s Policy Center, said the Gateway Cities are a tale of “unbalanced growth.” There



Developer Jacob Zapata stands inside a vacant office building on Main Street in Fitchburg that he’s turning into market-rate housing.

have been investments in eastern Massachusetts cities like Lowell and Haverhill, but fewer in Western Massachusetts cities like Pittsfield and Springfield. “In some ways, we’ve only seen more concentration of wealth and economic activity in Boston,” Forman said.

A walk along Main Street in downtown Fitchburg shows the promise and pitfalls of Gateway Cities.

A century ago, Fitchburg was a regional economic and political powerhouse. In the 1800s and 1900s, paper mills proliferated along the banks of the Nashua River. Main Street was populated by banks, lawyers, doctors, and professionals. In the 1930s, both Massachusetts’ US Senators — Marcus Coolidge and David Walsh — lived in Fitchburg.

But as mills began closing in the 1960s, driven by deindustrialization, offices emptied out. Main Street became a shell, filled with vacant storefronts.

State Senator John Cronin, a Fitch-

burg Democrat who cochairs the Legislature’s Gateway Cities caucus, said a decade ago, most leading citizens would have probably agreed to raze Main Street. In December 2015, The Fay Club, an ornate Gilded Age mansion on Main Street that had been a private social club went on the market for \$525,000 and couldn’t attract a buyer.

But Fitchburg also boasts assets not all communities have. It has a commuter rail link to Boston, one legacy of its industrial past, with most trips taking about 90 minutes. It has a state university. It has an art museum, Victorian mansions, and easy access to a hospital in nearby Leominster.

With help from state programs, including some targeted specifically at Gateway Cities, the empty storefronts today are interspersed with apartment construction and businesses — a bar arcade, a bookstore, dive bars, restaurants. According to state data, Fitchburg added 112 units to its housing stock between November 2024 and November 2025, and more are under construction or in the planning stages. The Fay Club reopened as a private social club, serving meals and hosting social functions in the wood-paneled dining room.

Fitchburg developer Jacob Zapata of T&T Construction is converting six Main Street buildings from vacant offices to market-rate housing. The building where Walsh once practiced law is being turned into 34 apartments over a co-working space. A 1890s YMCA that later housed a utility company is becoming a restaurant and 17 units. An old bank has been converted to five apartments over a bookstore. Rents in Zapata’s new buildings tend to be around \$2,100 a month for a two-bedroom.

The key to making projects financially viable, Zapata said, is tax credits and grants. According to data compiled by Cronin, Fitchburg housing projects have gotten money from the state’s Housing Development Incentive Program, a program first enacted in 2010 that gives tax credits to redevelop market-rate housing in Gateway Cities; from MassDevelopment’s Underutilized Properties Program to rehabilitate blighted properties; from tax credits for historic properties; from tax credits for commercial conversions; and from other public subsidy programs.

Most of Fitchburg’s downtown housing today is deed-restricted for low-income residents, but city officials want to build more market-rate housing. Main Street is near Fitchburg State University and the commuter rail. Regional employers include manufacturing companies, the university, and a hospital.

To be sure, Fitchburg still has its problems. Its unemployment rate — 5.8 percent in 2025 — is higher than the state average unemployment rate. Its median income, \$73,040 between 2020 and 2024, is below the state average. But Fitchburg has been growing, from 40,500 people in 2015 to 42,100 in 2025.

The last 20 years have shown that Gateway Cities can forge new identities. The challenge for the next 20 years will be to build on that progress, leveraging state resources to find new industry clusters to boost economically depressed regions, to convert vacant spaces to housing, and to improve failing schools. And the last two decades have shown how making Massachusetts’ Gateway Cities stronger can strengthen the entire Commonwealth.

Unemployment rate in Fitchburg

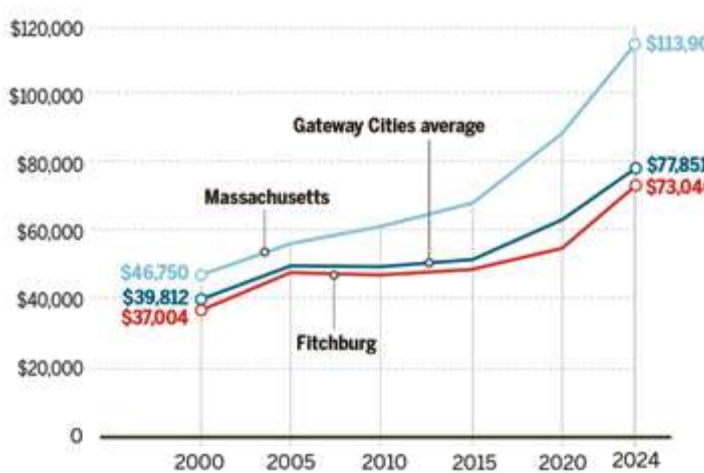
Fitchburg has, on average, had higher unemployment rates than other Gateway Cities and Massachusetts overall.



SOURCE: Division of Local Services (DLS) and MA Department of Economic Research  
DATA: Sidhi Dhandra for the Boston Globe; CHART: Heather Hopp-Bruce/Globe Staff

Median income in Fitchburg

Workers in Fitchburg earn, on average, less than workers in other Gateway Cities and workers statewide.



SOURCE: Federal Reserve Economic Data and US Census Data website (American Community Surveys)  
DATA: Sidhi Dhandra for the Boston Globe; CHART: Heather Hopp-Bruce/Globe Staff

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INBOX

A tough assignment: Getting students to read

Why do novels matter? Because fiction is an empathy engine.

Re “Novels (check phone) now too much (check) for distracted teens (check)” by John Hilliard (Page A1, Sept. 16): This headline caught my attention because I’m a novelist myself.

Fiction is an empathy engine. A novel invites readers to engage with characters, places, sometimes entire worlds they can’t otherwise experience. It allows them access to other people’s thoughts, emotions, and attitudes — their interiority. This can lead to deeper understanding of others and sometimes to discovery of other layers in the readers themselves.

Books are assigned through language arts classes, to teach comprehension skills, improve vocabulary, pass tests — all very useful. But that’s not why books are written, and not at all what makes them worth reading.

Some schools use the empathy element deliberately, assigning texts that relate to what students are learning in social studies or in other classes, to give students additional insight into the complex human situations of history and society.

On the Opinion page of the same edition of the Globe (“At the US Open, a master class in masculinity”), columnist Renée Graham refers to the denigration of empathy in modern America. Maybe it’s time to double down on assigning novels, for exactly this reason. If fiction’s unique magic is teaching empathy, it’s precisely what we need more of.

ELAINE ISAAK  
Nashua

Is this the end of reading? The plot thickens.

“Students’ reluctance to read has prompted teachers across the country to stop assigning as many full-length books and spend less time discussing literature,” writes John Hilliard in “Novels (check phone) now too much (check) for distracted teens (check)” (Page A1, Sept. 16). The article generated more than 125 comments on BostonGlobe.com. Following is an edited sample:

If you allow kids to have a screen in front of their face 24/7, this is what happens. The truth is that technology has evolved faster than our capacity to deal with it as humans. Our kids are the canaries in the mine shafts, warning us that we need to take a step back and manage technology better. But good luck with that. Greed and hubris are driving us off the cliff. Just look at AI, once touted as the solution to so many of our problems but now an existential threat to our existence.

SWAN MAN  
BostonGlobe.com

The key is to read to your kids when they are young, right before they go to bed. It creates a bond with your child and gives them motivation to want to learn how to read. Best piece of advice I got about parenting.

AHOYA  
BostonGlobe.com

The actual key is for kids to see their parents going to the library and reading their own books. And going to libraries and making it fun. Modern libraries have so much more than just books.

HANSCOME  
BostonGlobe.com

I work with adults with advanced degrees who proudly admit that they haven’t read a book in years because “Who has time?” They seem well informed in all the sports though.

NASOCHKAS  
BostonGlobe.com

We were part of the “wait till 8” crowd (no cellphone until eighth grade), I am in two book clubs, I read every night. My kid still has no interest. I can’t even find a literature class for him to take in college. They are rarely offered, and he’s at a decent school.

FEET1STINABOX  
BostonGlobe.com

So you think there’s nothing to be done? It’s like a muscle, it needs to be exercised. Besides, allowing [young people] to have the attention span of a gnat is going to adversely affect them in all areas of their lives. Reading is a good place to start. I know everyone wants to focus on classic literature, but you need to start with something they can really enjoy and is more contemporary. Then move to more classic stories and draw the connections.

SANDY68  
BostonGlobe.com

Oh my gosh. Who will populate the next generation of book clubs?

BOSTON RUNNER  
BostonGlobe.com

EPA goes all in on heating the planet. Care to respond, Democrats?

Re “EPA halts carbon emission rules on power plants” (Page A2, Sept. 15): Last week’s move by the Environmental Protection Agency is devastating for our country and the planet.

According to Lee Zeldin, the head of the EPA, “this is just the beginning.” According to the New York Times article that was reprinted in the Globe, “Environmental and energy experts criticized the move, which has been in the works since last spring.” That’s rational. What’s irrational is that I’ve heard little criticism from Democrats of this move or other Republican climate polices as we approach the midterms. We’re less than two months away from the election, and the climate crisis doesn’t seem to be on the ballot.

Zeldin has publicly declared that the United States is going all in on warming the planet. Hopefully this latest massive assault will wake the Democrats up.

MICHAEL DEAN  
Marshfield

JASON MARGOLIS

Trump’s trade war has come for youth hockey

For most of us, the latest trade spat between the United States and Canada is a mere abstraction.

But when you look at the long list of items the White House is slapping tariffs on, and you see something that you regularly purchase, suddenly the trade war feels a lot less theoretical. In my case, that would be ice hockey equipment, now subject to a 50 percent tariff when imported from Canada.

Every hockey parent knows the preseason drill. If your kid has grown a few inches, you head back to the store to get the next size shoulder pads, shin guards, stick, gloves, elbow pads, skate pants, and maybe skates and helmet. Later, you compare notes with other hockey parents, commiserating on how close you came to breaking the \$1,000 mark and lamenting that your kid didn’t choose swimming.

Yes, we look for deals and used gear, but finding equipment in decent shape, that isn’t too smelly, and will keep your kid well protected isn’t always easy.

For more than a decade, my son and I would go to Sports Etc. in Arlington, where the owner, Paul Stanton, patiently explained to me, a California native, how to outfit a hockey player.

A quick primer on tariffs: As much as President Trump likes to say that tariffs are penalties put on another country, which they are, they are basically import taxes. And it’s the customer who often pays higher prices in the end.

Most ice hockey gear is imported from China. Because of Trump’s earlier tariffs on that nation, Stanton said, “We’ve seen an increase of retail prices across the board.”

I can attest: It’s real. When your kid breaks his stick on the ice, which happens a lot, there goes another \$300, thanks, in part, to 20 percent tariffs on Chinese-built sticks.

Stanton always kept my son in gear at reasonable price points. But for his serious customers, boys and girls chasing big ice dreams, this latest round of tariffs is going to hurt — high-end, custom goalie equipment comes from Canada. Stanton said it used to cost about \$2,000 to outfit a goalie. With tariffs, that’s now \$3,000.

For equipment that’s been purchased but hasn’t come across the border yet, those added import duties will come out of Stanton’s pocket. “We’re going to have to absorb those increases because we’ve already quoted prices to the consumer.”

I’m out of the woods: My son isn’t a goalie and he graduated high school in the spring. But I feel for my friends still making the pilgrimage to Stanton’s store. And for Stanton.



ASTA/ADOBE STOCK

During his first term, Trump’s stated goal behind tariffs was to revive American manufacturing. That hasn’t worked. Comparing January 2016, when Trump first took office, with today, the needle hasn’t budged: there are still roughly 12 million people working in manufacturing in this country.

Economists have been in near unanimity that tariffs are a crude tool — they punish consumers, small businesses, and farmers — and have strongly and repeatedly urged Trump not to go down the tariff road.

With the latest round of import duties against Canada, Trump invoked Section 338 of the Tariff Act of 1930 “in response to Canada’s discriminatory treatment of American products.”

“This is a ridiculous argument since countries export goods for which they have a comparative advantage (we don’t grow pineapples in New England),” said Michael Klein, an economist at the Tufts Fletcher School and executive editor of the nonpartisan website EconoFact.

Why the White House is targeting Canadian hockey equipment is a bit of a mystery. The US Trade Representative did not respond to my request for clarification.

Economist Chris Douglas, professor of economics at the University of Michigan-Flint, said targeting hockey gear is “mostly for the symbolism, I suspect, like renaming ‘Lake Ontario’ to ‘Lake America.’”

But Douglas warned that import duties on other items — auto parts, plywood, lumber, steel, and aluminum — are no joke. The US and Canadian auto industries are deeply intertwined and cannot easily be unraveled. If car prices go up, sales could fall, and jobs will be lost. Or take Canadian plywood. Building homes in the United States, particularly in border states like Maine, will become costly.

Many pundits assume this is more Trump brinkmanship, trying to extract concessions from an adversary — or in this case, a friend turned into an adversary. But what if this trade war lingers or continues to escalate?

“I’m very concerned about that,” said Stanton, who worries about the impacts on youth hockey. “We’re trying to grow the game. ... This type of background noise or white noise you’re getting from all these tariffs is definitely going to scare people away.”

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SHIRA SCHOENBERG

Private insurance didn’t solve long-term care. Can government do better?

Massachusetts is on the brink of a caregiving crisis. As baby boomers age, middle-class residents struggle to pay for the care that they need.

Governor Maura Healey signed a law in August creating a commission to study long-term care, as some advocates push for the creation of a taxpayer-funded long-term care insurance program.

But prior attempts to solve the problem of paying for long-term care have run into brick walls. A 1988 expansion of Medicare to include short-term coverage of nursing home and home health care was repealed 16 months after it was passed, largely because of the unpopularity of paying for it by raising taxes on the elderly. The 2010 Affordable Care Act’s long-term care insurance program was repealed in 2012 based on projections that it wouldn’t be financially solvent.

And while public efforts have faltered, the answer doesn’t lie entirely with the private market, which has also floundered financially. Private long-term care insurance companies, which proliferated in the 1990s, have stopped offering new plans and are raising rates exorbitantly.

“I think the private industry had a chance to provide the best option, and for a whole bunch of different reasons it doesn’t seem to have worked out,” said Sean Collins, a Boston attorney who represents consumers in disputes with long-term care insurance companies.

As the Massachusetts commission begins its work, this context will be important to determine what works and what doesn’t as policy makers seek to create a financially sustainable system that makes care accessible.

The most promising effort to address long-term care financing came in the 1980s and 1990s, when companies began offering insurance to cover expenses Medicare didn’t — first nursing home care, then home health care, according to a 2013 study of the industry. By the late 1990s, that study found, more than 100 companies were selling long-term care insurance. In 2002, 750,000 individual policies were sold. Some employers offered workers the opportunity to buy in-

surance through payroll deductions.

The problem, however, was that the assumptions companies made when determining how to price products were incorrect, the study found. They hadn’t accurately predicted lifespans, interest rates, and how many policy holders would drop plans. By the 2000s, companies found these policies weren’t profitable. By 2012, only 11 companies were selling a significant number of new policies. Only 223,000 policies were sold in 2011.

Companies also began raising rates on existing policies. A 2022 national survey of long-term care insurance companies found that 19 of 20 surveyed companies had increased rates since a prior survey was done in 2016. The average rate increase approved by states’ insurance regulators, as documented in the 2022 survey, was 29 percent, which was lower than the average 42 percent rate increase documented in the 2016 study. According to 2023 data, new plans’ premiums cost around \$3,300 annually.

American Council of Life Insurers spokesperson Whit Cornman said many of the earliest long-term care insurance policies were priced when insurers had limited experience forecasting how claims would develop over decades. “In fact, long-term care inflation has heavily outpaced general economic inflation, making benefits more expensive to provide than originally anticipated and leading some insurers to seek premium adjustments,” Cornman said.

Attorneys like Collins see an effort by insurers to get consumers to drop plans. For example, Collins pointed to an investor presentation by insurance company CNA (which Collins’s firm sued over price increases), touting that its premiums are 93 percent higher than their original pricing and 84,000 policy holders reduced coverage between 2017 and 2025. (The company isn’t selling new policies.)

Sometimes, companies offer consumers options to avoid paying higher rates — reducing benefits, letting a policy lapse with benefits capped at what they’ve paid in, or taking a cash buyout.

“It seems like a classic cautionary tale of an insurance product gone wrong,” Collins said.

Collins also alleges that insurers try to make claiming benefits difficult. He points to Mitzi Gilbert, whose mother had a long-term care insurance policy with John Hancock for 32 years. In 2024, Gilbert tried to file a claim for her mother, who was living in a Hingham care facility and had kidney disease, memory problems, and other ailments. Gilbert told me the insurance company kept requesting additional information. Five months after she applied, the company finally approved benefits — then rescinded them a week later, apparently based on a Zoom interview with her mother. After hiring Collins, Gilbert’s claim was approved. Her mother died in 2025.

Gilbert said she felt the process was “set up to fail. ... They fought every little piece of the way,” Gilbert said. (John Hancock didn’t respond to a request for comment.)

Complaints about claims denials are largely anecdotal. A 2010 study found independent auditors agreed with insurers’ decisions to approve or deny claims 92 to 93 percent of the time and only disagreed 1 to 3 percent of the time.

Study author Marc Cohen, co-director of the LeadingAge LTSS Center at the University of Massachusetts Boston, said the evidence “did not support widespread allegations that insurers were routinely denying valid claims.” Cohen said there has not been an updated study since then, but he has not seen data suggesting that there have been substantial changes in claims practices.

But complaints do occur, including in Massachusetts. According to the Massachusetts Division of Insurance, between Jan. 1, 2024, and Aug. 5, 2026, the division received 165 complaints about long-term care insurance, including 46 about premium increases, 31 about claim delays, and 30 about claim denials.

As more older adults need care, many will need help paying for it. If the private insurance system failed, policy makers considering public alternatives need to answer: How and why can government do better?

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# T's accessibility fixes will need their own fixes

## ►ACCESS

*Continued from Page A1*

the new trolleys.

At the T, the decision to soldier on with the ongoing platform upgrades is based on a cost-benefit analysis.

Laura Brelsford, the agency's assistant general manager of systemwide accessibility, said her team is "laser-focused" on delivering accessibility on the Green Line sooner, even though additional construction is expected in the future.

T officials said Saturday that the work slated for the future will be less disruptive than the current construction, and disputed that it constituted redoing the work that they're currently performing.

The issue now is most pressing on the C branch, where the T is spending \$51 million to extend platforms in Brookline to 7½ feet wide and raise them 8 inches to accommodate the Green Line cars currently in use, and their accordion-style doors.

"We know for sure that when we go to level boarding [with the Type 10 trains], it's not just going to be as easy as pouring 6 inches of concrete," Brelsford said. "That said, we've tried to set ourselves up for success in the future."

It's a frustrating development in an otherwise steady drumbeat of efforts to improve accessibility across the system. Since a landmark 2006 accessibility settlement, the T says it has dramatically reduced how frequently riders with disabili-

'You can argue that it's not great to redo in a decade. But the work being done now allows the T to have universal accessibility 10 years faster than it otherwise would.'

BRIAN KANE, *executive director of MBTA advisory board*

ties are denied service on trains and buses over 20 years.

But the Green Line is a stubborn sticking point in that progress. Nearly all its stations were built before the Americans with Disabilities Act was signed into law in 1990. Today, of its 70 total stations, 23 are considered inaccessible because they do not have appropriate platforms, elevators, or other accommodations.

By roughly 2030, only the Boylston and Hynes Convention Center stations in the heart of Boston will not be accessible, because they would require an expensive upgrade — roughly \$200 million, Brelsford estimated.

The T officially announced its large-scale effort to overhaul Green Line accessibility in May, almost four years after it final-



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

The Summit Avenue stop on the Green Line C branch is one of the stations receiving improvements to accessibility.

ized the \$810 million contract to purchase the new Green Line Type 10 cars.

The incoming fleet of cars will be the most accessible trains on the Green Line by far. They are level inside, with no stairs in between sections of seats, and they will feature additional informational screens for riders, Brelsford said.

But the incompatibility between those new trains and the platform upgrades is something the T would have ideally

"thought about ... in advance," said Naomi Hess, a Green Line rider and power wheelchair user.

"The improvements being done currently on the C branch will help people now, and it's important to recognize that," Hess said. "But I do think it's frustrating that the improvements will have to be reversed down the line."

It's particularly difficult because the Green Line has been closed often this year. Some

parts of the line were shut down for 78 days through August, more than any other branch, a Globe analysis found.

During these closures the T is working on a range of improvements, including signal work and track repairs, along with accessibility.

The T is planning to suspend service again for nine consecutive days starting Sept. 26 on parts of all four branches of the Green Line. Service again will be shut down over the Hallow-

een weekend.

The accessibility work underway on the line now is expensive. The design and planning for upgrades on the B branch has a \$74 million budget. The project on the E branch, where four stations — Back-of-the-Hill, Fenwood Road, Mission Park, and Riverway — have no platforms at all, is budgeted for \$285 million of construction.

The wholesale renovation of the Symphony Station, closed for three years for accessibility upgrades, will cost \$170 million in all, including \$66 million from a federal grant.

Brian Kane, executive director of the MBTA advisory board, said it's worthwhile for the agency to pursue the platform upgrades on the Green Line, because its branches may not run entirely on Type 10 cars for years.

"You can argue that it's not great to redo in a decade," he said. "But the work being done now allows the T to have universal accessibility 10 years faster than it otherwise would."

Others are not excited for the prospect of another round of lengthy shutdowns. April Gabriel, owner of the Boston General Store in Coolidge Corner, said she's "nervous" about the prospect of further disruption on the C branch.

"It's poor planning on the T's part," she said.

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# Angry bicyclists take matters — and duct tape — into own hands

## ►BIKES

*Continued from Page A1*

driver who ran a red light near the same intersection on Wednesday, City Councilor Erin Murphy says she wants the tape removed, saying it may have made the street, which cyclists have complained about for years, even more dangerous.

"Privately installed changes to traffic patterns that have not been reviewed or approved by City engineers can create confusion and potential safety risks," Murphy wrote to Chris Osgood, the city's interim chief of streets, after she unsuccessfully tried to have the City Council hold an emergency hearing on the makeshift lane.

Her emergency order was filed past deadline, but is on the agenda for next week's meeting, she said.

Murphy's comments drew a sharp response from cycling advocacy groups, who said her focus on the unsanctioned bike lane distracts from the need for prompt safety upgrades.

"Whether or not it's the right thing to do, it was a thing that I guess folks decided to do because safe streets are not happening fast enough," said Tiffany Cogell, interim executive director of the Boston Cyclists Union, which is located a block from the makeshift bike lane.

"If you push people hard enough, long enough, they are going to find ways to activate the answers and the actions that they're calling for," she added.

Cogell said her group was not responsible for the duct tape bike lane, which appeared Aug. 30, and she wasn't sure who was.

The lane runs along one side of the street, heading downhill on Tremont Street toward Roxbury Crossing, where it appears to block a portion of a parking space before continuing across a crosswalk at the intersection, taking up roughly half a dozen car lengths in total.

Bike advocates have used such protests, known as "tactical urbanism," in Boston for years to show where city infrastructure is lacking and push for change, said Maha Aslam, transit and streets program manager for LiveableStreets Alliance, where Gag worked for a time.

"Inherently, a bunch of residents coming together to make themselves feel safer while they're biking down the street is OK," Aslam said.

In 2015, cyclist Jonathan Fertig used potted plants to create a temporary bike lane divider near the site of a crash that killed a biker on Massachusetts Avenue. Officials later replaced the pots with plastic posts.



PHOTOS BY DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Peter Cheung, who has placed about three dozen ghost bikes since 2015, looked over a recent one, at the Roxbury site where transportation planner Louisa Gag was killed. Bike safety advocates have expanded a bike lane and posted a sign at the site.

Since then, activists have lined roadways on a number of occasions to form "human bike lanes," beginning with a 2017 protest for upgrades to the Congress Street Bridge.

"Tape on a street isn't going to make it more unsafe than it already was," Cogell said, urging Murphy and others to "focus on making those infrastructure improvements happen rather than trying to drum up hearings and legislation that will vilify people who have been asking for something for years to save lives."

Zachary Yaro, a 32-year-old member of the Cyclists Union who rode past the makeshift lane on Thursday, said the markings are "an improvement over nothing."

He said the design mirrors many bike lanes he's seen in Somerville, making the outrage over it feel "like a distraction from the actual issue."

As other bikers rode through the intersection on Thursday, many followed the lane marked off by dozens of white and green tape strips, though some drivers cut through it as they made right turns.

Murphy said her concern over the bike lane was raised by Wednesday's crash, in which the driver was issued a citation for failing to stop or yield, police said. The scooter rider is recovering from his injuries, city offi-



cials said.

Murphy was added to an email chain that day by a resident imploring her, Osgood, and other City Council members to remove the unsanctioned bike lane citing safety concerns, she said.

The resident previously emailed Osgood on Aug. 30 about the tape. Marcela Dwork, a spokesperson for Wu, said Friday that was when officials were notified about it.

Dwork added the city re-

sponded to that inquiry the day it was sent, promising to remove the lane. A copy of the resident's correspondence shows they emailed again on Sept. 11 asking why it was still there.

In her letter, Murphy asked Osgood to evaluate whether the makeshift lane may have contributed to the latest collision. But dashcam video of the incident, shared with the Globe by a witness to the crash, appears to show the crash happened in the middle of the street.

The scooter rider was attempting to cross Tremont when a gray sedan sped through a red light, crashing into him near the center line and sending him flying through the air, the video showed.

In a call Friday, Murphy said even though the bike lane didn't influence the crash, unapproved road changes still make city streets less safe.

"This area needs attention, and we can't just let people take it into their own hands," she

said.

On a pole a few feet away from the bike lane, the anonymous note titled "If Wu Won't, We Will!" said protesters had created the lane after Gag's death in July because "knowledgeable and skilled street designers," did not step in to ensure "the same tragedy didn't befall anyone else."

"Unfortunately, Mayor Wu hasn't let them do their jobs since early 2025," the note said. Wu began requiring her personal approval on many street infrastructure projects last year, leading to substantial slowdowns.

Following Gag's death, Wu committed to installing more concrete bike lane barriers and making other road improvements, also pledging to have street officials receive more input on how to speed safety projects.

Murphy expressed some sympathy with the protesters.

"They obviously felt that nobody was listening to them," she said.

On Friday, the cyclist's union said that they agreed with Murphy's call for a professional solution and that they look forward to attending her hearing to voice their concerns.

City officials added that they have continued evaluating safety along the intersection and Tremont Street corridor and will continue to work with residents, local leaders, and advocates on improving safety in the area and enforcing traffic laws.

On Friday morning, the lane remained in place, although a city worker on a bike arrived around 9 a.m. to take photos and measurements.

Wu officials said the city plans to remove and replace the tape once they've finalized design changes for the area, which are being developed by the city's Streets Cabinet.

In the meantime, bikers say they plan to hold officials to account if they don't follow through.

On Thursday night, 59-year-old Nathan Phillips, a professor at Boston University, stopped his bike at the intersection to add red tape to reinforce the bike lane design.

The color was "fitting for the blood that has been shed," he said.

"If they remove it, I'd be someone who'd come right back out and put it down again," Phillips added, before riding away.

*Niki Griswold of the Globe staff contributed. Bryan Hecht can be reached at bryan.hecht@globe.com. Follow him on Instagram bhechtjournalism.*

Forum ‘an enduring way for us to engage’  
Holy Cross program fosters civil discourse

By Michaela Towfighi  
GLOBE STAFF

A month after the Oct. 7 Hamas attack on Israel, before a small gathering formed on the quad in support of Palestine and encampments spread across other campuses, students at the College of the Holy Cross came together in the campus center for a conversation.

The topic was tense and would only grow to be more contentious, but the premise was simple: to talk about the war in Gaza in an open conversation among community members.

In an age of a rampant digitized democracy — where artificial intelligence can distort fact from fiction and social media provides a platform to brawl behind screens — Holy Cross has gone back to basics. Now in their fourth year, themed “Dialogue Dinners” invite students to engage in constructive discourse, led by a student facilitator, that begins with an acknowledgement that the conversation should start from a point of curiosity, not critique.

Days after Charlie Kirk was assassinated, students gathered to talk about political violence. They have debated artificial intelligence and dissected cancel culture. When Dr. Anthony Fauci, a Holy Cross alum, came to campus last year, he wanted to participate, too, talking with students about public health.

“It has become such an enduring way for us to engage,” said Daniel Klinghard, the dean of education and academic experience. “Institutionally, this is how we do it in response to big events that happen. This is a way that we can work through this.”

Holy Cross was not included in the most recent rankings of college campuses from the Foundation for Individual Rights and Expression. But the report found that among 63,000 students at 262 four-year colleges nationwide, nearly half said they would feel uncomfortable expressing their opinion on a controversial topic in a campus space — like a dinning hall or quad – and more than half would refrain from doing so in the classroom.

The old adage is to not talk about

**HOLY CROSS, Page B4**

Macklemore, Yom Kippur, and the days of shock, awe  
Feud with Kraft sparks reflection

By Brooke Hauser  
GLOBE STAFF

Yom Kippur ends the stretch of 10 days beginning with Rosh Hashanah that Jews call the Days of Awe. But this year, the awe is accompanied by shock, thanks to a public showdown between a rapper and a football magnate.

The feud between Macklemore and Robert Kraft was instant clickbait. But in a strange way it also has the makings of a sermon, one that practically wrote itself leading up to the Day of Atonement. For Jewish people who observe the holiday, it’s a time to fast, reflect, and repent — and it has particular resonance this year for unexpected reasons.

For many, Macklegate has been an entry point into a collective reckoning for, not just the Jewish community, but practically anyone with an internet connection. It has surfaced age-old questions about affliction and forgiveness, while sparking debate about who, exactly, needs to make amends.

As Israel continues to attack Gaza, the answer might seem obvious to its critics. But for many American Jews of a certain age, the shock is one of realization: that much of the world has turned against the Jewish state so completely in the three years since Oct. 7, 2023, despite the history of the Holocaust, the pogroms, and millennia of persecution that help explain why (and how) modern Israel came to exist.

**MACKLEMORE, Page B4**



PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF



**BOOKS GALORE** — Yinou, 6, took a rest as her mother sorted through the books that she had chosen at the Boston Teachers Union 13th annual Back to School Fair in Dorchester on Sunday. At left, Derek Lam, 3, of Quincy clutched his book bag tightly while gathering his reading material. The event included more than 40,000 free books for students, BPS families, and educators. **B2**

‘I liked Wade Boogs a lot, and he just happened to play for them, so I became a fan. The rest is history.’

BRANDON PARR *project manager at Edge Homes who named streets in a Utah subdivision for Red Sox players*

It’s a virtual Fenway Park West in this Utah development  
Pesky Lane, Pedroia Street, Varitek Drive stand out large in Salt Lake City suburb

By Camilo Fonseca  
GLOBE STAFF

On the edge of the wind-scoured Salt Lake Valley, between rows of gray and white houses and sunbaked driveways, you can find a little taste of Fenway Park.

A housing subdivision in Herriman, Utah, is turning heads online for its streets, each of which bears the name of a Red Sox star from the annals of team history: Pesky Lane, Pedroia Street, and Varitek Drive, to name a few.

The names, which could be ripped straight from the banners on Van Ness Street, stand out in a place like Herriman, a Salt Lake City suburb 500 miles

from the nearest Major League Baseball stadium. There’s little else to suggest Copper Fields, a neat grid of roughly 200 houses completed by Edge Homes in 2024, has a link to Boston.

But once social media caught wind of the Sox-heavy ‘hood over the weekend, fans were ablaze with speculation.

“Ready to blow my savings and move to Utah so I can live on Pedroia Street,” one commenter wrote on X, posting an image of a three-bed, three-bath home on sale for \$669,000 (slightly cheaper than a 700-square-

foot condo in the South End).

“[I don’t care] about getting priced out of Boston,” opined Anna Caruso of Section 10, a Red Sox podcast, beneath a photo of the development. “You’ll find me here.”

Another commenter said that, in person, the neighborhood is “brand-new and pretty nice,” though “all of the houses look basically the same.”

“I wonder what [percentage] of families that live here have no idea what the streets mean,” they added.

So, who’s behind all these names?

There’s not much of a Red Sox connection in the area to speak of, aside from the fact that a young David Ortiz played with Salt Lake’s minor league team while still a Minnesota Twins prospect.

But that didn’t matter to Brandon Parr, the Edge Homes project manager who selected the names. Parr, 47, was born and raised in Utah — but he lives and breathes the Red Sox all the same.

“I liked Wade Boggs a lot, and he just happened to play for them, so I became a fan,” he said. “The rest is history.”

When Parr got the chance to name an entire new subdivision, his vision

**STREET NAMES, Page B3**

FROM RATS TO SUGAR PLUM FAIRY DREAMS  
Young Boston-area dancers audition for ‘Nutcracker’ roles at José Mateo Ballet Theatre

By Gitana Savage  
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

More than 100 kids from across Greater Boston swarmed José Mateo Ballet Theatre’s Cambridge studios over the weekend, hoping to land a role in the company’s 38th annual production of “The Nutcracker.”

With handwritten audition bibs safety-pinned to their leotards, children danced, skipped, and trotted their hearts out for a chance to take part in the holiday classic.

The auditions were split over two days, with children ages 6-12 auditioning Saturday and older dancers ages 13-18 taking the stage Sunday.

For 7-year-old Ava Babbist, Saturday marked her first audition, but she tried not to let her nerves get the better of her.

“I was kind of nervous, and kind of excited,” Babbist said. “It

**NUTCRACKER, Page B2**



JOHN TLUMACKI/BOSTON GLOBE

On Saturday, dancers in the 6-to-7 age group listened to instructions during auditions for the José Mateo Ballet Theatre’s ‘The Nutcracker’ production. The show will run from Dec. 5-20 at the Strand Theatre in Dorchester.

# Teachers union book fair aims to awaken the reading bug

**By Katie Cressman**  
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Over 40,000 books sat carefully stacked in rows throughout the Boston Teachers Union building in Dorchester, waiting to be read.

The books were organized into neat stacks and grouped by grade level. Students were able to pick out 10 free books to take home, while educators could walk away from the event with up to 30. There was something for everyone, with titles ranging from The National Geographic's Almanac to coloring and activity books.

Emily Ko from Boston, a volunteer at the union's 13th annual book fair, said that she's been

coming to the book fair for years.

"I used to come here and take books like everyone else because I loved reading," she said. "So my mom and I decided to come volunteer and hand books to people. Even now, I just walk around and see what books there are and what they have available."

Sunday's book fair was one of the most highly attended, according to the union's president Erik Berg. The event started in 2013, and is organized in coordination with First Book, a nonprofit that aims to deliver quality education to children in low-income communities.

"It's a fantastic day, and it re-

ally sets the tone for getting back to school," Berg said. "Sometimes we get jaded by the screens that are ubiquitous in our pockets, on our walls, and it's really heartening and refreshing to remember that [books] still bring out that joy," he said.

Truc Lai, the family engagement liaison for BPS, said that seeing her students around the room hunting for books was the highlight of the event for her.

"It's important to be in the community because it shows that I am part of the community and reading is important to me," she said.

Reading is the foundation of literacy, she explained. Her fa-

vorite teacher inspired Lai to get involved with education.

Governor Maura Healey also attended Sunday's book fair, speaking to attendees at the start of the event.

"There's nothing more important that we do than invest in kids and invest in their education," she said to the Globe.

She explained that while speaking with students about what careers they might want to pursue in the future, many wanted to become teachers themselves.

"It means they've seen their teacher and they're inspired by their teacher," she said.

Outside of the union building, Ashley Santiago, a middle

school English Language Arts teacher for Boston Public Schools, was waiting for a ride home with her new stack of books at her feet.

"Seeing the light bulb go off in kids' heads when they finally figure something out and then [getting] to be excited about that really motivates me," she said.

Sunday's fair was the first Santiago had ever attended and she picked out everything from picture books to chapter books to accommodate the different reading levels of her students, she said.

Santiago also picked out comic books to show her students that reading can also involve graphics and art.

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# Tiny ballerinas audition for ‘The Nutcracker’ in Cambridge

►**NUTCRACKER**  
*Continued from Page B1*

was very hard, but I tried to memorize the positions."

One of the most popular ballets, "The Nutcracker" can be a difficult production to put together. For José Mateo Ballet Theatre's director of communications, Madison Sweeney, it is Mateo's emphasis on diversity that sets his performances apart.

"Really the most unique thing is the fact that we have such a diverse cast," Sweeney said. "Performing at the Strand Theatre and in a diverse community is really big. For most of the things in José's Nutcracker, I feel like it's centered around the magic and how we can create magic in each individual, whether it's their first time seeing 'The Nutcracker' or their 101st time seeing 'The Nutcracker.'"

Jodie Pemberton, a Cambridge resident and former ballet dancer, brought her daughter Aria to auditions because of Mateo's reputation in the Cambridge community.

"We came to José Mateo because Aria has always been interested in ballet," Pemberton said. "I come from a ballet background, and he has a really positive reputation in our city."

Most parents felt the same. Grant Calderwood brought his 7-year-old daughter, Quitterie, out for similar reasons.

"We chose José Mateo because they have a wide variety of programming and they're well integrated with the community in Cambridge and in Boston," he said.

With roles ranging from snowflakes to Mother Ginger's children, there are plenty of characters for younger dancers — however one role emerged as an unlikely favorite among those auditioning.

"I kind of want to be a rat,"



Clockwise from top: Mary Thompson looked over a group of children as they took a break from auditions for the José Mateo Ballet Theatre's "The Nutcracker" production; a young girl in the 6-to-7 age group finished her audition, and dancers sat on a bench as they waited to enter.

'I kind of want to be a rat. I think a rat just is fun because it makes you laugh a lot.'

QUITTERIE CALDERWOOD, 7-year-old ballerina who auditioned for "The Nutcracker" over the weekend.

Quitterie said when asked what her dream role would be. "I think a rat just is fun because it makes you laugh a lot. Like when they go out looking for the rats, and they come out and then they hide, and it's really fun."

With Mateo's rendition of "The Nutcracker" sometimes featuring as many as 100 child performers alongside professional dancers, the rehearsal process can be a chaotic one.

"It's very intense, and it's very hard work. It takes a village to pull this all together," Sweeney said.

However, to Sweeney, that hard work is always worth it in the end.

"It's a huge cast with the skeleton crew, and like it's all about creating community and working together, and I think that we should get more people coming to the show because it's a really magical experience."

José Mateo's production of "The Nutcracker" will run from Dec. 5-20 at the Strand Theatre in Dorchester.

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## In 8th case, woman tests positive for West Nile Virus

**By Madyline Swearing**  
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

A woman in her 30s is the eighth person to test positive for West Nile virus in Massachusetts after she was exposed in Middlesex County, state public health officials said Friday.

The Department of Public Health said she was exposed to the virus in an area of the county where other people were exposed this year.

The risk level for contracting the mosquito-borne virus is high

in Boston, Brookline, Cambridge, Chelsea, Everett, Malden, Newton, Revere, Somerville, Watertown, and Winthrop, the DPH said in a statement. "Most of the rest of the state is at moderate risk," the statement said.

She is the first woman to test positive for the virus in the state.

Three men were reportedly exposed in Suffolk County, a man in his 50s and two men in their 70s, and three men were exposed in Middlesex County —

a man in his 60s, a man in his 80s, and a man in his 90s, according to the state.

Another man in his 60s was exposed to the virus in Worcester County, public health officials said. No animal cases have been reported.

West Nile virus has been detected in 327 mosquito samples, showing up in every Massachusetts county but Nantucket, according to the state. The state's first positive samples were announced June 16.

Eastern equine encephalitis has been detected in 21 mosquito samples this year, but no animal or human cases have been reported, officials said.

Risk levels for both viruses are updated daily, the state says.

People can reduce their risk by wearing long-sleeve clothing and insect repellent, public health officials said.

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## The Boston Globe

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| Sunday single copy        | \$6.00  | 6.00   | 6.00  |

## Lottery

**SUNDAY MIDDAY 2639**  
Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)

| EXACT ORDER     |         |
|-----------------|---------|
| All 4 digits    | \$4,474 |
| First or last 3 | \$626   |
| Any 2 digits    | \$54    |
| Any 1 digit     | \$5     |

| ANY ORDER    |       |
|--------------|-------|
| All 4 digits | \$186 |
| First 3      | \$104 |
| Last 3       | \$104 |

**SUNDAY NIGHT 0856**  
Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)

| EXACT ORDER     |         |
|-----------------|---------|
| All 4 digits    | \$5,728 |
| First or last 3 | \$802   |
| Any 2 digits    | \$69    |
| Any 1 digit     | \$7     |

| ANY ORDER    |       |
|--------------|-------|
| All 4 digits | \$239 |
| First 3      | \$134 |
| Last 3       | \$134 |

**MILLIONAIRE FOR LIFE**  
Sept. 19 **04-18-21-45-52**  
Millionaire Ball **02**

*Jackpot: \$1 million a year for life winners*

**MASS CASH**  
Sept. 20 **01-04-06-13-20**  
*Jackpot: \$100,000; no winners*

**MEGABUCKS**  
Sept. 19 **10-19-28-32-37-40**  
*Jackpot: \$650,000; winners*

| PREVIOUS DRAWINGS |        |       |
|-------------------|--------|-------|
|                   | Midday | Night |
| Saturday          | 0287   | 8360  |
| Friday            | 3053   | 7632  |
| Thursday          | 2516   | 9389  |
| Wednesday         | 9911   | 5272  |
| Tuesday           | 2682   | 8173  |

**WEEKEND NUMBERS AROUND NEW ENGLAND**  
Sun. Maine, N.H., Vermont  
Day: 3-digit **539** 4-digit **1297**  
Eve: 3-digit **215** 4-digit **4164**

Rhode Island  
Sunday **0148**  
Saturday's Powerball  
**18-30-41-45-68**  
Powerball **10**

*Jackpot: \$313 million; winners*

## This day in history

Today is Monday, Sept. 21, the 264th day of 2026. There are 101 days left in the year.

**Birthdays:** Producer Jerry Bruckheimer is 83. Musician Don Felder is 79. Author Stephen King is 79. Actor-comedian Bill Murray is 76. Champion race car driver Arie Luyendyk is 73. Filmmaker Ethan Coen is 69. Basketball Hall of Famer Sidney Moncrief is 69. Actor-comedian Dave Coulier is 67. Actor Rob Morrow is 64. Actor Cheryl Hines is 61. Country singer Faith Hill is 59. Actor Billy Porter is 57. Actor Alfonso Ribeiro is 55. Musician Liam Gallagher (Oasis) is 54. Actor Joseph Mazzello is 43. Rapper Wale is 42. Singer Jason Derulo is 37. Actor Ben Wang is 29. Cyclist Tadej Pogacar is 28.

►In 1792, the National Convention of France issued a proclamation announcing the abolition of the French monarchy.

►In 1898, in response to a letter from 8-year-old Virginia O'Hanlon, the New York Sun newspaper wrote an editorial containing the famous line "Yes, Virginia, there is a Santa Claus."

►In 1922, President Warren Harding signed the Lodge-Fish Resolution, a congressional resolution endorsing the creation of a Jewish state in Palestine.

►In 1938, a hurricane made US landfall, striking parts of New York and New England while causing widespread damage and claiming some 700 lives.

►In 1939, Romanian Prime Minister Armand Calinescu was assassinated by members of the

fascist Iron Guard movement.

►In 1955, at Yankee Stadium in New York, heavyweight boxer Rocky Marciano completed his undefeated professional career by knocking out Archie Moore in the ninth round of their title fight.

►In 1968, a groundbreaking was held for the Hancock Tower, building was not completed until 1976, about five years later than expected.

►In 1970, "Monday Night Football" made its debut on ABC, with the Cleveland Browns defeating the N.Y. Jets 31-21.

►In 1981, the Senate unanimously confirmed the nomination of Sandra Day O'Connor to become the first female justice on the Supreme Court.

►In 1989, Hurricane Hugo

crashed into South Carolina; the storm was blamed for 56 deaths in the Caribbean and 29 in the United States.

►In 2013, an attack by armed militants in the Westgate shopping mall in Nairobi, Kenya, left 67 people dead, hundreds hurt.

►In 2022, Russia's Vladimir Putin ordered a mobilization of reservists for the first time since World War II, nearly seven months after invading Ukraine.

►In 2025, Donald Trump praised ally Charlie Kirk as a "great American hero" and "martyr" for freedom as the US president and other leading conservatives took part in a televised tribute in Glendale, Ariz., to the political activist who was shot dead at a Utah speaking appearance Sept. 10.

# Shrewsbury says it has eradicated Asian longhorned beetles

**By Travis Andersen**  
GLOBE STAFF

Beat it, beetle.

Shrewsbury has successfully eradicated its population of the wood-devouring Asian longhorned beetle, state officials said Friday.

In a statement, the state’s Department of Conservation and Recreation said that as a result of the eradication, Shrewsbury has become the second municipality after Holden to be

removed from the longhorned beetle quarantine zone in Worcester County.

Holden bid farewell to the beetle last year, officials said.

Officials didn’t provide specifics in the statement on how the beetle got banished from both communities. But officials did say that since it was first detected in Massachusetts nearly two decades ago, state and federal crews have worked to find and eliminate the pest by in-

specting trees, removing infested trees and wood, and restricting the movement of wood that could bring the beetle to new areas.

“The Asian longhorned beetle is one of the most destructive invasive species that currently threatens the health of trees across Massachusetts,” DCR commissioner Nicole LaChapelle said in the statement. “Removing Shrewsbury, just a year after removing Hold-

en, from the quarantine area is a huge milestone in the fight to eradicate ALB.”

The beetle, native to Asia, was first detected in Worcester in 2008 and is believed to have come into the US via wood packing materials, officials said.

Ashley Randle, commissioner of the state’s Department of Agricultural Resources, said the eradication marked “a significant step in our efforts to eradi-

cate this pest in Massachusetts.”

It “reflects the power of the continued collaboration between our state and federal partners and cooperation of Shrewsbury residents to protect our maple and other hardwood trees,” Randle said.

A similar insect, the spotted lantern fly, has also sparked concern in Massachusetts.

The lanternfly, an invasive insect that can imperil certain

kinds of trees and create headaches as its sticky excrement mists down onto patios and cars, has now been found in almost 150 communities in Massachusetts, about triple this time last year, officials said earlier this month.

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# Utah project manager names streets for his favorite Red Sox players

**►STREET NAMES**  
*Continued from Page B1*

was clear.

“I don’t think anybody on my team really knew what I was doing until they saw the first flat be recorded [on the master plan],” he said.

Parr made sure to include a (Wade) Boggs Way, as well as a (Jerry) Remy Road, named after the late broadcaster and former player, and a Xander (Bogaerts) Lane.



Brandon Parr, project manager at Edge Homes, stood at the crossroads of Boggs and Yawkey Way in Herriman, Utah.

gotten creative with street names. Edge Homes takes on anywhere from 10 to 12 development projects a year, and naming all those streets can be “a little bit of a daunting task sometimes,” he said.

Aside from Red Sox players,

Parr has also referenced comic book movie actors. A subdivision in Riverton, Utah, includes a Hemsworth Lane and a Hiddleston Drive, named after Chris Hemsworth and Tom Hiddleston, the actors who play Thor and Loki in Marvel films.

“My company encourages us to be creative,” he said. “It’s just something fun that we do as a team.”

Parr, who carries a Red Sox water bottle and owns a replica championship ring, has taken his family to a few games at Fen-

way. But he admits that Red Sox fans aren’t exactly plentiful in Salt Lake City.

“I’m kind of alone,” he said. “At the office, I would say there’s definitely more Yankees fans around me than Red Sox fans. But I’ll be a Red Sox fan till the

day I die.”

At least one Herriman resident recognizes the significance of the street names.

Chris Watson, 56, a graphic designer and photographer, has lived in Utah for over two decades. But he was raised in Framingham, collecting Red Sox trading cards and watching Luis Tiant and Jim Rice and Carl Yastrzemski.

“I don’t keep up with [the team] as much anymore,” he said. “But the only baseball hat I’ll wear is a Red Sox hat.”

When he was searching for a place to build a new home a few years back, he realized “really quickly” the names on the lot were something special.

It was a “really fun coincidence” to end up living on Fisk Road — named after Carlton Fisk, Watson’s favorite player on the (in)famous 1978 team. Even that team, lamented for its end-of-season collapse against the Yankees, still holds a special place in his heart.

“That was the peak of fandom for my 8, 9-year old self,” he said. “He would have thought it was really cool [to be living here].”

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# Feud between Macklemore and Kraft sparks reflection

► **MACKLEMORE**  
*Continued from Page B1*

What people do know is what they see on their screens, and it is agonizing and unbelievably relentless: Israel killing more than 73,000 people in Gaza since the war began.

The Kraft-Macklemore spat is hardly a matter of life and death, but in its discordant way it is emblematic of our times.

Some Jewish concertgoers felt uncomfortable when Macklemore opened for Ed Sheeran in New Jersey and performed “Hind’s Hall,” a protest song celebrating pro-Palestinian encampments, and putting Israel supporters on notice that “white supremacy is finally on blast.”

Should they have sat with their discomfort, or demanded an apology and a refund? The watchdog group StopAntisemitism advocated for the latter in an Instagram post, which pop star Pink reposted, accelerating a chain of events that led New England Patriots and Gillette Stadium owner Robert Kraft to pressure Sheeran and other venue owners to drop Macklemore from the tour.

All for uttering two words: “Free Palestine.”

At least that’s how Macklemore framed it. And, for the most part, that’s how the public discourse has framed it, too, which is “reductive and misrepresentative,” said Jeremy Burton, chief executive of the Jewish Community Relations Council of Greater Boston, located in the Kraft Family Building downtown.

But people forget, or maybe don’t know, that while performing at a concert in 2014, Macklemore raised his arm in a way reminiscent of a Nazi salute. He also donned a fake hooked nose, black beard, and wig that resembled the type of antisemitic caricature that’s survived for centuries.

Macklemore later apologized, but Robert Kraft didn’t forget. When he barred Macklemore, Kraft referenced his “broader history of antisemitic rhetoric and imagery” while underscoring Gillette Stadium’s commitment to being free of “hate speech.”

Were Macklemore’s recent actions antisemitic or anti-Zionist? Are we talking about hate speech or free speech? These same questions tore college campuses apart in the wake of the Hamas-led Oct. 7 attack that



ANTHONY ANEX/KEYSTONE VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

**Rapper Macklemore, pictured in Bern, Switzerland, last year. He was recently dropped from Ed Sheeran’s concert after saying “Free Palestine” during a show in New Jersey.**

triggered the war in Gaza. Now, they’re touching off complicated feelings for many Jewish people during a season of apples and honey, renewal and reconciliation.

Jonathan Sarna, a scholar of American Jewish history, sees the events of last week as “a reflection of a larger problem, which is how the American Jewish community should respond to speech it perceives as hate speech — and all of the different strategies are fraught with problems,” he said. “Some people say, ‘Well, just ignore it — we’re only encouraging it.’ ... Others say, ‘We must respond as a matter of pride.’ I think what Mr. Kraft has said is basically that there is free speech, but speech has consequences: If you speak in this way, you can’t do it in my stadium.”

Now a professor emeritus, Sarna taught at Brandeis University, which just received \$10 million from Kraft for the Robert K. Kraft Family Center for Jewish Life and Leadership. He has known the Kraft family since 1965. The NFL owner’s father, Harry Kraft, was a stead-

fast presence at Congregation Kehillath Israel in Brookline, “so the idea of supporting Jewish life and promoting Israel is part of the deepest values that he cherishes,” Sarna said.

Yet, Sarna notes the 85-year-old Kraft is something of an anomaly in two industries that cater to young people: sports and music. “He has rather broad friendships and, I think, is hoping he can find a middle ground,” Sarna said. “As everybody knows, in a polarized America, the middle is a very tough place to be.”

Amid a second Trump term, the general public is primed. Many people know antisemitism is politically “weaponized” and used as a “smokescreen” to conceal agendas. They have reason to question if it’s “real,” or a handy excuse to sic government lawyers and immigration agents on everyone from student protesters to documented immigrants.

In short, they have more reason to trust Macklemore, an advocate for LGBTQ+ rights who raps about marriage equality in “Same Love,” and to distrust a

multibillionaire who is buddies with President Trump, despite Kraft’s credentials combating antisemitism.

Within the Jewish community, there’s a multitude of viewpoints about Israel, Palestine, and what it means to be Jewish in America at a time when antisemitic hate crimes are painfully real, even as the word antisemitism itself, and its definition, remain deeply polarizing.

About one third of US adults now believe Israel has committed genocide against Palestinians; within the Jewish community, roughly one third believe the same, while about half reject that view, according to an Associated Press-NORC Center for Public Affairs Research poll.

“The Jewish community has been deeply divided internally, with many people feeling that however much we may be heartbroken around Gaza, and however much we believe in freedom of expression, there has been a turn against Jews and an unbalanced, uncomplicated consensus about the Middle East,” said Lori Lefkowitz, director of Jewish studies at North-

eastern University.

Kraft created the Blue Square Alliance Against Hate to track hate speech online and its “Command Center” is located near Gillette. When Macklemore used the stage as a literal political platform, Lefkowitz said, Kraft was in a “no-win situation.” “Jews are put in the untenable situation of needing to decide what crosses boundaries in an unacceptable way when I wish others would police the borders against racism and antisemitism in solidarity.”

Burton pointed to Macklemore’s “Hind’s Hall” as a diatribe that “explicitly leans into and is framed around classical antisemitic tropes about Jews.”

“It’s about — white, moneyed Jews control your society and are the root of all evil,” Burton said.

Then there’s that image from 2014. For some people, it’s hard to unsee, despite Macklemore’s earlier explanation the hooked-nose getup was just a “random costume.”

“Every Jew I know knew exactly what it was,” Pink, who is Jewish, wrote on Instagram.

“But he apologized, and I let it go, because that’s what we do. We let it go.”

Last year, Ye, formerly Kanye West, released a song called “Heil Hitler.” Now, he’s scheduled to play in the Dallas Cowboys’ stadium.

When public figures have “a history of repeat offenses,” Burton said, “there’s a big public conversation about how much grace they get.”

As for his own venue, “Kraft can make whatever decision he’d like,” said Lila Corwin Berman, a professor of American Jewish history at New York University who has written about American philanthropy, “but he ought to recognize the consequences of using his financial holdings to deem certain forms of political speech beyond the pale.” While it’s commendable Kraft decided to donate to humanitarian aid efforts, Berman added, “that should not come at the expense of open discussion about political questions.”

Some Jewish scholars question how the open exchange of ideas can continue when criticism of Israel is quashed.

“When you get to the point where you have universities or external actors looking through the syllabi of courses to see if there’s anything anti-Israel or antisemitic about it, you have undermined the pursuit of knowledge,” said Shaul Magid, a professor of modern Jewish studies in residence at Harvard Divinity School.

Magid, who is also a rabbi, doesn’t see Macklemore’s recent onstage statements as antisemitic, but he stressed the Jewish community needs to look inward this Yom Kippur.

“We’ve never actually had the power to destroy another society, and now we do, and we did,” he said. “I think we have to basically stand up, as a people, and say what happened in Gaza was indefensible.”

“We killed tens of thousands of civilians and children, and there’s no justifying that,” he added, emphasizing what he sees as the need to “do *teshuva*,” or repent. “In my mind, that’s the only way to begin to get people to actually listen.”

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# Holy Cross fosters civil discourse on contentious topics

► **HOLY CROSS**  
*Continued from Page B1*

politics at the dinner table, but at Holy Cross, students are challenged to do just that.

Klinghard was part of a team that introduced the idea in 2023, after hosting a conference on free expression, where peer institutions, like Marquette University, shared that they hosted facilitated conversation on their campuses.

Holy Cross scheduled its first one for that fall, and community members were asked to respond to a poll to pick the topic. Quickly, it became a litmus test as the war in Gaza emerged as the top choice.

“This was the thing that was the most hot topic on campus, and a lot of people said, ‘We should go in a different direction. It’s the first time. Let’s be cautious,’” said Klinghard. “We decided, no, this is what the students want to talk about”

Julia Kane, a senior, was less than two months into her first year of college. A “standstill on campus” followed Oct. 7, 2023, she said, and she remembers thinking: “What are we supposed to do with this going on right now?”

So she attended the Dialogue Dinner, a conversation about the conflict over a catered Thanksgiving dinner in November.

“I wanted to talk to more people about it,” she said. “And I loved it because my table had very different views.”

Afterward, Kane, who studies political science, applied to be a facilitator for future dinners. For the last three years, she has met weekly with a dozen other students and helped guide the conversations, in addition to moderating events with student groups, including a conversation between the Holy Cross Feminist Forum and Students



TAYLOR COESTER FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

**Paige Ringuette held red, white, and blue star-shaped balloons while helping clean up following a “Dialogue Dinner” at the Hogan Campus Center of Holy Cross College last week.**

for Life club.

At Holy Cross, the basic premise is bolstered by the school’s Jesuit foundation. On each table is a set of framed guidelines, a framework based on the presupposition of Saint Ignatius of Loyola: “Every good Christian ought to be more eager to put a good interpretation on a neighbor’s statement than to condemn it.”

“We may disagree with one another, but we can do so with humility, respect, and a willingness to listen,” said Caitlin MacNeil, a Holy Cross alum who is now the associate director for

student involvement.

On a Wednesday night in September, a month into the school year, MacNeil reiterated this intention as students filed into the campus center and took a seat at small circular tables. The theme for the evening was the promises and responsibilities of democracy, in light of Constitution Week and the country’s semiquincentennial.

Kane facilitated a table where a senior from Pennsylvania took a seat — the dinner was one of many bucket-list items for her final year in Worcester. A first-year student from Ohio

joined, after attending a similar exercise during orientation. Another first-year student sat down, having never been to such an event, just beginning his time at the college hoping to study biology with a minor in theater.

Before students began their own conversations, three seniors simulated the experience for the crowd. Each had just participated in the college’s semester program in Washington D.C., and Sydney Carr, a political science professor, asked them to publicly reflect on their experience and personal principles about the importance of democ-

racy.

In Washington, Molly Gage, a senior, said she saw how a six-hour hearing became a 30-second TikTok, clipped to create a rancor when the rest was far more cordial. Maxine Jones, another senior, said she heard how most young people felt shunned from civic spaces, like town hall meetings.

These sentiments laid a foundation for the conversation at Kane’s table, where students took turns answering a similar set of questions about political participation and perceptions of democracy.

Jimmy Monahan, a first-year student, said aside from voting, he sees most of his peers choosing to engage in politics through protesting. Cecilia Massaua, a senior from Pennsylvania, said she did not disagree but felt defeated from her own experiences.

“No one ever listens to us. I would love to protest, but I feel like everyone just looks down on it,” Massaua said. “We go out to the streets, I remember with ‘No Kings Day,’ and it discourages me because nothing happened.”

Instead, she felt she learned how to express her own views, which she identified to be moderately conservative, by simply talking to her peers. At Holy Cross, she has leaned into the discomfort of debate.

“It is such a formative time to be wrong and be right,” she said. “You get the opportunity to make so many mistakes, but then learn from them but also be right and engage in really cool conversations.”

Nina Head, a first-year student from Ohio, said that part of the reason she chose to attend Holy Cross was because of the community the college fostered. Outside of campus, the thought of talking publicly about politics feels intimidating as a young person.

Over dinner with her classmates, she was the first to speak up.

“This teaches a really everyday way to have a civil conversation,” Head said. “Find out if you are wrong, be wrong, just talk it out, learn from other people and expand your perspective.”

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# Autumnal equinox and the loss of light

**By Dave Epstein**  
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

There are certain stories a meteorologist can count on with the changing seasons. A winter outlook. A hurricane season forecast. And, of course, the solstices and equinoxes. We have one coming up: the autumnal equinox on Tuesday, marking the first day of astronomical fall.

Unlike most of the weather I have to predict, the equinoxes are refreshingly certain. We know exactly when they're going to happen, not just this year but for decades to come. The predictability of the planets and the sun makes this part of the job easy.

But what we think we know about the equinox isn't quite right, and what we don't know about it is more interesting than the date itself.

Let's start with the myth. The autumnal equinox marks the point at which the sun is directly overhead at some point along the equator. But the equinox is not actually a day of equal day and night. That balance, when daylight and darkness split evenly, is called the equilux, and it doesn't arrive until a few days after the equinox, around Sept. 25 or 26. The gap comes down to two things: The sun isn't a point of light, it's a disc, so we get a few extra minutes of daylight as the top edge clears the horizon before the whole sun rises and the bottom edge lingers after it sets. Also, the atmosphere itself bends light, pulling the sun's image up over the horizon a bit before it's technically there, and holding it a bit after the sun is technically gone. Put those together and you get a few extra minutes of daylight tacked onto both ends, every single day, everywhere on Earth. We get nearly three minutes a day here in this part of the world. It's less the farther south you go, and even more dramatic the closer you get to the poles.

Around the equinox, the rate at which we're losing daylight is the fastest it will be all year, close to three minutes a day, compared to just seconds around the solstices. That's not a small thing for the brain.



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

As the hours of daylight shorten, research says it's important to make an effort to get some.

This time of year and that steady loss of light are intrinsically linked to your mood and how it may be changing, if you've been slowly feeling off since mid-August. I was chatting last week with my best friend from Toronto, not really knowing why he was feeling a bit down, as if winter were already here. It got me thinking: As we've been heading toward the equinox, what are the collective impacts?

There's research from Vanderbilt University in 2024 in which Sandra Rosenthal, a chemistry professor who also studies pharmacology, found something that surprised her. It wasn't the total amount of daylight that mattered most to people with mood disorders. It was how fast that daylight was disappearing.

She noticed the pattern in her own life first. Every August, around the third week, she'd end up at the doctor feeling run-down, like she had mono, long before winter ever showed up on the calendar. Her research team tracked solar insolation, the actual amount of the sun's energy reaching the ground, across small regions, and found that the rate of that decline pre-

dicted symptoms of depression better than the season itself did.

There's another piece to this that has nothing to do with total daylight and everything to do with timing. The light that actually sets your body clock isn't midday sun, it's the low angle, right around sunrise and sunset. Your retina has cells built specifically to catch that kind of light and report straight to the brain's master clock. Get that signal at a consistent early hour and your cortisol rises on schedule, which locks in when you feel awake and, about 16 hours later, when you feel sleepy.

Here's the problem this time of year: Sunrise keeps sliding later, day by day, while most of us keep waking up at the same clock time we always have. So the exact light you need to anchor your rhythm is arriving after you're already up, already checking your phone, already three cups of coffee into the day. You miss the window without ever knowing there was one.

This isn't just one research study. We've got Rosenthal's work on the rate of light change, but also that of Andrew Huberman, a Stanford neuroscientist who's built a huge body of work around exactly this kind of light

exposure. According to Huberman, an 2023 observational study of more than 85,000 people found that low daytime light exposure was tied to a real rise in depression and other mental health conditions.

I always knew, personally, that I felt better on the mornings I got my dog walk in right at sunrise, catching that low angle light. I just never had any research behind it, just a feeling I chalked up to being an early riser who likes his coffee outside.

But Rosenthal's research points to the body's own master clock, the suprachiasmatic nucleus in the hypothalamus region of the brain, as the part doing the sensing. It reads the pace of the light change and adjusts melatonin release accordingly, hence regulating circadian rhythms. SCN is a mechanism every one of us carries, whether or not we ever notice it working.

We can't change the amount of sunlight over the next six months, but we can try to get more of it as it's clearing the horizon first thing in the morning or before it disappears late in the afternoon.

No matter what, if you're feeling a bit down, you're not alone.

## Brockton firefighter named top safety educator

**By Adam Sennott**  
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Over his 30 years as a Brockton firefighter, Peter Reardon has worked on engine and ladder trucks, responding to calls night and day.

But in 2024, after being named the department's public education officer, he found his true calling.

He works with residents of all ages, from kindergarteners to seniors, teaching them about fire safety.

"I love it," said Reardon, also affectionately known as "Firefighter Pete." "It's been the pinnacle of my career, actually."

Last week, Reardon received the state's 2026 Fire & Life Safety Educator of the Year Award for his work with thousands of students and residents in the city south of Boston.

Massachusetts awards grant funding to local communities to educate students and seniors about fire safety.

"Massachusetts continues to

lead the nation in fire safety because of the great work of the Department of Fire Services and local leaders like Firefighter Peter Reardon," Governor Maura Healey said in a statement announcing the award.

Brockton Fire Chief Brian Nardelli was on hand for the ceremony.

"This is an incredible award for someone who's worked very hard, and not looking for any recognition," Nardelli said in an email to the Globe.

For his part, Reardon said he appreciates the recognition, but noted he has "a hard time receiving awards," because he is simply doing his job.

"It's very, very nice," Reardon said by telephone Friday. "I just believe in the work."

In just two short years, 'Firefighter Pete' has made over 250 classroom visits, reaching more than 6,300 public school students, according to the statement.

He visits the senior center ev-

ery month. On most Fridays, he attends the weekly meeting of Shoe City Walkers, a group of senior strollers that meets at the Westgate Mall.

"He's enlisted the help of translators to ensure that every resident gets this important information – no matter where they're from or what language they speak," state Fire Marshal Jon M. Davine said in the statement.

In schools, Reardon visits children in kindergarten through third grade, teaching them new skills each year.

Early learners are taught that firefighters are their friends who can help them. The lessons grow from there, he said.

Second graders, for example, use graph paper to map out color-coded escape routes from their homes. They have to highlight two exits out of a room and multiple ways out of their house, he said.

"And that route would take you all the way outside to a

meeting place where your entire family would meet, and you would wait for emergency services, the fire department, to come," Reardon explained.

He knew he'd made an impact when, one night while picking up dinner at a KFC, he spotted an 8-year-old girl sitting with her mother, mapping out their escape route.

The family is from Cape Verde, and English is not their first language, he recalled.

"This lovely mom ... she didn't know anything about escape routes," Reardon said. "It just made me realize how important this education can be to people."

The girl walked over and introduced him to her mother as "Firefighter Pete." The nickname stuck, he said.

"It made me tear up," Reardon said. "I cried."

*Adam Sennott can be reached at adam.sennott@globe.com.*

## Taunton man held for allegedly killing girlfriend

**By Shannon Larson**  
GLOBE STAFF

A 37-year-old man accused of killing his girlfriend at his townhouse in Taunton on Thursday was ordered held without bail, according to court records.

Matthew Cruz, formerly of Bridgewater, pleaded not guilty to a charge of first-degree murder on Friday at his arraignment in Taunton District Court. He is being held at the Bristol County House of Correction.

Cruz is accused of fatally assaulting Shannon Smith, 37, following a dispute, officials said. Police found the Bridgewater woman unresponsive at the base of a staircase inside the home after Cruz called 911.

She was taken to Morton Hospital in Taunton, where she was pronounced dead shortly after 1:30 p.m., police said in a report.

Cruz told an officer that he

had argued with Smith earlier "about her cheating on him," according to the report. He said he was in his room when he "heard her throw herself down the stairs," the report said.

Smith and Cruz were the only people home at the time, the report said. Smith was found at the base of the stairs "on her back, up against a broken closet door."

Paramedics said they believed Smith had been unresponsive longer than Cruz told police. "From my training and experience, the injuries I personally observed on Shannon's body were not consistent with a fall from a fairly short set of household stairs," an officer wrote in the report. "The position and location Shannon was found [in] could not happen from a fall from those stairs. The box on the landing did not appear damaged or moved."

Police determined her injuries "were more likely than not caused from a physical assault," the report said.

An officer said he observed "several injuries and markings" on her face and body, including a cut to the top of her forehead. Smith also had swelling and contusions on the left side of her face and appeared to have a bruised right eye, the report said.

At the time of the alleged killing, Cruz was on pretrial release for allegedly assaulting his father, 75, in early August at his parents' home in Bridgewater, court records show.

Cruz's father told police that his son got angry after he told him he would be making sandwiches for dinner and then denied his request to get him a sandwich "from a food establishment nearby" instead, the report said. Cruz then pushed his fa-

ther to the living room floor, according to the report. His father did not report any injuries. Cruz continued yelling at his mother until he left the home as his mother called 911, the report said.

A judge granted his parents' request for restraining orders against him later that night, according to the report. He pleaded not guilty in Brockton District Court on Aug. 10, records show. He was released on personal recognizance and ordered to follow specific conditions, including not to abuse or harass his father, court records show.

His next hearing in that case is scheduled for Oct. 13 at Brockton District Court, records show.

Two days later, he is due in Taunton District Court on the murder charge.

*Shannon Larson can be reached at shannon.larson@globe.com.*

# Remembered

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### BY CITY AND TOWN

|                                              |                                    |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>BRIGHTON</b><br>COSTINE, Paul E.          | <b>NEEDHAM</b><br>COSTINE, Paul E. |
| <b>CANTON</b><br>HENKEN, Herbert             | <b>NEWTON</b><br>HENKEN, Herbert   |
| <b>HINGHAM</b><br>ZULLAS, Mary Flora         |                                    |
| <b>MILTON</b><br>TEEHAN, Kathleen M. (Hogan) |                                    |

### COSTINE, Paul E.

Of Needham, formerly of Brighton, known as "Angry Bill" on his calls to WEEI died suddenly, September 17, 2026. Paul is survived by his wife, Marta Poupart and her family; and his brother, Ret. BPD Robert Costine. Visitation, Tuesday morning 9-10:30, Funeral Mass at 11 AM. For full information, visit [www.eatonfuneralhomes.com](http://www.eatonfuneralhomes.com)

### HENKEN, HERBERT

A beloved father, grandfather, and great-grandfather, passed away peacefully at Orchard Cove in Canton, MA, on September 20, 2026. Herb preceded in death by his loving wife, Charlene, his parents, Samuel and Rose, and his brother, Marvin. He is survived by his devoted sons, Richard and Robert; their wives, Gabrielle and Barrie; his six grandchildren, Julia (and her husband Richard Kelly), Danny (and his wife Rachael), Sam (and his wife Katie), Ben, Brooke, and Blaire; and his great-grandchildren, Rozzie and Mickey. A service to honor Herb's life will be held on September 22, 2026, at 11:00 AM at Stanetsky Memorial Chapels, 475 Washington Street, in CANTON, with burial to follow at Sharon Memorial Park. Family and friends are then invited to celebrate a life well-lived at Orchard Cove immediately following funeral and burial proceedings until 4:00 PM. In lieu of flowers, the family kindly requests that donations be made in Herb's memory to Orchard Cove, located at 1 Del Pond Drive, in Canton, MA 02021. For complete obituary and on line condolences, please visit [www.stanetskybrookline.com](http://www.stanetskybrookline.com)

**Stanetsky Memorial Chapel**  
**617-232-9300**  
**[www.stanetskybrookline.com](http://www.stanetskybrookline.com)**

### TEEHAN, Kathleen M. (Hogan)

Died peacefully, at home in Milton, Friday, September 18, 2026.

Beloved wife of the late Lt. Colonel Richard J. Teehan U.S. Army. Loving mother of the late Richard P. Teehan. Daughter of the late John T. and Marion R. (Hart) Hogan. Devoted sister of her late twin brothers, Gerald F. Hogan and Malcom J. Hogan, who died one month apart, in the service of their country in World War II; and her late cherished sister, Elaine P. Hogan.

Kathleen will be remembered for her everlasting love of God, family, country and friends in all her undertakings.

A Mass of Christian Burial will be celebrated in Saint Agatha Church, 432 Adams Street, Milton, Wednesday, September 23, at 10:30 am. Relatives and friends invited. Visiting Hours at Dolan Funeral Home, 460 Granite Avenue, EAST MILTON SQUARE, Tuesday, 4-7 pm. Interment, Milton Cemetery.

For complete obituary, [www.dolanfuneral.com](http://www.dolanfuneral.com)

### ZULLAS, Mary Flora (Edwards)



Age 95, passed away on Tuesday, September 15, 2026, at Linden Ponds in Hingham. Mary is survived by two of her two children, Elizabeth (Zullas) Clague and her husband, Daniel of Brockton and Michael Zullas and his wife, Marianne of Milton; three grandchildren, Daniel Freeman Clague of Washington, D.C., Melina Alves Zullas of Brunswick, Maine, and Alyssa Alves Zullas of Milton; and many nieces and nephews. She was the wife of the late Robert (Bob) James Zullas, a former State Police Detective Captain and Brockton Police Sergeant; the mother of the late Roberta Ann Zullas; and the sister of the late Fred T. Edwards, Jr. and the late Carol Hubert.

Visiting Hours will be held on Monday, September 28, from 7:00 pm to 9:00 pm, and on Tuesday, September 29, from 9:00 am to 11:00 am, at the Conley Funeral Home, 138 Belmont Street (Rte. 123) BROCKTON. A Funeral service will be on Tuesday, September 29, at 11:00 am, at the Conley Funeral Home, followed by interment in Pine Hill Cemetery in West Bridgewater. For a complete obituary, please visit [www.ConleyRussellPica.com](http://www.ConleyRussellPica.com)

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## Obituaries

# Brendan Farrington, 60, AP Florida news reporter

By Kathy McCormack

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Brendan Farrington, a veteran news reporter who covered Florida politics, hurricanes, and quirkiness for the Associated Press for more than 25 years, has died. The Massachusetts native and former Patriot Ledger reporter was 60.

Mr. Farrington died Friday at his home in Tallahassee following a brief illness, said Steve Schale, a close friend of the family.

Based in the state capital, he was regarded as well-sourced, fair, and kind, with a wide-ranging sense of humor. He also was a big sports fan who boasted of having visited every major league ballpark.

Reporters called him a mentor and friend, adding that he was trusted by politicians on both side of the aisle.

“I was amazed by the many calls he would get from everyone from big-name politicians and their aides to back-office workers telling him what was going on behind the scenes,” said Terry Spencer, former Florida news editor for the AP.

Among the politicians paying tribute to Mr. Farrington was former Florida governor Jeb Bush.

“Brendan was an old school journalist,” Bush posted on X. “He was a real pro.”

Originally from Wilbraham, Mr. Farrington began his career as a general assignment reporter at The Patriot Ledger in Quincy in 1988. He joined the AP in Miami in the late 1990s and transferred to Tallahassee in 2001.

Spencer said one of his favorite memories of Mr. Farrington was when he assigned him on election night 2014 to be with Charlie Crist, who was running for governor against Rick Scott in a tight race. Crist decided to concede, but his cellphone battery had died, according to Kevin Cate, a filmmaker who back then was a consultant for Crist.

“Brendan being Brendan offered his phone,” wrote Cate in a Facebook post. “Of course he had Rick Scott’s cell. Of course Rick Scott would answer. This was Brendan Farrington.”

Gary Fineout, a reporter at Politico who formerly worked for the AP in Tallahassee with Mr. Farrington, said he was a beautiful writer who could handle a multitude of subjects. “He was always very willing to go out and to cover hurricanes, be prepared for natural disasters,” Fineout said. “He would always jump into that coverage as soon

as it was needed.”

Schale said Mr. Farrington would try to frame what was happening through the lives of the people affected by a hurricane or other event.

“Brendan was a great journalist and even better colleague and mentor to AP journalists in Florida and beyond, and we could always count on him to jump into a big story,” said AP global sports editor Josh Hoffner, the organization’s former director of US news. “I’ll always remember and appreciate the role he played as a watchdog and champion of government transparency, press access, and accountability journalism.”

Mr. Farrington also enjoyed collecting stories that he would turn into an annual “weird Florida” roundup in years past.

“Some stories were gruesome, but bizarre. Like the man who injured his finger during a fight then cut it off, cooked it with scrambled eggs and ate it,” his story from 1999 read. “Apparently he didn’t consider other options, like the Orlando-area man who lost a chunk of a finger while slicing a frozen pig then underwent leech treatment to save the digit.”

In 2021, the press secretary for Florida Governor Ron DeSantis was suspended from what was then called Twitter after excoriating Mr. Farrington for journalism that pointed out that one of DeSantis’ multimillion-dollar donors invested in a company that was making the COVID-19 treatment drug Regeneron.

In one tweet, she wrote that if Mr. Farrington didn’t change the story, she would “put you on blast.” She also retweeted a message that said “Light. Them. Up.” in reference to the AP, whose president had interceded. Mr. Farrington said he received lots of abuse online after the press secretary’s comments, tweeting to his followers: “For your sake, I hope government doesn’t threaten your safety. I’ll be fine, I hope. Freedom. Just please don’t kill me.”

Mr. Farrington left the AP in January 2025 after he was one of a group of employees who accepted voluntary buyouts.

Spencer said one of Mr. Farrington’s favorite stories, from 2011, was about the then-new president of the Florida Senate who had written a book on politics for Brevard Community College, where he had taught. Mike Haridopolos received \$152,000 in taxpayer money for the effort in lieu of teaching — but the sin-



BILL COTTERELL/STATE ARCHIVES OF FLORIDA VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

**Mass. native and AP reporter Brendan Farrington, pictured in 2014, at the Florida State Capitol in Tallahassee.**

gle available copy of the 175-page, double-spaced manuscript called “Florida Legislative History and Processes” could only be read at the school.

College administrators swore that that would change, but they also acknowledged the arrangement negotiated by the college president with Haridopolos at the time was unusual and expensive. The president defended it. Haridopolos, a Republican who was later elected to the US House in 2024 representing Florida’s Eighth Congressional District, did not respond to requests for comment at the time.

Mr. Farrington enjoyed talking to people and posted “selfies with a stranger” with people he had just met at a bar, restaurant, or on the street, Spencer said. And he ran a faux campaign for his dog Roxy for US Senate. “Walks, Naps & Treats 4 U” was her slogan.

“Brendan loved everyone he met, and made friends everywhere he went,” his wife, Amy Farrington, said in a statement. “He believed in the decency that lives inside every one of us.”

Marta Lavandier, an AP photographer based in Miami, first knew Mr. Farrington when the two worked at the Patriot-Ledger together.

“He was always a lot of fun, almost like the center of attention,” she said. “He was always happy, had a good, great wit to him, a good friend, a mentor to many.”

He was also known for his compassion.

“If you walked around town with Brendan, it was common for him to greet the homeless by name,” Schale, a political consultant, told the Tallahassee Democrat. “And I know of one particular night he chose to spend a night out on the street because he felt that’s where he needed to be to help. That’s just who he was.”

In addition to his wife, Mr. Farrington leaves a son, Cullen; his mother, Ethel; three brothers, Bill, Tom, and John, and a sister, Maire.

After leaving the AP, Mr. Farrington wrote freelance articles for the Tallahassee Democrat.

“I began my career covering community news in Massachusetts, and by the time I retired, I wanted to return to those roots, even just to write an occasional story,” he wrote in a first-person story in October. “I, like many, was weary of the divisiveness and ugliness of politics. And then there were the mass shootings, executions and deadly tornadoes and hurricanes I covered when I wasn’t at the Capitol listening to lawmakers argue.”

Among his new assignments? The Dog-O-Ween at Tallahassee’s Tom Brown Park. The event honored canines in costumes.

Mr. Farrington called it “a dream assignment.”

His story began: “There was a boxer who wasn’t a Boxer, a Pug-sley who wasn’t a pug, and a vampire who doesn’t bite, because a good dog would never do that. No she wouldn’t.”

# Elaine Mokhtefi, 97, witness to Algeria’s revolution

By Clay Risen

NEW YORK TIMES

Late one night in June 1969, Elaine Mokhtefi, a journalist with the Algerian government news service, received a call from a representative of the Zimbabwe African People’s Union, a militant group fighting the white supremacist government of what was then Southern Rhodesia.

He needed help. Eldridge Cleaver, a leader of the Black Panther Party, had jumped bail on an attempted murder charge in California, fled to Cuba and was now hiding in Algiers, the capital. Could she lean on her contacts in the Algerian government to arrange a visa?

African guerrillas, US radicals, top Algerian officials — Ms. Mokhtefi was used to it. What was strange was how she got there.

Born Elaine Klein in New York and educated in Georgia, she improbably found herself as an indispensable fixer for the Algerian independence movement in the 1950s and, after it separated from France in 1962, for the young Algerian republic, connecting its leaders with the revolutionaries and rebels who saw Algeria as a beacon for developing-world freedom movements.

“In the ’60s, we had the impression that what we did could have an impact,” Ms. Mokhtefi told Publishers Weekly in 2018. “We felt that we were on the edge of a new world.”

Ms. Mokhtefi died Sept. 11 in New York City. She was 97.

The death, in a hospital, was confirmed by Zeynep Çelik, a neighbor and close friend.

After dropping out of college and moving to Paris in 1951, Ms. Mokhtefi became drawn to the plight of Algerian workers, who faced constant discrimination, and to their homeland’s smoldering campaign for independence from France, which broke out into full-scale war in 1954.

By decade’s end, she was working for the provisional Algerian government, first in Paris and later in New York, helping its officials navigate the United Nations and cultivate ties with the US government.

Fluent in French, she proved adept at moving between cultures and causes, helping link the Algerian struggle to the broader fight against European colonialism in Africa and Asia.

Following independence, Ms. Mokhtefi moved to Algiers, where she continued her work as a fixer.

She was in Algeria in 1970 when Timothy Leary, an Ameri-

can psychologist and counter-culture celebrity, escaped to the country after breaking out of prison in California, where he was being held on a drug conviction. She arranged for him and his wife, Rosemary, to meet with government officials and stay in Algiers.

And she was the main point of contact between the Algerian government and Cleaver, arranging for him, his wife, and his associates to receive something like diplomatic status in Algeria, which included a stipend and the use of a villa outside Algiers.

The Panthers added to Algeria’s mystique as an international center for revolutionaries, but their flashy American lifestyle raised eyebrows among what was, still, a conservative Muslim country.

One day, Cleaver confessed a secret to Ms. Mokhtefi: He had killed one of his close associates, Clinton Smith, known as Rahim. He said the man had been trying to steal from the Panthers. Ms. Mokhtefi later learned that Smith had been seen dancing closely with Cleaver’s wife at a disco while he had been on a trip to North Korea, and she suspected the killing had a different motivation.

Cleaver was never charged in the killing.

Elaine Klein was born Dec. 10, 1928. Her parents, Charlie and Mildred Klein, owned a dry goods store in Hempstead, a Long Island suburb, but it failed at the onset of the Great Depression in 1929.

The family moved repeatedly, first back to the city from Long Island, then to Texas, then to upstate New York and finally to Ridgefield, Conn., an experience that established Elaine’s comfort with different surroundings and affinity for outsiders.

She attended Wesleyan College, a women’s institution in Macon, Ga., but was expelled after a year for speaking out against Jim Crow segregation and for breaking curfew to visit Atlanta on the weekends.

Her expulsion in 1974 stung. By then she had fallen in love with a former freedom fighter, Mokhtar Mokhtefi, who left with her. They lived for 20 years in Paris, where she sold jewelry, and married in 1991.

She also became involved in various protest movements and was a regular presence at demonstrations against the Iraq War and for Palestinian rights.

Mokhtar Mokhtefi died in 2015. Elaine Mokhtefi does not leave any immediate survivors.

# Judy Gumbo, an original Yippie, at 83

By Richard Sandomir

NEW YORK TIMES

Judy Gumbo, a key member of the leftist, anti-establishment Yippies who poked fun at the 1968 Democratic National Convention in Chicago, protested the Vietnam War in a Viet Cong costume in Moscow, and was a target of FBI surveillance and break-ins, died Sept. 14 in Berkeley, Calif. She was 83.

Her daughter, Jessica Epstein, said she died of dementia in a memory care facility.

From the late 1960s to the early ’70s, the Yippies — formally the Youth International Party — mocked institutional figures with political satire and street theater in a bid to stop the Vietnam War and injustices.

“I am an original Yippie,” Dr. Gumbo wrote in her autobiography, “Yippie Girl: Exploits in Protest and Defeating the FBI” (2022). “A Yippie is a politicized hippie, a protester who has been hit over the head by a cop — and woke up.”

Dr. Gumbo was not as well known as Abbie Hoffman and Jerry Rubin, two of the party’s founders, but she was “an integral Yippie,” Nancy Kurshan, a Yippie who was Rubin’s partner for a while, said in an interview.

A few days before the Democratic convention, Dr. Gumbo was part of a contingent — which included her boyfriend and future husband, Stew Albert, a founder of the Yippies; Rubin; and folk singer Phil Ochs — that drove to a farm to buy a 150-pound pig they brought to the Civic Center in Chicago.

After a quick speech by a

spokesperson named Super Joel Yippie nominating Pigasus for president, Chicago police officers arrested seven Yippies for disorderly conduct and confiscated the pig. Fearing deportation to her native Canada if she had been arrested, Dr. Gumbo stayed on the sidelines, raising the \$300 to bail out the jailed Yippies.

She viewed the riotous demonstrations outside the convention as the equivalent of a “live-action antiwar documentary” and was thrilled that she had hit a police cruiser with a jar of “Yippie purple” paint.

“No girly throw for me, I had hit what I had aimed for!” she wrote.

In a 2024 oral history of the convention riots in The New York Times, she recalled seeing officers beat protesters.

“It was scary, but I don’t remember the scary as much as I remember the empowerment,” she said. “The feeling of, ‘We are doing the right thing.’”

In 1969, when Rubin, Hoffman and five other defendants — the Chicago 7 — were tried in federal court for inciting a riot during the convention, Dr. Gumbo was named “conspiracy trial office manager” by William Kunstler, one of the defense lawyers.

Her job was traditional woman’s work: answering phones and handing out mail. She also retyped each day’s trial transcript, and then mimeographed it to produce enough copies to mail to national and foreign news outlets.

The Yippies were a patriarchal organization, said Kurshan,

the author of a memoir, “Levitating the Pentagon and Other Uplifting Stories: A Life of Activism” (2026).

“Sometimes, we were invisible,” Kurshan said.

But in early 1970, Dr. Gumbo got a role in the forefront when a North Vietnamese delegation sent a message to the trial office wanting to meet members of the Chicago 7 in Montreal. The trial had not ended — and leaving for Canada might have meant violating the defendants’ bail — so Dr. Gumbo went instead.

“For peace activists like me to meet North Vietnamese — who our protest movement considered heroes — was the crown jewel in the pantheon of antiwar privilege,” she wrote in her book.

While there, she began a monthslong affair with Do Xuan Oanh, a poet and composer who headed the delegation.

The meeting led to Dr. Gumbo’s trip to Hanoi in May 1970, accompanied by Kurshan and Genie Plamondon, the minister of internal affairs for the radical White Panther Party. While there, Oanh handed Dr. Gumbo an envelope filled with 143 letters from American prisoners of war.

The next month, the three women flew to Moscow, where they dressed as Viet Cong — black silk pajamas, conical hats, and sandals — and gathered outside the US Embassy to protest the war.

For about 30 minutes, they chanted and carried signs that declared, “We Are the American” and “Ho Chi Minh. The



GRITSAN LITGAZ/ASSOCIATED PRESS

**Judy Gumbo (right) stood with two other American women dressed in black pajamas and Ho Chi Minh sandals are shown outside the US Embassy in Moscow in 1970.**

NLF Is Gonna Win” — references to the communist leader of North Vietnam and the National Liberation Front, whose guerrilla fighters were known as the Viet Cong.

Judith Lee Clavir was born in Toronto on June 25, 1943. Her father, Leo, was a film distributor who imported Soviet films and also was a game show producer. Her mother, Harriet (Kamman) Clavir, ran the home but was also an alcoholic.

“We were both Jewish and ‘godless’ communists as the far right likes to claim,” she wrote in her memoir. “Instead of synagogue, our rituals took place in front of bookshelves, my atheistic family’s holy of holies.”

In 1965, she received a bachelor’s degree in sociology from the University of Toronto. Two

years later, she was in graduate studies there when she attended a sociology conference in San Francisco and was enraptured by the free love philosophy expressed by one of the attendees.

She soon moved to Berkeley, where she met Albert — one of the Yippies’ founders — and was hired at The Berkeley Barb, an underground newspaper, to sell classified sex ads.

In 1968, while in a car with Albert and his close friend Eldridge Cleaver, a Black Panther, Cleaver referred to her as “Mrs. Stew.” She objected, saying she was nobody’s “Mrs.,” which led Cleaver to call her Gumbo. She loved it.

In the years after the Yippies faded, Dr. Gumbo taught sociology at SUNY New Paltz, Mills College, in Oakland, and the

University of Oregon. She later worked as a fund-raiser for Planned Parenthood in Portland, Ore. She received a doctorate in sociology from the University of Toronto in 1975.

Her first marriage, to David Hemblen, an actor, ended in divorce. Albert, whom she married in 1977, died in 2006. She was married to David Dobkin, a financial planner, from 2009 until his death in 2014. They walked down the aisle to a klezmer musician playing “The Internationale,” the socialist and communist anthem.

In 2017, she married Arthur Eckstein, a historian at the University of Maryland who wrote “Bad Moon Rising: How the Weather Underground Beat the FBI and Lost the Revolution” (2016).

In addition to her husband and her daughter, from her second marriage, she has a son and a

TV HIGHLIGHTS

NHL preseason: Senators-Canadiens, 7 p.m., NHL  
WNBA: Dream-Liberty, 8 p.m., NBCSN  
NFL: Giants-Rams, 8:15 p.m., ABC, ESPN  
Listings, C9

Sports

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THE BOSTON GLOBE MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 21, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/SPORTS

TARA SULLIVAN

It's fitting they had extra wait to celebrate



ST. PETERSBURG, Fla. — The first time Red Sox players walked off Tropicana Field on Sunday evening, they trudged toward a locker room that, had they been able to win the rubber game of this final road series of the regular season, would have been covered in protective tarps and laden with full champagne bottles.

Alas, a 5-1 loss to the Rays meant there would be no pop-

ping corks in the immediate aftermath, with players quietly changing out of their uniforms and turning their chairs toward the television screens above them instead.

The second time they walked off that same field it was a totally different story, now featuring a group of jubilant, playoff-bound players, custom T-shirts, and protective goggles. They all headed back in to celebrate a wild-card berth that became official the moment the Braves beat the Astros, 4-2. From a celebratory team photo on the field back to a locker room

SULLIVAN, Page C2



MARK TAYLOR/GETTY IMAGES

Willson Contreras didn't let his bruised hand keep him from celebrating after the Red Sox got help to clinch a playoff spot.

Red Sox lose, but earn playoff spot

They get needed help from Astros

By Peter Abraham  
GLOBE STAFF

**Rays 5**  
**Red Sox 1**

ST. PETERSBURG, Fla. — The notion that the Red Sox would spend the final week of the regular season preparing for the playoffs was the definition of fantasy baseball when they fell to 32-46 on June 24.

The Sox were buried in last place in their division with a lost summer ahead.

"Everybody counted us out," right fielder Wilyer Abreu said. "But we believed we were a bet-

ter team than that."

A stunning 32-5 run, including a 15-game win streak, turned their season around under interim manager Chad Tracy.

The final validation came Sunday when the Sox clinched their spot in the American League Wild Card Series that starts Sept. 29, likely at Yankee Stadium.

Not only did the Sox make the playoffs, they somehow did it with six games to spare.

Of course it wasn't easy. The Sox missed a chance to clinch with a 5-1 loss against the Rays. Then the Braves beat the Astros 58 minutes later, guaranteeing

RED SOX, Page C2



PATRIOTS 20, STEELERS 3



Prevailing through pain

Onwenu joins wounded group

By Nicole Yang  
GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — Although the Patriots earned their first win of the season on Sunday, 20-3 over the Steelers, they also added some key contributors to their growing list of injuries.

After losing their star wide receiver A.J. Brown to a high ankle sprain in Week 1, the Patriots lost five more players, including three starters.

Late in the first quarter, right guard Mike Onwenu was carted off the field with a serious right ankle injury. Midway through the second quarter, edge rusher Dre'Mont Jones appeared extremely upset as he stormed off the field with a shoulder injury.

The team immediately ruled Onwenu out and initially listed

MORE NFL

**Something's amiss**  
Patriots still don't look right on offense. **Gaspar, A1**

**In quite a rush**  
New England's ground game gets job done in victory. **C4**

**Squeeze play**  
Patriots defense in Rodgers's face. **Unconventional review, C5**

**March to victory**  
Saints complete rally with late touchdown, defeat Ravens. **C6**

Jones as questionable to return before downgrading him to out. X-rays after the game showed that Onwenu broke his ankle, a league source confirmed Sunday evening.

Later, in the second half, the Patriots also ruled out tight end Eli Raridon (thigh) in addition to safeties Dell Pettus (ankle) and Craig Woodson (shoulder). It was not clear when those three players suffered their in-

juries.

After experiencing extremely fortunate injury luck last season en route to a Super Bowl appearance, the Patriots are getting tested early.

Coach Mike Vrabel, who publicly questioned the team's depth during the preseason, said following the game he had no update on any of the players. Woodson left the locker room

PATRIOTS, Page C4



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Christian Elliss (53) and Robert Spillane (14) sandwich Steelers quarterback Aaron Rodgers, one of four Patriots sacks causing a fumble and knocking Pittsburgh out of field goal range.

BEN VOLIN  
ON FOOTBALL

Win masks Maye's mistakes

FOXBOROUGH — The Patriots' offense scored just one touchdown and lost two turnovers in Sunday's 20-3 win over the Steelers, but Mike Vrabel was in no mood to dwell on the negatives.

"Just trying to win the game, Ben," Vrabel said in response to a question from a certain Globe reporter. "You're not going to ruin my Sunday."

The Patriots improved to 1-1 with a comfortable, 17-point victory. The day had all the trappings of another big win — the fans belting out "Living on a Prayer" late in the fourth quarter, and

Vrabel greeting his players with smiles and handshakes as they entered the locker room.

But Drake Maye and the offense nearly ruined Vrabel's day. The win was a one-sided performance, with the defense throttling Aaron Rodgers and returning a fumble 19 yards for a touchdown in the fourth quarter to seal the victory.

Maye, though, once again looked less like last year's MVP runner-up and more like a young quarterback struggling to find his footing in the NFL.

Maye completed 14 of 22 passes for 208 yards, taking three sacks and throwing a bad interception in the third quarter, his fourth this season.

"Definitely not where we want to be," Maye said of the offense. "You have got to be excited, and enjoy the win, but at the same time, you realize that playing like this is not going to end up with offensively, us leading our team to wins."

The theme of their day was inefficiency — only 327 total yards, 4 for 12 on third down, and 0 for 1 in the red zone. The struggles were certainly not all on Maye, but the Patriots' young quarterback has not picked up where he ended last regular season. The offense scored just 10 points in the loss to

ON FOOTBALL, Page C5

NFL SCORES WEEK 2

|          |       |          |    |            |       |
|----------|-------|----------|----|------------|-------|
| Patriots | 20    | Saints   | 24 | Packers    | OT 20 |
| Steelers | 3     | Ravens   | 17 | Jets       | 17    |
| Panthers | 34    | Bengals  | 20 | Browns     | 23    |
| Falcons  | 3     | Texans   | 6  | Buccaneers | 19    |
| Eagles   | 24    | Raiders  | 26 | Cowboys    | 37    |
| Titans   | 20    | Chargers | 14 | Commanders | 20    |
| Vikings  | 9     | Broncos  | 20 | Seahawks   | 31    |
| Bears    | 3     | Jaguars  | 13 | Cardinals  | 7     |
| Chiefs   | OT 33 | 49ers    | 35 |            |       |
| Colts    | 30    | Dolphins | 13 |            |       |

INSIDE

**Ugly endings**  
Late mistakes cost Legacy at home against Houston. **C8**

**In the swing**  
McCormack, Xaverian tops at damp Cape Cod National golf. **C8**

**Stepping up**  
Milford fights back to secure statement win on the gridiron. **C8**

**Good eggs**  
Mississippi passes LSU in college football poll after revenge win. **C9**

Brunet getting his chance

Defenseman has been paired with McAvoy

By Jim McBride  
GLOBE STAFF

**Bruins 3**  
**Capitals 2**

The Bruins have big plans for Frederic Brunet.

After playing 183 games across parts of four seasons with Providence, the smooth skating defenseman is being given every opportunity to secure a Boston address for the season.

For starters, Marco Sturm has had Brunet joined at Charlie McAvoy's hip for the preseason, which started Sunday night at

TD Garden with 3-2 shootout win over the Capitals.

Playing alongside one the NHL's upper echelon defensemen allows Brunet to play without looking over his shoulder, knowing McAvoy can keep things calm on the back end. It's not unlike 2017 when Bruce Cassidy paired McAvoy with Zdeno Chara.

"I think it's a great starting point for a guy like Brunet getting into this league. We have high hopes on him," Sturm said. "We wanted to develop him the right way. I think Charlie will give us the right start for a guy like him and not just our coaches. So, I just want them to play a solid game and

BRUINS, Page C8



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

Michael DiPietro was unable to stop Jonny Brodzinski's bid in the first period.

Baseball

Rotation is lining up for postseason

By Peter Abraham  
GLOBE STAFF

ST. PETERSBURG, Fla. — The Red Sox will start **Payton Tolle**, **Sonny Gray**, and **Ranger Suarez** in the series against the Guardians that starts Tuesday at Fenway Park.

**RED SOX NOTEBOOK**

That would conceivably line them up for the Wild Card Series that starts on Sept. 29 with six days rest each.

“Don’t read into that yet,” interim manager **Chad Tracy** said Sunday before a 5-1 loss against the Rays. “We can line that up still however we want.”

True. But Tolle has a 2.44 ERA in his last eight starts. He also has faced the Yankees twice this season and allowed one run on four hits over 13 innings with three walks and 18 strikeouts.

Gray allowed three runs on nine hits over 13⅓ innings in two starts against the Yankees. He struck out 12 and walked three.

Guerrero returns

Righthanded reliever **Tyron Guerrero** returned from a 19-day stint on the injured list with shoulder inflammation. Righthanded reliever **Wyatt Olds** was optioned to Triple-A Worcester.

Guerrero pitched a perfect eighth inning, striking out two.

“Felt good to be out there,” Guerrero said. “If I get a few more games I’ll be fine [for the postseason].”

Guerrero, 35, was called up in May for his first major league stint since 2019. He emerged as a reliable late-inning option, posting a 3.18 ERA over 39 games.

“He’s obviously a very important piece to this puzzle in our bullpen,” Tracy said.

Olds deserved a better fate. The 27-year-old has a 1.20 ERA and 1.20 WHIP in 13 games since making his major league debut on Aug. 17.

“Very tough. He’s thrown the ball great. He’s got big stuff,” Tracy said. “We had to make a roster decision.”



PHELAN M. EBENHACK/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Jahmai Jones came in as a pinch hitter with a runner on second in the eighth, but he struck out to end the inning.

Contreras doing better

**Willson Contreras** took some swings in the batting cage to test his bruised right hand and came through fine. He hopes to be able to do more on Tuesday. “Step in the right direction,” Tracy said . . . There was no update on **Garrett Crochet**, who has yet to face hitters. That could come in the next few days . . . **Tanner Houck** had a 3.38 ERA over eight innings in four minor league games. Tracy suggested he would face hitters in a simulated game early this week. “Figuring out the next steps at home — and want to figure that out — but no plans for the next outing,” Tracy said. Could Houck be acti-

vated? “It’s possible,” Tracy said. “At this point, it’s going to depend very much on where’s the roster at, what are the needs.” . . . Rays shortstop **Taylor Walls** showed his baseball acumen in the first inning. With **Roman Anthony** on first and one out, he allowed **Adley Rutschman’s** pop-up to drop. Walls picked up the ball and flipped to second to get the force on Anthony. That left the Sox with a slower runner on first. It ultimately didn’t matter as **Trevor Story** struck out . . . Worcester, as Double-A Portland also did last weekend, had its final game rained out. The WooSox finished 76-67. **Kutter Crawford** was at Polar Park, and the plan was

to have him start what would have been a bullpen game. Crawford has not appeared in the majors since Sept. 28, 2024. He missed the 2025 season because of an injured right knee. He injured his right wrist in August of that season doing yard work at his home in Florida. Crawford pitched three innings for Worcester on April 11, but had a setback and wasn’t cleared for another game until Sunday. “He got to a point where he wanted to go out there and throw one,” Tracy said.

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AL wild card

|                      | W         | L         | Pct.        | GB |
|----------------------|-----------|-----------|-------------|----|
| p-New York.....      | 89        | 66        | .574        | —  |
| <b>p-Boston.....</b> | <b>84</b> | <b>72</b> | <b>.538</b> | —  |
| Chicago .....        | 80        | 76        | .513        | —  |
| Toronto .....        | 77        | 79        | .494        | 3  |
| Houston.....         | 77        | 79        | .494        | 3  |
| Baltimore .....      | 75        | 81        | .481        | 5  |

Rays 5, Red Sox 1

| At Tropicana Field, St. Petersburg |           |          |          |          |          |          |      |  |  |  |  |  |
|------------------------------------|-----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|------|--|--|--|--|--|
| BOSTON                             | AB        | R        | H        | BI       | BB       | SO       | Avg. |  |  |  |  |  |
| Anthony lf                         | 4         | 0        | 2        | 0        | 0        | 1        | .241 |  |  |  |  |  |
| Gasper dh                          | 3         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | 2        | .255 |  |  |  |  |  |
| a-Jones ph-dh                      | 1         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | 1        | .209 |  |  |  |  |  |
| Rutschman c                        | 4         | 0        | 1        | 0        | 0        | 1        | .234 |  |  |  |  |  |
| Story ss                           | 4         | 1        | 1        | 1        | 0        | 1        | .247 |  |  |  |  |  |
| Sogard 1b                          | 4         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | 2        | .250 |  |  |  |  |  |
| Durbin 3b                          | 4         | 0        | 2        | 0        | 0        | 1        | .255 |  |  |  |  |  |
| Duran cf                           | 3         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 1        | 0        | .204 |  |  |  |  |  |
| Kliner-Falefa 2b                   | 3         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | 2        | .247 |  |  |  |  |  |
| Eaton rf                           | 2         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 1        | 0        | .133 |  |  |  |  |  |
| <b>Totals</b>                      | <b>32</b> | <b>1</b> | <b>6</b> | <b>1</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>9</b> |      |  |  |  |  |  |

| TAMPA BAY     | AB        | R        | H        | BI       | BB       | SO       | Avg. |
|---------------|-----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|------|
| Diaz dh       | 3         | 1        | 0        | 0        | 1        | 0        | .252 |
| Vilade 1b     | 3         | 1        | 0        | 0        | 0        | 1        | .256 |
| Caminero 3b   | 4         | 1        | 1        | 0        | 0        | 1        | .277 |
| DeLuca cf     | 4         | 1        | 1        | 2        | 0        | 2        | .259 |
| Simpson lf    | 3         | 0        | 1        | 2        | 0        | 0        | .309 |
| Williamson 2b | 3         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .244 |
| Fortes c      | 3         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | 2        | .264 |
| Mesa Jr. rf   | 2         | 1        | 1        | 1        | 1        | 0        | .251 |
| Walls ss      | 3         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | 1        | .216 |
| <b>Totals</b> | <b>28</b> | <b>5</b> | <b>4</b> | <b>5</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>7</b> |      |

|                 |      |      |      |   |   |   |   |
|-----------------|------|------|------|---|---|---|---|
| Boston .....    | .000 | .000 | .001 | — | 1 | 6 | 0 |
| Tampa Bay ..... | .400 | 1.00 | .00x | — | 5 | 4 | 0 |

a-struck out for Gasper in 8th. **LOB**—Boston 6, Tampa Bay 2. **2B**—Anthony (9), DeLuca (22). **HR**—Story (5), off Johnson, Mesa Jr. (14), off Sandoval. **SB**—Simpson (46). **Runners left in scoring position**—Boston 4 (Anthony 2, Jones, Duran), Tampa Bay 1 (Walls). **RISP**—Boston 0 for 4, Tampa Bay 3 for 4. **GDP**—Story. **DP**—Tampa Bay 1 (Walls, Williamson, Vilade).

| Boston         | IP | H | R | ER | BB | SO | NP | ERA  |
|----------------|----|---|---|----|----|----|----|------|
| Sandoval L 1-7 | 7  | 4 | 5 | 5  | 2  | 5  | 94 | 5.15 |
| Guerrero       | 1  | 0 | 0 | 0  | 0  | 2  | 12 | 3.18 |

| Tampa Bay  | IP | H | R | ER | BB | SO | NP | ERA  |
|------------|----|---|---|----|----|----|----|------|
| Jax W 8-10 | 5  | 3 | 0 | 0  | 2  | 5  | 74 | 3.62 |
| Sulser     | 1  | 0 | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | 11 | 4.39 |
| Hopkins    | 1  | 0 | 0 | 0  | 0  | 2  | 14 | 6.00 |
| Matz       | 1  | 1 | 0 | 0  | 0  | 1  | 14 | 5.49 |
| Johnson    | ½  | 2 | 1 | 1  | 0  | 1  | 13 | 5.79 |
| KKelly     | ½  | 0 | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | 6  | 2.49 |

**Inherited runners scored**—KKelly 1-0. **HBP**—by Sandoval (Vilade). **Umpires**—Home, Adam Beck; First, Dan Iassogna; Second, Brock Ballou; Third, Jeremie Rehak. T—2:21. A—24,654 (25,025).

HOW THE RUNS SCORED

**FIRST INNING**  
RAYS — Diaz walked on four pitches. Vilade was hit by a pitch, Diaz to second. Caminero singled to left, Diaz to third, Vilade to second. DeLuca doubled to left, Diaz scored. Vilade scored. Caminero to third. Simpson singled to right, Caminero scored, DeLuca scored. Williamson filed out to center fielder Duran. Fortes struck out. Simpson stole second. Mesa Jr. walked on a full count. Walls filed out to center fielder Duran.

**FOURTH INNING**  
RAYS — Fortes filed out to left fielder Anthony. Mesa Jr. homered to right on a 2-2 count. Walls filed out on a bunt to pitcher Sandoval. Diaz filed out to left fielder Anthony.

**NINTH INNING**  
RED SOX — Johnson pitching. Rutschman struck out. Story homered to left on a 2-1 count. Sogard filed out to shortstop Walls. Durbin singled to left. Kelly pitching. On defensive indifference, Durbin to second. Duran grounded out, shortstop Walls to first baseman Vilade.



PHELAN M. EBENHACK/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Trevor Story (right) was all that kept the Red Sox from being shut out, via his one-out solo home run in the ninth inning.

Red Sox clinch playoff spot despite loss

►RED SOX  
Continued from Page C1

the Sox their spot, and the celebration started.

It seemed fitting that Mike Yastrzemski, the grandson of Red Sox great Carl Yastrzemski, won the game for Atlanta with a three-run homer in the sixth inning.

The Sox gathered on the field for a team photo, then enjoyed a well-earned, raucous celebration in the visiting clubhouse at Tropicana Field. That included first baseman Willson Contreras hooking up a hose and dousing his teammates with cold water before quieting the room to speak.

“This is what we play for,” he said. “This is why we’re here.”

There’s still work to be done to be ready for what’s ahead. The Sox were 2-4 on their road trip and are 11-13 since Aug. 26. They were 1 for 15 with runners in scoring position the last two games, leaving 14 men on base.

Patrick Sandoval (1-7) allowed four runs during a 40-pitch first inning and took the loss.

“Legit nightmare situation,” he said. Sandoval completed seven innings and

allowed only one more run. After the long first inning, he threw 54 pitches over the next six and faced only 19 batters.

The Sox had a chance to get back in the game in the fifth inning when they loaded the bases with two outs, but Roman Anthony struck out against Griffin Jax.

They didn’t punch back until Trevor Story hit a solo home run off Ty Johnson in the ninth inning. That was much too late to matter.

But Contreras did not play in the series because of a bruised right hand and Abreu had Sunday off for a much-needed rest. A third All-Star, center fielder Ceddanne Rafaela, should come off the injured list on Tuesday.

“Obviously we’ve got to hit and score runs. But we’re getting our way back to health and we’ll get there,” Tracy said.

He and his coaches observed the party from its perimeter, several of them enjoying a cigar while wearing ski goggles to protect their eyes from a rainstorm of champagne and beer.

Tracy, pitching coach Andrew Bailey, and bench coach José David Flores were among the most soaked.

Tracy reflected on the long road his

team took to get to that celebration.

“It wasn’t on our mind at the beginning,” he said. “At the beginning, we had a long way to go. It’s like, ‘How do we get on track and get things moving in the right direction?’

“When the end of June hit, and things started to go, and we started to see things come together, it became very much on our mind. So I’m just really happy for our guys.”

Because of all they went through, the Sox could be a tough out once the postseason starts.

“We’re going to show up. We’ll be ready,” said righthander Garrett Whitlock, who played for the 2021 team that advanced to the American League Championship Series.

“You can’t worry about what happened in the past. It’s one game at a time in the postseason. We didn’t get here the way we expected to get here. But now we have a chance.”

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It’s fitting they had extra wait to celebrate

►SULLIVAN  
Continued from Page C1

now properly dressed for celebration, the pent up emotion of a long, trying, and tumultuous season could be heard all the way back in Boston.

“I think it was just relief,” breakout starter Payton Tolle said in describing the scene later, when reporters and cameras were allowed in to wade through the river of beer and duck the sprays of champagne that flowed in front of walled-off locker stalls. “I think there’s also just that feeling of like, ‘Man, we’ve come a long way.’ You know, we’re going to enjoy this and be proud of it. It was a whole lot of fun.

“Obviously, you want to win, but being in is the most important thing.”

And somehow, some way, the Red Sox are in. From the despair of a coaching staff change on April 25 and the depths of a 32-46 record on June 24, they rallied, regrouped, and managed to turn themselves into a playoff team. Given the obstacles, why would the final step come easy?

Because joy delayed is not joy denied, and ultimately, in the burst of cheers heard emanating from the room when they clinched to the thumping music and raucous shouts in the celebration when they returned, the soundtrack of a playoff team was written.

“At the beginning, we had a long way to go,” said interim manager Chad Tracy, whose ability to marshal the troops in the wake of Alex Cora’s stunning dismissal anchored the team in those turbulent times. “It’s like, ‘How do we get on track and get things moving in the right direction?’ When the end of June hit and things started to go, and we started to see things come together, [the playoffs] became very much on our mind. So I’m just really happy for our guys.

“They came together and they found a way to get it done. They had a long way to go to do it, but they found a way to get it done. They stared almost an impossible task right in the face, and they refused to take no for an answer. They’re very battle tested, and I’m super, super proud of them.”

If one word emerged from the exuberant, soaking celebra-

tion, it was ‘pride.’ That was the sentiment channeled by Willson Contreras, who managed to quiet the cacophony long enough to address teammates with a short, emotional speech.

“We create a good family here, good chemistry throughout the season,” he said, still holding the water sprayer he was using to rinse his face as players all turned his way. “We just needed time, and the time came for us. And what’s the most important thing to me is that everybody never stopped working. Everybody was finding a way to make adjustments and play the game the right way. This is what we play for. This is what we’re going for. This is just the first step ahead. This is the postseason, and I just wanted to let everybody know that I’m proud of them.”

A chorus of “Hell, yeah!” ended the speech and reopened the floodgates, and on the Red Sox go, through the final six regular-season games at Fenway and then (almost certainly) back to New York for a redux of the three-game, do-or-die Wild Card Series clash with the rival Yankees. But as much as this feels like a do-over of a series the Yankees took by winning Games 2 and 3 last year, this is far from the same Red Sox team.

Cora and Co. are gone. Sonny Gray, Tolle, and Ranger Suarez are the bedrocks of a rotation that, after Garrett Crochet last year, couldn’t match the Yanks. Contreras, a World Series winner, was acquired in the offseason, while Roman Anthony, who missed last year’s playoffs with an injury, made it back from another this year to rejoin the team in August.

“I felt this a little bit last year but obviously being injured, I am so happy to be part of it now,” Anthony said. “It’s just an amazing feeling. Obviously, we wanted to win [today’s game], but the way it happened, being together watching that [Houston] game, it was amazing.”

And, somehow, fitting. Nothing came easy for these Red Sox all season. Why start now? As Tracy said, they are battle tested, and ready for more.

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Baseball

Yastrzemski HR helps Braves win NL East

ASSOCIATED PRESS

**Mike Yastrzemski** hit a three-run homer in a four-run sixth inning, and the Braves clinched the NL East title for the seventh time in nine years with a 4-2 win over the Astros in Houston on Sunday.

NOTEBOOK

**Ozzie Albies** tied it with an RBI single before Yastrzemski's homer off **Bryan King** (3-6).

After missing the playoffs last season, Atlanta rebounded under first-year manager **Walt Weiss**.

The Astros trail the Rangers by a game in the AL West, but own the tiebreaker.

**Jose Altuve** had a home run in the fourth inning, and **Yainer Diaz** hit one in the eighth, but the Astros left the bases loaded in the first and fifth.

After **Martín Pérez** allowed one run on six hits in 4½ innings, **Victor Mederos** (5-1) entered with the bases loaded and struck out Altuve before inducing a ground out by Diaz to end the fifth.

Diamondbacks slam Yankees

**Nolan Arenado** hit his third grand slam of the season to help the Diamondbacks beat the Yankees, 8-4, in Phoenix.

Arenado connected off reliever **Brent Headrick** (7-4) in the fifth inning. The Diamondbacks loaded the bases against Yankee starter **Will Warren**. Headrick entered and fanned **Geraldo Perdomo** for the second out, but walked **Corbin Carroll** to force in a run before Arenado's ninth career slam.

Arizona's MLB-best 47th comeback win kept it four games behind the Phillies for the NL's final wild-card spot with six left.

New York, with a slim chance to win the AL

East, starts a four-game set at home Tuesday against division-leading Tampa Bay.

Perdomo had a run-scoring single in the first and an RBI triple in the seventh.

**Heliot Ramos, George Lombard Jr., and Spencer Jones** homered for New York.

Sánchez picks up 18th win

**Christopher Sánchez** earned his major league-leading 18th win as the Phillies beat the Mets, 7-2, in New York to salvage a split of the four-game set.

Sánchez surrendered six hits — including **Bo Bichette's** sixth-inning homer — and struck out six over 6⅓ innings.

The last Phillies pitcher to lead the majors in wins was **Steve Carlton** with 23 in 1982.

**Justin Crawford** had a three-run triple, and **Lu-is Arraez** finished with two RBIs. **Alec Bohm** and **Trea Turner** each had run-scoring hits. **Kyle Schwarber** tied a career high with four walks.

**Jonah Tong** (2-2) gave up four runs and struck out five in 4¾ innings for the last-place Mets.

Guardians maintain division lead

**Gavin Williams** threw seven shutout innings, **Jo Adell** had an RBI infield single, and the Guardians beat the Athletics, 1-0, in Cleveland to stay one game ahead of the White Sox atop the AL Central.

Chicago had a rain-soaked 8-1 win that ended the visiting Tigers' playoff hopes. **Sam Antonacci** had a two-run double in the three-run fourth in a game delayed 3 hours, 50 minutes by rain.

The White Sox hold a three-game lead over the Astros and Blue Jays for the third AL wild card.

**Steven Kwan** added three hits for Cleveland,



JOE BUVID/GETTY IMAGES

Mike Yastrzemski's three-run shot helped the Braves beat the Astros and win the NL East.

which posted its seventh series sweep of the season and third at home.

Williams (14-8) gave up three hits and struck out nine to move into the AL lead with 244 strikeouts, five more than Toronto's **Dylan Cease**.

**Cade Smith** worked 1⅓ innings for his 39th save in 44 opportunities.

**José Ramírez** led off the fourth with a double, advanced to third on a fly out, and scored on Adell's infield single. **Jack Perkins** (3-12) fielded the soft grounder on the grass in front of the mound, but his throw hit Adell in the back.

| EAST            | W         | L         | Pct.        | GB         | WCGB | Last 10    | Streak     |
|-----------------|-----------|-----------|-------------|------------|------|------------|------------|
| p-Tampa Bay     | 95        | 60        | .613        | —          | —    | 8-2        | W 2        |
| p-New York      | 89        | 66        | .574        | 6          | —    | 6-4        | L 2        |
| <b>p-Boston</b> | <b>84</b> | <b>72</b> | <b>.538</b> | <b>11½</b> | —    | <b>4-6</b> | <b>L 2</b> |
| Toronto         | 77        | 79        | .494        | 18½        | 3    | 4-6        | W 1        |
| Baltimore       | 75        | 81        | .481        | 20½        | 5    | 5-5        | L 3        |
| CENTRAL         | W         | L         | Pct.        | GB         | WCGB | Last 10    | Streak     |
| Cleveland       | 81        | 75        | .519        | —          | —    | 7-3        | W 5        |
| Chicago         | 80        | 76        | .513        | 1          | —    | 5-5        | W 2        |
| Minnesota       | 73        | 83        | .468        | 8          | 7    | 4-6        | W 1        |
| Detroit         | 73        | 83        | .468        | 8          | 7    | 6-4        | L 2        |
| Kansas City     | 67        | 89        | .429        | 14         | 13   | 3-7        | L 4        |
| WEST            | W         | L         | Pct.        | GB         | WCGB | Last 10    | Streak     |
| Texas           | 78        | 78        | .500        | —          | —    | 6-4        | L 1        |
| Houston         | 77        | 79        | .494        | 1          | 3    | 3-7        | L 3        |
| Seattle         | 73        | 83        | .468        | 5          | 7    | 5-5        | W 1        |
| Athletics       | 61        | 95        | .391        | 17         | 19   | 3-7        | L 6        |
| Los Angeles     | 60        | 96        | .385        | 18         | 20   | 4-6        | L 1        |

| EAST          | W  | L  | Pct. | GB | WCGB | Last 10 | Streak |
|---------------|----|----|------|----|------|---------|--------|
| d-Atlanta     | 92 | 64 | .590 | —  | —    | 7-3     | W 3    |
| Philadelphia  | 86 | 70 | .551 | 6  | —    | 4-6     | W 1    |
| Miami         | 76 | 80 | .487 | 16 | 10   | 4-6     | L 3    |
| Washington    | 73 | 83 | .468 | 19 | 13   | 6-4     | L 1    |
| New York      | 71 | 85 | .455 | 21 | 15   | 3-7     | L 1    |
| CENTRAL       | W  | L  | Pct. | GB | WCGB | Last 10 | Streak |
| d-Milwaukee   | 98 | 58 | .628 | —  | —    | 8-2     | W 3    |
| Chicago       | 87 | 69 | .558 | 11 | —    | 6-4     | W 2    |
| Pittsburgh    | 79 | 77 | .506 | 19 | 7    | 6-4     | W 4    |
| St. Louis     | 76 | 80 | .487 | 22 | 10   | 4-6     | W 1    |
| Cincinnati    | 72 | 84 | .462 | 26 | 14   | 3-7     | L 2    |
| WEST          | W  | L  | Pct. | GB | WCGB | Last 10 | Streak |
| d-Los Angeles | 96 | 60 | .615 | —  | —    | 7-3     | W 4    |
| San Diego     | 87 | 69 | .558 | 9  | —    | 9-1     | W 5    |
| Arizona       | 82 | 74 | .526 | 14 | 4    | 4-6     | W 2    |
| San Francisco | 64 | 92 | .410 | 32 | 22   | 3-7     | L 3    |
| Colorado      | 57 | 99 | .365 | 39 | 29   | 2-8     | L 1    |

| RESULTS             |                 |                 |                 |
|---------------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| SUNDAY              |                 |                 |                 |
| At Tampa Bay 5      | Boston 1        | Toronto 7       | at Texas 2      |
| Philadelphia 7      | at NY Mets 2    | Seattle 2       | at Colorado 1   |
| At Pittsburgh 4     | Kansas City 3   | Minnesota 8     | at LA Angels 0  |
| At Cleveland 1      | Athletics 0     | At San Diego 7  | Miami 3         |
| Chi. Cubs 9         | at Cincinnati 1 | At Arizona 8    | NY Yankees 4    |
| Atlanta 4           | at Houston 2    | At LA Dodgers 3 | San Francisco 1 |
| At Chi. White Sox 8 | Detroit 1       | Milwaukee 3     | at Baltimore 0  |
| At St. Louis 5      | Washington 3    |                 |                 |

| SATURDAY            |                 |                          |                 |
|---------------------|-----------------|--------------------------|-----------------|
| At Tampa Bay 2      | Boston 1        | Atlanta 6                | at Houston 3    |
| At Chi. White Sox 3 | Detroit 1       | Washington 8 (11 inn.)   | at St. Louis 5  |
| Milwaukee 1         | at Baltimore 0  | At Arizona 5             | NY Yankees 3    |
| At NY Mets 10       | Philadelphia 3  | At Colorado 5            | Seattle 3       |
| At Cleveland 12     | Athletics 6     | At San Diego 7 (10 inn.) | Miami 6         |
| Chi. Cubs 5         | at Cincinnati 2 | At LA Dodgers 10         | San Francisco 4 |
| At Pittsburgh 6     | Kansas City 5   | At LA Angels 6 (11 inn.) | Minnesota 5     |
| At Texas 6          | Toronto 2       |                          |                 |



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Bryson Stott and the Phillies held their hold on the last NL wild-card spot by beating the Mets.

| MONDAY'S GAMES                                             |      |           |      |           |          |                         |      |     |      |      |
|------------------------------------------------------------|------|-----------|------|-----------|----------|-------------------------|------|-----|------|------|
|                                                            | Odds | .....2026 | Team | .....2026 | vs. opp. | .....Last 3 starts..... |      |     |      |      |
|                                                            |      | W-L       | ERA  | rec.      | W-L      | IP                      | ERA  | W-L | IP   | ERA  |
| TORONTO AT BALTIMORE, 6:35 p.m.                            |      |           |      |           |          |                         |      |     |      |      |
| Yesavage (R)                                               | -110 | 5-5       | 3.65 | 7-11      | 0-1      | 10.2                    | 5.91 | 1-0 | 12.2 | 2.84 |
| Baz (R)                                                    | -110 | 6-15      | 4.11 | 9-21      | 0-1      | 5.2                     | 1.59 | 1-1 | 16.0 | 5.06 |
| WASHINGTON AT DETROIT, 6:40 p.m.                           |      |           |      |           |          |                         |      |     |      |      |
| Cornelio (R)                                               | +135 | 3-2       | 4.22 | 1-1       | 0-0      | 0.0                     | 0.00 | 0-0 | 5.0  | 0.00 |
| Ryan (R)                                                   | -160 | -         | -    | 0-0       | 0-0      | 0.0                     | 0.00 | 0-0 | 0.0  | -    |
| MINNESOTA AT SAN FRANCISCO, 9:45 p.m.                      |      |           |      |           |          |                         |      |     |      |      |
| Ober (R)                                                   | -120 | 7-6       | 4.32 | 12-11     | 0-0      | 0.0                     | 0.00 | 0-2 | 14.2 | 3.07 |
| Roupp (R)                                                  | +100 | 9-14      | 4.01 | 10-19     | 0-0      | 0.0                     | 0.00 | 1-1 | 15.1 | 1.76 |
| Team rec. — Record in games started by pitcher this season |      |           |      |           |          |                         |      |     |      |      |

| CUBS 9, REDS 1  |     |     |     |    |    |    |      |                        |    | BRAVES  |   |    |    |    |      |  |  |  |  |
|-----------------|-----|-----|-----|----|----|----|------|------------------------|----|---------|---|----|----|----|------|--|--|--|--|
| CHI. CUBS       |     |     |     |    |    |    |      |                        |    | ATLANTA |   |    |    |    |      |  |  |  |  |
| PCArmstrong cf  | AB  | R   | H   | BI | BB | SO | Avg. | Baldwin c              | AB | R       | H | BI | BB | SO | Avg. |  |  |  |  |
| Suzuki rf       | 5   | 1   | 1   | 1  | 0  | 1  | .267 | Acuña Jr. dh           | 10 | 3       | 3 | 1  | 0  | 1  | .300 |  |  |  |  |
| Busch 1b        | 4   | 1   | 1   | 0  | 1  | 2  | .239 | Olson 1b               | 3  | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| Bregman 3b      | 1   | 1   | 1   | 1  | 0  | 0  | .262 | Harris II cf           | 4  | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| Shaw ph-2b      | 2   | 0   | 0   | 0  | 1  | 2  | .238 | Dubin 3b               | 2  | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| Happ lf         | 5   | 1   | 2   | 1  | 0  | 2  | .221 | Albies 2b              | 2  | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| Hoerner ss      | 4   | 0   | 1   | 1  | 1  | 0  | .265 | Yastrzemski lf         | 5  | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| Conforto dh     | 5   | 1   | 1   | 0  | 1  | 0  | .245 | Hicklen rf             | 4  | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| Ramirez 2b-3b   | 5   | 1   | 3   | 2  | 0  | 0  | .266 | Kim ss                 | 3  | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| Amaya c         | 5   | 1   | 3   | 2  | 0  | 0  | .234 | Totals                 | 33 | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| Totals          | 40  | 9   | 13  | 9  | 4  | 10 |      |                        |    |         |   |    |    |    |      |  |  |  |  |
| CINCINNATI      |     |     |     |    |    |    |      |                        |    | HOUSTON |   |    |    |    |      |  |  |  |  |
| Myers cf        | AB  | R   | H   | BI | BB | SO | Avg. | Peña ss                | AB | R       | H | BI | BB | SO | Avg. |  |  |  |  |
| Jorge ph-cf     | 1   | 0   | 0   | 0  | 0  | 0  | .120 | Alvarez lf             | 5  | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| De La Cruz ss   | 4   | 0   | 1   | 0  | 0  | 1  | .285 | Paredes 3b             | 4  | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| Brto 2b         | 0   | 0   | 0   | 0  | 0  | 0  | .325 | Diaz c                 | 2  | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| Stewart lf      | 4   | 0   | 0   | 0  | 1  | 2  | .268 | Wacker 1b              | 3  | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| Stephenson dh   | 4   | 0   | 0   | 0  | 2  | 3  | .246 | Can Smith rf           | 4  | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| Bleday rf-1b    | 3   | 1   | 1   | 1  | 0  | 0  | .215 | Allen 2b               | 3  | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| McLain 2b-ss    | 3   | 0   | 1   | 0  | 0  | 0  | .184 | Matthews cf            | 4  | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| OCabrera lf-3b  | 3   | 0   | 0   | 0  | 0  | 2  | .000 | Totals                 | 38 | 0       | 0 | 0  | 0  | 0  | .000 |  |  |  |  |
| Barfield c      | 3   | 0   | 1   | 0  | 0  | 1  | .200 | Atlanta                |    |         |   |    |    |    |      |  |  |  |  |
| Hayes 3b        | 2   | 0   | 0   | 0  | 0  | 0  | .145 | Houston                |    |         |   |    |    |    |      |  |  |  |  |
| Rodriguez ph-rf | 1   | 0   | 0   | 0  | 0  | 0  | .218 | E - Paredes (8), L     |    |         |   |    |    |    |      |  |  |  |  |
| Totals          | 31  | 1   | 4   | 1  | 1  | 8  |      | 2B - Dubin (28),       |    |         |   |    |    |    |      |  |  |  |  |
| Chi. Cubs       | 104 | 030 | 010 | —  | 9  | 13 | 1    | Keel, 3B - Olsen (10), |    |         |   |    |    |    |      |  |  |  |  |
| Cincinnati      | 000 | 100 | 000 | —  | 1  | 4  | 0    | Kerr, 1B - Acuña (10), |    |         |   |    |    |    |      |  |  |  |  |

E—Ramirez (4), LOB—Chi. Cubs 8, Cincinnati 4, 2B—Crow-**Armstrong** (38), Happ (27).  
HR—Crow-**Armstrong** (45), off Spiers, Suzuki (25), off Spiers, Conforto (15), off Spiers, Bleday (23), off Peterson, SB—Crow-**Armstrong** (38), De La Cruz (28), McLain (19). DP—Chi. Cubs 1.  
Chi. Cubs IP H R ER BB SO ERA  
Peterson W 9-8 6 3 1 1 0 7 4.96  
Thielbar 1 0 0 0 0 1 4.72  
ECabrera 1 0 0 0 0 0 5.67  
Rea 1 0 0 0 0 0 4.43

Cincinnati IP H R ER BB SO ERA  
Lowe L 6-12 3 6 5 5 3 3 6.01  
Mey 1 1 0 0 0 1 5.85  
Spiders 1 1 0 0 0 1 2.45  
Ashcraft 1 1 0 0 0 1 4.45

NP—Peterson 83, Thielbar 18, ECabrera 9, Rea 8, Lowe 60, Mey 20, Spiers 62, Ashcraft 17. **Umpires**—Home, D.J. Reybourn; First, James Hoye; Second, Sean Barber; Third, John Libka. T—231. A—28,917 (48,814).

| PHILLIES 7, METS 2   |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | TORONTO             |  |
|----------------------|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|---------------------|--|
|                      |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Bateman cf          |  |
|                      |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Gerrero Jr. 1b      |  |
|                      |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Lukes rf            |  |
|                      |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Okech 3b-1b-3b      |  |
|                      |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Kymts dh            |  |
|                      |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Spinger ph-dh       |  |
|                      |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | McAdoo ph-1b        |  |
|                      |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Gimenez ss          |  |
|                      |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Valenzuela c        |  |
|                      |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Clement 2b          |  |
|                      |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | TOTALS              |  |
| NY METS              |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Langford lf         |  |
| AB R H BI BB SO Avg. |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Seager dh           |  |
| 5 0 1 0 0 2 .224     |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Jung 3b             |  |
| 4 0 1 1 0 1 .273     |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Duran ss            |  |
| 4 1 1 0 1 .263       |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Osuna rf            |  |
| 4 0 1 0 1 .218       |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Burger 1b           |  |
| 4 0 0 0 1 .219       |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Lopez 2b            |  |
| 4 1 2 0 1 .232       |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Fosce ph-2b         |  |
| 2 0 0 0 1 .176       |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Janssen c           |  |
| 2 2 0 0 0 .257       |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Carter cf           |  |
| 2 0 1 0 0 .244       |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Totals              |  |
| 1 0 1 1 0 .235       |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | TORONTO             |  |
| 3 Senga p            |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | LOB.                |  |
| 0 0 0 0 0 —          |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Texas, 202          |  |
| 0 0 0 0 0 —          |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Keys (2), McAdoo    |  |
| 1 0 0 0 0 .181       |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Burger 1b, Off Arm  |  |
| 37 2 10 2 0 8        |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | Torres 1b, Texas 2. |  |
| Philadelphia         |  |  |  |  |  |  |  | 202 000 030 — 7 7 0 |  |

LOB—Philadelphia 8, NY Mets 8, 2B—Turner (28), Vientos (10), 3B—Crawford (5).  
HR—Bichette (17), off Sánchez. SF—Arraez. DP—NY Mets 1.

Philadelphia IP H R ER BB SO ERA  
Sánchez W 18-6 6½ 6 2 2 0 6 2.93  
McFarlane ½ 2 0 0 0 1 2.35  
Shugg 1 1 0 0 0 1 2.31  
Alvarado 1 1 0 0 0 1 5.02  
NY Mets IP H R ER BB SO ERA  
Tong L 2-2 4½ 5 4 4 4 5 4.21  
Weisenburger 1½ 0 0 0 0 2 2.31  
Yan 1 0 0 0 1 1 4.00  
Roddien 3b 2 0 0 0 2 3 7.46  
Senga ½ 2 0 3 3 0 7.46  
Warren 1½ 0 0 1 0 4.13  
Inherited runners-scored—McFarlane 1-1, Weisenburger 2-4, Warren 2-0. WP—Senga. NP—Sánchez 98, McFarlane 18, Shugg 15, Alvarado 18, Tong 95, Weisenburger 13, Yan 20, Senga 26, Warren 23. **Umpires**—Home, Tyler Jones; First, Ramon De Jesus; Second, Paul Clemens; Third, Quinn Wolcott. T—316. A—33,611 (41,922).

| MARINERS 2, ROCKIES 1 |           |          |          |          |          |          |  |
|-----------------------|-----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|--|
| SEATTLE               |           |          |          |          |          |          |  |
| AB                    | R         | H        | BI       | BB       | SO       | Avg.     |  |
| Crawford ss           | 4         | 1        | 1        | 0        | 1        | .222     |  |
| Arozarena lf          | 3         | 1        | 0        | 0        | 1        | .279     |  |
| Canzone rf            | 4         | 0        | 2        | 2        | 0        | .261     |  |
| Raleigh c             | 3         | 0        | 0        | 1        | 1        | .182     |  |
| Rodriguez cf          | 0         | 0        | 1        | 0        | 0        | .243     |  |
| Naylor 1b             | 4         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .268     |  |
| Young 2b              | 3         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .246     |  |
| Montes dh             | 2         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 1        | .211     |  |
| Roddien 3b            | 2         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .200     |  |
| Arroyo ph             | 1         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .350     |  |
| WestWilson 3b         | 0         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .213     |  |
| <b>Totals</b>         | <b>29</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>4</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>3</b> | <b>6</b> |  |
| COLORADO              |           |          |          |          |          |          |  |
| AB                    | R         | H        | BI       | BB       | SO       | Avg.     |  |
| McCarthy lf-cf        | 4         | 0        | 1        | 0        | 0        | .297     |  |
| Norby 3b              | 4         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 2        | .242     |  |
| Goodman dh            | 1         | 1        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .245     |  |
| Rumfield 1b           | 3         | 0        | 0        | 1        | 0        | .300     |  |
| Veen pr               | 0         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .237     |  |
| Carrigg cf-ss         | 4         | 0        | 1        | 0        | 0        | .271     |  |
| Amador 2b             | 3         | 0        | 1        | 0        | 1        | .284     |  |
| Brusillivan c         | 4         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .231     |  |
| Beck rf               | 2         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .195     |  |
| Johnston ph-rf        | 1         | 0        | 1        | 0        | 0        | .281     |  |
| Tovar ss              | 2         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .215     |  |
| Moniak ph-1b          | 1         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .241     |  |
| <b>32 Totals</b>      | <b>32</b> | <b>0</b> | <b>1</b> | <b>2</b> | <b>1</b> | <b>4</b> |  |

| CARDINALS     |           |          |          |          |          |          |  |
|---------------|-----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|--|
| WASHINGTON    |           |          |          |          |          |          |  |
| AB            | R         | H        | BI       | BB       | SO       | Avg.     |  |
| Wood dh       | 4         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .200     |  |
| Chaparro 1b   | 2         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .182     |  |
| Tritz ph-1b   | 3         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .268     |  |
| Brusse 3b     | 3         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .246     |  |
| Vivas ph-3b   | 3         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .211     |  |
| Craws rf      | 4         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .246     |  |
| Lewis lf      | 3         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .200     |  |
| Ford c        | 2         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .246     |  |
| Reich ph      | 1         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .213     |  |
| Yuzp c        | 0         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .213     |  |
| Nonez ss      | 0         | 0        | 0        | 0        | 0        | .213     |  |
| <b>Totals</b> | <b>29</b> | <b>0</b> | <b>0</b> | <b>0</b> | <b>0</b> | <b>0</b> |  |

FootballMonday

# Patriots commit to ground game

Running backs average 4.9 yards a carry in win

By Christopher Price  
GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — Reggie Gilliam smiled. “It was a ground and pound day,” the full-back said with a grin following New England’s 20-3 win over the Steelers.

As offensive lineman Morgan Moses’s sons wrestled in the middle of the Patriots’ locker room — and chatted with “Uncle Will” Campbell — Rhamondre Stevenson and the rest of the running backs were able to laugh in the aftermath.

“It felt good, getting the run game going a little bit,” Stevenson said.

On an afternoon where the passing game looked wobbly at best, New England got a boost from its backfield. Gilliam helped clear a path for Stevenson (six carries, 43 yards) and TreVeyon Henderson (16 carries, 76 yards, one touchdown) in the win.

In the end, the Patriots finished with 136 yards on 28 carries (a gaudy 4.9 yards per).

“We knew their front seven is extremely physical, and they like to move around a lot,” Gilliam said of the Steelers. “So we knew we were going to have our work cut out for us up front. But at the end of the day, it’s just getting a hat on a hat and let the runners find the holes. And they got the job done.”

In the days leading up to Sunday, offensive coordinator Josh McDaniels preached staying committed to the run, arguing the short runs in the first half eventually turn into longer runs down the stretch because you can wear out the opposition. That was the case against the Steelers.

“You keep running the same thing, and eventually, one of those plays is going to pop because the nature of the game is just so violent, so physical,” Gilliam said. “Maybe the defensive end or maybe the nose tackle is not going to fire off as hard as he did on the first play of the day. So it’s just being patient and letting it develop, and we were able to do that today.”

Even after a first-quarter fumble — which brought back scary memories of last year’s ball security issues in a Week 3 loss to the Steelers — Stevenson found success, pairing with Henderson to play a sizable role in the win as a runner and in pass protection.

“I think the O-line and Reggie made some holes for us to run through, and it was getting to the second level of the backers,” Stevenson said. “It kind of made it easy for the running backs.”

It was a bruising afternoon. The Patriots lost several players on both sides of the ball, but their appetite for physical football never waned. Wide receiver DeMario Douglas, one of the smallest players on the roster at 5 feet 8 inches and 185 pounds, delivered a key block to help spring Henderson on a 39-yard touchdown run in the first quarter.

It was the longest run from scrimmage over the first two games for the Patriots, and second-most explosive play of the day, trailing only the 63-yard pass to Romeo Doubs later in the afternoon.

“I mean, I got to display my blocking today. You feel me?” said Douglas with a smile. “There’s where a lot of question marks came in about me. I couldn’t block. So you know, I had to just make a little statement real quick today. It felt good.”

“It was great,” Henderson said. “That’s something coach [Mike] Vrabel has been

mentioning — that we really need [explosive] plays. I couldn’t have done it without the offensive linemen, the receivers, and the tight ends. Everybody just doing their job. It’s a team game. I can’t do it by myself, I need those guys up front. I appreciate them taking care of the dirty work.”

“That’s what you need,” Vrabel said. “We talked about, to create [explosive] plays offensively, you need great execution and extra efforts. We had good execution, and then Pop [Douglas] provided the extra effort to spring the block that got TreVeyon into the end zone.”

Sunday marked the first game of the season for Henderson, who was out with an ankle issue in the season opener. A powerful and dynamic runner, he brings a unique skill set to the Patriots’ offense.

“He can do it all,” Stevenson said of Henderson. “He’s a three-down back, in my eyes. He runs hard. He’s super-fast, and he’s very coachable. He’s willing to learn, and he’s coming here, you know, Monday through Saturday, learning as much as you can, and goes out and performs on Sundays.”

Ultimately, while the success or failure of the Patriots will rely largely on the quarterback, Sunday’s win was a reminder that the ground-and-pound approach can still pay dividends.

“The bottom line is that [there’s] going to come a time where we need to throw the ball. There’s going to be a game where we need to run it,” Douglas said. “Today, we needed to run it. And it felt good to be able to run it and win the game.”

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DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Patriots right guard Mike Onwenu was carted off during the first quarter of Sunday’s win over Pittsburgh with a right ankle injury.

## First win comes at a cost as injuries pile up

►PATRIOTS  
Continued from Page C1

with his left arm in a sling.

“We ask everybody each week to prepare as a starter,” Vrabel said. “I know that sometimes that’s hard. Sometimes guys prepare really hard to be a starter and they don’t end up playing or having a major role. Then, sometimes, like today, they have to be ready to go.”

The injury to Onwenu looked particularly ugly. After Steelers defensive end Derrick Harmon sacked Drake Maye for a loss of 3 yards, edge rusher T.J. Watt rolled up on Onwenu and caused him to fall over. Onwenu remained on the ground in obvious pain while some of his teammates kneeled around him.

Athletic trainers tended to Onwenu, before a cart drove on the field to take him back to the locker room. Right tackle Morgan Moses came over to spend an extra moment with Onwenu.

“It’s been a pleasure to be able to play beside somebody so dominant,” Moses said. “I can’t sit here and say I could do all these things myself without having a good partner in crime. Any time you lose somebody of that caliber, it’s hard. Mike knows we got him. We’ll do anything for him. The biggest thing is keeping him around here and keeping him a part of this team.”

Onwenu, the longest-tenured Patriot, is a major loss for New England’s revamped offensive line. During his seven-year tenure, Onwenu has played multiple positions and served as a bright spot in a position group that has often struggled.

The 28-year-old Onwenu is set to become a free agent at the end of the 2026 season. He carries the team’s third-highest salary cap number, \$17.5 million.

The interior offensive line was a thin spot for the Patriots, who lost Ben Brown to a knee injury in the preseason opener and had to sign Greg Van Roten in mid-August. Brown returned to practice this week and was active for Sunday’s game — a promising sign for his availability moving forward — but Van Roten entered in Onwenu’s place.

“You prepare as a starter, hoping everybody stays healthy,” Van Roten said. “The ‘next man up’ is such a cliché, but it’s very true. You want to make sure you have depth because your roster and your depth is going to get tested throughout the year. Unfortunately, it’s Week 2.”

Onwenu’s injury seems to be the most severe of the bunch, but extended absences to Jones and Woodson would be significant.

Jones serves as a veteran presence on the edge, especially with Harold Landry still on the physically unable to perform list. The rest of New England’s edge rushers are young, albeit promising — second-year player Elijah Ponder, second-round draft pick Gabe Jacas, and seventh-rounder Quintayvious Hutchins.

The Patriots still managed to pressure Aaron Rodgers consistently on Sunday, forcing two fumbles and registering four sacks on seven quarterback hits.

“These guys have all been practicing and working really hard,” Vrabel said. “You look over there and [the Steelers] have T.J. Watt,

[Alex] Highsmith, and [Nick] Herbig. And we’ve got Ponder, Jacas, and Q. I’m proud of our guys for going out there and being ready.”

Woodson, meanwhile, has been a mainstay in the secondary since getting drafted in the fourth round last year. He led the defense in playing time last year and did not miss a snap alongside Kevin Byard in Week 1. With Pettus also sidelined, Jaylen Reed, whom the Patriots acquired in late August in exchange for Kayshon Boutte, filled in for Woodson.

“Some of these guys hadn’t been here for more than two weeks or so, and they played for us,” Vrabel said. “That’s a great thing that they were ready to go. We have to get healthy and figure out who’s available next week for a huge challenge.”

The Patriots already were playing without cornerback Carlton Davis, who did not practice Thursday or Friday because of a neck injury.

Up next for the 1-1 Patriots are two tough conference opponents on the road. They’ll travel to face the Jaguars next Sunday and then the Bills on Oct. 4 — potentially without some important pieces.

“That’s football,” Moses said. “When we go to war everyday, we play a dangerous game. We build a bond, we build team chemistry, and we build a family before anything. We always believe in the next guy up.”

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|          |   |   |   |   |   |
|----------|---|---|---|---|---|
|          | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | F |
| STEELERS | 0 | 3 | 0 | 0 | 3 |

|          |   |   |   |   |    |
|----------|---|---|---|---|----|
| PATRIOTS | 7 | 3 | 3 | 7 | 20 |
|----------|---|---|---|---|----|

At Gillette Stadium, Foxborough Attendance: 64,628. Time: 2:54.

|                         |       |
|-------------------------|-------|
| Net yards rushing       |       |
| PIT                     | 91    |
| NE                      | 136   |
| Net yards passing       |       |
| PIT                     | 144   |
| NE                      | 191   |
| Total net yards offense |       |
| PIT                     | 235   |
| NE                      | 327   |
| Time of possession      |       |
| Pit                     | 32:47 |
| NE                      | 27:13 |

|               |                         |        |         |
|---------------|-------------------------|--------|---------|
|               |                         | Pit    | NE      |
| First downs   | Total                   | 16     | 15      |
|               | Rushing                 | 4      | 7       |
|               | Passing                 | 10     | 6       |
|               | Penalties               | 2      | 2       |
|               | Third down              | 2-12   | 4-12    |
| Conversions   | Fourth down             | 1-1    | 0-0     |
|               | Red zone efficiency     | 0-1    | 0-1     |
|               | Attempts                | 23     | 28      |
| Rushing       | Average gain            | 4.0    | 4.9     |
|               | Comp.-att.-int.         | 23-40  | 14-22-1 |
|               | Avg. gain per pass play | 3.3    | 7.6     |
| Passing       | Sacked-yards lost       | 4-43   | 3-17    |
|               | Plays, pass and rush    | 67     | 53      |
|               | Avg. gain per play      | 3.5    | 6.2     |
| Total offense | Total                   | 142    | 80      |
|               | Punt returns-yards      | 2-21   | 4-40    |
|               | Kick returns-yards      | 5-118  | 1-29    |
| Return yards  | Int. returns-yards      | 1-3    | 1-11    |
|               | Number-average          | 8-48.1 | 4-46.3  |
|               | Had blocked             | 0      | 0       |
| Penalties     | No.-yards               | 5-59   | 6-31    |
| Fumbles       | No.-lost                | 2-1    | 2-1     |

### Scoring summary

**FIRST QUARTER**  
**New England 7, Pittsburgh 0**  
TreVeyon Henderson 39 yd run (Andy Borregales kick). Drive: 4 plays, 49 yards, 1:55.  
**SECOND QUARTER**  
**New England 10, Pittsburgh 0**  
Andy Borregales 30 yd FG. Drive: 9 plays, 41 yards, 4:56.  
**New England 10, Pittsburgh 3**  
Chris Boswell 56 yd FG. Drive: 6 plays, 27 yards, 0:40.  
**THIRD QUARTER**  
**New England 13, Pittsburgh 3**  
Andy Borregales 45 yd FG. Drive: 5 plays, 65 yards, 1:29.  
**FOURTH QUARTER**  
**New England 20, Pittsburgh 3**  
Elijah Ponder 19 yd opp fumble return (Andy Borregales kick). Drive: NA.

| STEELERS STATISTICS                                  |      |      |      |      |      |                                                      |                 |      |      |      | PATRIOTS STATISTICS                           |                                               |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
|------------------------------------------------------|------|------|------|------|------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|------|------|------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|------|------|------|----|---|--|
| Rushing                                              |      |      |      |      |      | Rushing                                              |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Passing                                       |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
|                                                      | Att. | Yds. | Avg. | Lg   | TD   |                                                      | Att.            | Yds. | Avg. | Lg   | TD                                            |                                               | Att.           | Com.                                                              | Yds.                                                    | TD   | Int. | Lg   | TD |   |  |
| Warren.....                                          | 11   | 43   | 3.9  | 10   | 0    | Henderson .....                                      | 16              | 76   | 4.8  | 39   | 1                                             | Maye.....                                     | 22             | 14                                                                | 208                                                     | 0    | 1    | 63   | 0  |   |  |
| Dowdle.....                                          | 7    | 22   | 3.1  | 6    | 0    | Stevenson .....                                      | 6               | 43   | 7.2  | 24   | 0                                             | Pass receiving                                |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Homer.....                                           | 2    | 16   | 8.0  | 14   | 0    | Maye.....                                            | 4               | 17   | 4.3  | 13   | 0                                             | Tar.                                          | No.            | Yds.                                                              | Avg.                                                    | Lg   | TD   |      |    |   |  |
| Rodgers.....                                         | 1    | 5    | 5.0  | 5    | 0    | Kiner.....                                           | 2               | 0    | 0.0  | 2    | 0                                             | Doubs .....                                   | 4              | 3                                                                 | 96                                                      | 32.0 | 63   | 0    |    |   |  |
| Rudolph.....                                         | 1    | 3    | 3.0  | 3    | 0    |                                                      |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Henry.....                                    | 5              | 3                                                                 | 40                                                      | 13.3 | 29   | 0    |    |   |  |
| Freiermuth.....                                      | 1    | 2    | 2.0  | 2    | 0    |                                                      |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Hollins .....                                 | 2              | 2                                                                 | 18                                                      | 9.0  | 10   | 0    |    |   |  |
| Passing                                              |      |      |      |      |      | Passing                                              |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Pass receiving                                |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
|                                                      | Att. | Com. | Yds. | TD   | Int. | Lg                                                   |                 | Att. | Com. | Yds. | TD                                            | Int.                                          | Lg             | Tar. <th>No.<th>Yds.</th><th>Avg.</th><th>Lg</th><th>TD</th></th> | No. <th>Yds.</th> <th>Avg.</th> <th>Lg</th> <th>TD</th> | Yds. | Avg. | Lg   | TD |   |  |
| Rodgers.....                                         | 39   | 23   | 187  | 0    | 1    | 26                                                   | Doubs .....     | 4    | 3    | 96   | 32.0                                          | 63                                            | 0              | Raridon.....                                                      | 1                                                       | 1    | 30   | 30.0 | 30 | 0 |  |
| Rudolph.....                                         | 1    | 0    | 0    | 0    | 0    | 0                                                    | K.Williams..... | 2    | 2    | 10   | 10.0                                          | 10                                            | 0              | Douglas .....                                                     | 2                                                       | 1    | 9    | 9.0  | 9  | 0 |  |
| Pass receiving                                       |      |      |      |      |      | Pass receiving                                       |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Interceptions                                 |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Tar.                                                 | No.  | Yds. | Avg. | Lg   | TD   |                                                      | No.             | Yds. | Avg. | Lg   | TD                                            |                                               | No.            | Yds.                                                              | Avg.                                                    | Lg   | TD   |      |    |   |  |
| R.Wilson.....                                        | 6    | 5    | 28   | 5.6  | 9    | 0                                                    | Gilliam.....    | 2    | 1    | 4    | 4.0                                           | 4                                             | Chism III..... | 1                                                                 | 1                                                       | 2    | -2.0 | -2   | 0  |   |  |
| Bernard.....                                         | 8    | 4    | 35   | 8.8  | 19   | 0                                                    | Stevenson ..... | 2    | 1    | 3    | 3.0                                           | 3                                             |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Freiermuth.....                                      | 5    | 4    | 32   | 8.0  | 9    | 0                                                    | Chism III.....  | 1    | 1    | 2    | -2.0                                          | -2                                            | Interceptions  |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Metcalfe.....                                        | 9    | 4    | 27   | 6.8  | 16   | 0                                                    |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Jacas.....                                    | 1              | 11                                                                | 11.0                                                    | 11   | 0    |      |    |   |  |
| Warren.....                                          | 4    | 2    | 34   | 17.0 | 26   | 0                                                    |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Punting                                       |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Dowdle.....                                          | 2    | 2    | 22   | 11.0 | 13   | 0                                                    |                 |      |      |      |                                               | No.                                           | Avg.           | Lg                                                                | In                                                      | TD   |      |      |    |   |  |
| Washington.....                                      | 2    | 1    | 7    | 7.0  | 7    | 0                                                    |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Wishnowsky.....                               | 4              | 46.3                                                              | 54                                                      | 1    | 0    |      |    |   |  |
| Skowronek.....                                       | 1    | 2    | 2.0  | 2    | 0    | 0                                                    |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Punt returns                                  |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Interceptions                                        |      |      |      |      |      | Interceptions                                        |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Kickoff returns                               |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| No.                                                  | Yds. | Avg. | Lg   | TD   |      | No.                                                  | Yds.            | Avg. | Lg   | TD   |                                               | No.                                           | Avg.           | FC                                                                | Lg                                                      | TD   |      |      |    |   |  |
| Queen.....                                           | 1    | 3    | 3.0  | 3    | 0    | 0                                                    |                 |      |      |      |                                               | M.Jones.....                                  | 4              | 10.0                                                              | 2                                                       | 19   | 0    |      |    |   |  |
| Punting                                              |      |      |      |      |      | Punting                                              |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Kickoff returns                               |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| No.                                                  | Avg. | Lg   | In   | TD   |      | No.                                                  | Avg.            | FC   | Lg   | TD   |                                               | No.                                           | Avg.           | Lg                                                                | TD                                                      |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Johnston.....                                        | 8    | 48.1 | 53   | 3    | 1    | 0                                                    |                 |      |      |      |                                               | K.Williams.....                               | 1              | 29.0                                                              | 29                                                      | 0    |      |      |    |   |  |
| Punt returns                                         |      |      |      |      |      | Punt returns                                         |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Tackles-assists-sacks                         |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| No.                                                  | Avg. | FC   | Lg   | TD   |      | No.                                                  | Avg.            | FC   | Lg   | TD   |                                               | Ellis 7-5-1, Woods 8-2-0, Woodson 4-3-0,      |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Wetjen.....                                          | 2    | 10.5 | 1    | 17   | 0    | 0                                                    |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Spillane 3-3-0, Ponder 3-2-1, Gonzalez 3-1-0, |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Kickoff returns                                      |      |      |      |      |      | Kickoff returns                                      |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Tackles-assists-sacks                         |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| No.                                                  | Avg. | Lg   | TD   |      |      | No.                                                  | Avg.            | Lg   | TD   |      | Byard III 2-2-0, Jacas 1-1-0, Hutchins 0-3-0, |                                               |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Wetjen.....                                          | 4    | 23.0 | 26   | 0    | 0    |                                                      |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Farmer 1-1-1, M.Jones 1-1-0, Oblazor 0-0-0,   |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Heidenreich.....                                     | 1    | 26.0 | 26   | 0    | 0    |                                                      |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Reed 1-1-0, Durden 0-2-0, Barmore 1-0-1,      |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Tackles-assists-sacks                                |      |      |      |      |      | Tackles-assists-sacks                                |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Tackles-assists-sacks                         |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Harmon 1-7-5, Herbig 4-3-0, P.Wilson 4-1-0,          |      |      |      |      |      | Harmon 1-7-5, Herbig 4-3-0, P.Wilson 4-1-0,          |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Chism III 0-0-0, Prunty 0-0-0, Muasau 0-0-0,  |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Brisker 1-5-0, Jenkins 4-1-0, Samuel Jr. 3-2-0,      |      |      |      |      |      | Brisker 1-5-0, Jenkins 4-1-0, Samuel Jr. 3-2-0,      |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Gilliam 0-0-0, Henry 0-0-0, DaJones 1-0-0,    |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Ramsey 2-3-0, Spears-Jennings 0-0-0, Watt 2-         |      |      |      |      |      | Ramsey 2-3-0, Spears-Jennings 0-0-0, Watt 2-         |                 |      |      |      |                                               | Latu 0-0-0, Hunter 0-0-0, Dr.Jones 0-1-0,     |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Hight 1-5-0, Hight 1-5-0, Benton 0-3-0,              |      |      |      |      |      | Hight 1-5-0, Hight 1-5-0, Benton 0-3-0,              |                 |      |      |      |                                               | M.Williams 0-1-0                              |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| Heward 0-3-0, Heyward 0-3-0, Queen 0-2-0, Holcomb 0- |      |      |      |      |      | Heward 0-3-0, Heyward 0-3-0, Queen 0-2-0, Holcomb 0- |                 |      |      |      |                                               |                                               |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |
| 0-0, Joseph-Day 1-0-0, Rodgers 0-0-0                 |      |      |      |      |      | 0-0, Joseph-Day 1-0-0, Rodgers 0-0-0                 |                 |      |      |      |                                               |                                               |                |                                                                   |                                                         |      |      |      |    |   |  |

## FootballMonday

## Defense gets to Rodgers, Steelers

CHAD FINN

## THE UNCONVENTIONAL REVIEW

Welcome to the Unconventional Review, an instant reaction to standouts, stats, and story lines from the Patriots' most recent game . . .

The Patriots roughed up Aaron Rodgers so thoroughly Sunday that it's a wonder he didn't call an emergency podcast with Pat McAfee late in the fourth quarter to claim that it's all fake news and he really threw nine touchdown passes and could have had 10 if he wanted.

The Patriots roughed up Aaron Rodgers so thoroughly Sunday that it's fair to wonder if the defense had a secret side-quest to defend the honor of Shailene Woodley and Danica Patrick.

The Patriots roughed up Aaron Rodgers . . .

OK, fine, I'll stop . . . for now. It's just that following the Patriots' 20-3 victory over the Steelers on Sunday in which the offense was spotty (if you thought we were deluged with Is Drake Maye Actually Good? takes *last* week, just wait . . .) and the injury updates constant, the one true satisfaction to come out of the much-needed win was the performance of the defense.

The three biggest plays? Linebacker Christian Ellis pulverizing Rodgers from the blind side and forcing a fumble in the second quarter that ended up being a 36-yard loss on third down.

The Patriots really tightened the vice on Rodgers in the fourth quarter. They essentially clinched the game when on second and 21 from the Steelers 30, Rodgers fumbled after being steamrolled by Christian Barmore. Elijah Ponder, who along with Gabe Jacas (interception) and Joshua Farmer (sack) had strong games, scooped up the ball and rumbled 19 yards for the touchdown and a 20-3 lead.

The Patriots sacked Rodgers four times and hit him seven other times.

One might suggest they roughed him up so thoroughly that he's probably remembering his time with the Jets fondly.

Some further thoughts, upon immediate review:

## Players worth watching

*Players suggested in the Unconventional Preview: Hunter Henry, T.J. Watt, Kevin Byard.*

**Romeo Doubs:** The veteran receiver, signed to a four-year, \$68-million deal in the offseason, had just about the most inauspicious debut imaginable in the opener against the Seahawks, failing to catch any of his three targets and having one inexcusable drop on what would have been a long gainer. Doubs had a quiet first half against the Steelers — he had one of just three receptions by a Patriots wide receiver in the first 30 minutes — before breaking loose in the third. Doubs hauled in a 29-yard catch on the Patriots' first possession of the third quarter. (Unfortunately, a Maye underthrow was picked off by linebacker Patrick Queen on the next play.) Later in the third, Doubs made a smart play as Maye rolled right, adjusting his route and heading upfield, where Maye found him for a 63-yard gain to the Steelers 29-yard line. That drive ended with an Andy Borregales 45-yard field goal,



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Patriots linebacker Gabe Jacas gives Steelers quarterback Aaron Rodgers a helping hand after a first-quarter sack.

which made the score a presumably insurmountable 13-3. Dobbs finished with three catches for 96 yards.

**TreVeyon Henderson:** The second-year running back, who missed the opener with an ankle injury, gained 5 yards on his first carry of the season. On the second carry? *Whoooooosh.* With 8 minutes, 22 seconds left in the first half and the game scoreless, Henderson rocketed through the middle of the Steelers defense for a 39-yard touchdown run. Henderson still too often turns second and short into third and a little

longer — his other 15 carries netted just 37 yards total — but his explosiveness provides an element no one else on the offense can replicate.

**Christian Gonzalez:** With Maye struggling, the third-year lockdown cornerback is the Patriots' best player. He held DK Metcalf to four catches for just 27 yards on nine targets, and Gonzalez made Metcalf's performance somehow look worse than the numbers. He probably does have one regret, though. He'd have had a scoop-and-score touchdown after Ellis's detonation of Rodgers, but he couldn't quite master the scoop part.

## Grievance of the game

Rhamondre Stevenson's fumble on the first possession — after coughing up a pair in last year's Week 3 loss to the Steelers — deserves at least a dishonorable mention here. But in all honestly, the grievance has to be Maye's too-delicate throw that Queen picked off in the third quarter. Even if he didn't see Queen in coverage there, these underthrows that give the defense a chance to recover and make a play are happening too often. It's your job to fix this, Josh McDaniels.

## Notes scribbled in the margins

**Predicted final score:** Patriots 20, Steelers 13.

**Final score:** Patriots 20, Steelers 3.

The Patriots, as Mike Vrabel will acknowledge, were incredibly fortunate with injuries last year. Their luck is not trending in a similar direction this year. Offensive lineman Mike Onwenu was carted off, edge Dre'Mont Jones left with a shoulder injury, and safety Craig Woodson and rookie tight end Eli Raridon, who had a nifty 30-yard catch in the first half while drawing a pass interference penalty, were among others that had to leave the game . . . I don't believe there's a snowball's chance in the Sahara that Tony Romo ends up back in CBS's No. 1 NFL booth, but it's going to take a bit for Jim Nantz and J.J. Watt to have the connection of a true top team. Late in the first quarter, Watt told a story about Steelers coach Mike McCarthy getting a game ball last week from Rodgers after the Steelers' win over the Falcons. Nantz immediately repeated the story, like he hadn't heard a syllable of Watt's anecdote. . . . I didn't like how they handled Onwenu's injury, either. Nantz said Onwenu got "tangled up" with T.J. Watt — J.J.'s brother — when in reality, Watt crashed into the back of Onwenu's legs after lunging at and missing Maye. I wonder if Nantz would have framed it that way if he'd had Romo (or Romo's brother, I suppose) next to him in the booth.

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DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

TreVeyon Henderson skips past Asante Samuel Jr.'s tackle attempt and heads to the end zone for a 39-yard touchdown.

## Maye looks more a young QB, not the MVP runner-up

## ►ON FOOTBALL

*Continued from Page C1*

Seattle, and 13 on Sunday.

The Patriots had three drives end in Pittsburgh territory without scoring points — a lost fumble by Rhamondre Stevenson, Maye's interception, and a missed 47-yard field goal by Andy Borregales. They led, 10-3, at halftime, but easily could have had 17 or 21 points.

Maye's teammates deserve some of the blame. Stevenson's fumble, the ninth lost one of his career, ruined a promising opening drive. A.J. Brown's

sprained ankle, which will keep him out 4-6 weeks, left Maye with a bunch of No. 2 and 3 weapons. A false start by Morgan Moses on the 6-yard line led to a short field goal instead of a touchdown.

The performance wasn't all bad, either. Romeo Doubs, who had no catches and one bad drop in Week 1, caught three passes for 96 yards. Maye also hit on a 30-yard pass to tight end Eli Raridon and a 29-yarder to Hunter Henry.

TreVeyon Henderson, making his season debut after missing Week 1 with

a sprained ankle, finished with a healthy 76 rushing yards on 16 carries, including a dynamic 39-yard touchdown run in the first quarter. Henderson got great blocks from Morgan Moses and DeMario Douglas, who took out two defenders with one hit, and did the rest with his speed.

"I thought we had positive plays," Vrabel said. "We just didn't finish enough drives."

Maye, though, is not playing like the quarterback who fell one first-place vote short of winning the MVP last year. He

doesn't seem comfortable in the pocket — taking off too early to scramble, or running into sacks, as he did late in the first half with T.J. Watt. Maye also threw an inexplicable interception for the second straight week.

It was another throw off his back foot, a floater to Hunter Henry that was easily picked off by linebacker Patrick Queen. This came on first and 10 from the Steelers 33-yard line, when Maye had little reason to take a risk.

"You have got to know that that is not always the time to take a shot on

first down," Maye said. "So, it is just the little things. It starts with me doing them better and making them more important."

The Patriots were able to escape with a win Sunday against a Steelers' offense that was even more feckless, gaining 235 yards and scoring only 3 points. But they know their performance won't cut it the next two weeks, when they play the Jaguars and Bills on the road.

*Ben Volin can be reached at ben.volin@globe.com.*

FootballMonday



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Wide receiver Romeo Doubs was excited to haul in a 63-yard reception in the third quarter of the Patriots' 20-3 win over the Steelers.

After Week 1 dud, Doubs delivers

Offseason signing had three catches

By Cam Kerry  
GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — Romeo Doubs's Patriots debut was one to forget, a zero-catch dud in a defeat to the Seahawks. He made no secret his desire to turn the page this week.

With A.J. Brown sidelined on injured reserve, Doubs stepped up, catching three of four targets for 96 yards in a 20-3 victory over the Steelers in his Gillette Stadium debut. It set a career high for receiving yards in a regular-season game for the fifth-year pass catcher.

Doubs was the game's leading receiver by a wide margin, outpacing Hunter Henry by 56 yards. He accounted for nearly half of Drake Maye's 208 passing yards.

"It gives me a ton of confidence," said Doubs. "I would love to keep that [the] same and to lean on more of my humility and just continuously have the mind-set to improve."

His first catch, a 4-yard completion on second and 5 in the first quarter, was fumbled out of bounds. The crowd gave Doubs a noticeable pop for his first reception with the team.

Facing third and 5 at the Patriots 38-yard line on the opening drive of the second half, Maye extended the play with his legs, and connected with Doubs out of sequence over several Steelers defenders for a 29-yard pickup.

The one that will air over and over on the highlight reel was a 63-yard catch-and-run late in the third quarter. Maye rolled to his right and uncorked a rocket on the run that Doubs had to slow down for, well behind the Steelers' safeties. He

brought it in and scampered up field before Rayshawn Jenkins dragged him down out of bounds. It ultimately set the table for a 45-yard field goal by Andy Borregales that gave the Patriots a 13-3 lead.

That reception was Doubs's longest career reception. His previous long was a 48-yard reception last season as a member of the Packers.

"Obviously, great play call," he said. "[Defensive backs] guess in this league, and I had leverage. It was a great ball."

Doubs, who inked a four-year, \$68 million contract with the Patriots this offseason, showed glimpses of what he is capable of as the team's clear No. 1 receiver this week.

"Rome dropped one ball last week in the first game, and I've seen 'Oh, he dropped three passes,'" said Patriots coach Mike Vrabel. "I don't think he dropped three passes, he dropped

one, we get back to work. People drop passes, people miss tackles, you guys just don't see it all the time. You guys see the drops and the easy ones. Rome got back to work, worked extremely hard. We'll get back and we'll coach him, but going up and trusting your hands and staying focused and all those things that are critical.

"Drake gave him some opportunities, hopefully we can continue to progress and finish those drives you guys were talking about here today, and I thought we had a lot of positive plays, we just didn't finish enough drives and that limited our scoring."

When asked how he is progressing learning the offense, Doubs expressed his desire to continue improving both as a player and as a team.

Doubs will get to showcase that next Sunday, when the Patriots visit the Jaguars.

Patriots win, but can't meet expectations

►PATRIOTS  
Continued from Page A1

want to execute and be successful on offense, and we still know that that was not our best football [even] when you come out with a win," said Maye.

"So, you have got to ... see it both ways. You have got to be excited and enjoy the win. But at the same time, you realize that playing like this is not going to end up with, offensively, us leading our team to wins. I think that is what it starts with, and it starts with me and starts with more juice."

In a meeting of the only two franchises to capture six Lombardi Trophies, there wasn't much juice. Vrabel's defense squeezed the life out of contact-averse quarterback/aging icon Aaron Rodgers, limiting him to 187 yards passing, a 59 percent completion percentage (23 of 39), and a 60.5 quarterback rating.

Rodgers looked every bit of his 42 years on this Earth on a strip-sack by Christian Barmore that broke the game open early in the fourth quarter. Elijah Ponder scooped up the fumble and rumbled 19 yards for a comfortable 20-3 advantage.

Prime Rodgers would not have blinked at such a deficit, but this advanced version of the iconoclastic four-time MVP is simply in self-preservation mode in his sendoff season. The final indignity was the Patriots ending his consecutive passes without an interception streak at 310 in the fourth quarter on a juggled ball.

Rodgers departed with a bruised ego. Meanwhile, the ultimate soldiers of good fortune last year had lousy injury luck in a Pyrrhic victory, including losing longest-tenured Patriot Mike Onwenu to a serious ankle injury.

Rodgers and Maye are quarterbacks at opposite ends of the career spectrum. But coming off



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

**Patriots running back Rhamondre Stevenson fumbled in the first quarter of Sunday's win.**

an MVP runner-up season, Maye has started slowly in Year 3, with just one touchdown pass and four interceptions — halfway to his 17-game regular season total in his breakout sophomore season.

Something looks amiss with New England's newest coverboy QB.

Maye (14 of 22 for 208 yards with an interception) assumed more of a play-it-safe posture coming off his disastrous three-interception fourth quarter vs. Seattle.

He was a Bible Belt conservative in the first half as the Patriots took a 10-3 halftime lead. On

the first play of the second quarter, Maye slid down like a playoff-bound Red Sox player and surrendered on third and goal from the Pittsburgh 10, eager to preserve the chip-shot field goal.

He looked more gun-shy than gunslinger.

And on the first possession of the second half, after the Patriots drove to the Pittsburgh 33, the turnover bug bit again. Maye sailed a football that belonged in a water fountain with a penny attached, because it was more wish than pass, into a passel of Steelers. It was easily intercepted at the Pittsburgh 10. That gave Maye turnovers in five of his last six games, dating to last year's playoff run, and a league-high 39 in his 35 games as a starter.

"I mean, the guy made a good play. We didn't make a very good one," said Vrabel. "Those things are going to end up costing us. But I love the way that we responded defensively, and we see how critical the football is, who possesses it, and how you finish drives."

The Patriots, who finished second in the NFL in points per game (28.8) last year, failed to finish. Seven of their 11 drives pierced Pittsburgh territory, but they scored just one offensive touchdown — a 39-yard, first-quarter romp by TreVeyon Henderson, making his season debut.

"I think [we're] figuring us as an offense out early in the [season]," said Maye. "And, when you are playing against teams early ... you're figuring out what we got, kind of who we are."

What the Patriots should've figured out by now is that last year's magic carpet ride is over. While the belief might carry over, the results do not.

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Shough and Saints stun Ravens late

New Orleans rallies from 17-9 deficit for first win

By Noah Trister  
ASSOCIATED PRESS

**Saints 24 Ravens 17** BALTIMORE — Twice in a row, Tyler Shough disappeared into a pile of bodies at the goal line with the game tied late in the fourth quarter.

Officials ruled he was stopped on third down and scored on fourth — it could well have been the reverse — and that was good enough for the Saints.

Shough scored on a fourth-down sneak with 1:28 remaining, and the Saints rallied for a 24-17 win over the Ravens Sunday. After Shough didn't score on third down, New Orleans elected to go for it on fourth instead of kicking for a three-point lead. The second sneak was called a touchdown, and that decision was upheld after a review.

"It's a hard play on the goal line because ... sometimes they lose sight of the football. I think it's a challenging play for everyone," Saints coach Kellen Moore said. "Fortunate for us to get that. Obviously we're going to go for it in that situation. Chance to score a touchdown. If not, we're forcing them to be on the minus-1 and go the long way."

New Orleans (1-1) had first down from the 2 before a penalty and a costly incomplete pass allowed Baltimore — with only two timeouts left — to stop the clock after the next two plays. Shough finally scored on a 1-yard sneak.

The Ravens, who didn't have a first down on either of their previous two drives, made it to the New Orleans 37, but Lamar Jackson's deep pass was intercepted by Julian Blackmon with 13 seconds left.

Baltimore had a 17-9 lead and forced a three-and-out with sacks by Trey Hendrickson and Mike Green. That gave the Ravens the ball at the New Orleans 49 late in the third quarter with a chance to make it a two-score game.

But Baltimore went backwards 16 yards and punted, then the Saints drove to tie it with 9:42 remaining on a 21-yard touchdown pass from Shough to Chris Olave. After a penalty on the Ravens (1-1) moved the 2-point conversion to the 1-yard line, Travis Etienne Jr. ran the ball in to make it 17-all.

After another Baltimore three-and-out — Jackson curiously threw long on third-and-1, and his pass to Chris Moore was broken up by Kool-Aid McKinstry — the Saints took over at their own 32 with 8:06 remaining.

"A play that we liked, thought we had a shot there for an explosive," Ravens coach Jesse Minter said. "Obviously, didn't work out, so it's always going to be, you know, looking at it after the fact."

New Orleans then drove about as methodically as possible, converting two third downs and two fourth downs to seize the lead.

"We'd like to not make it as close," Shough said.

Baltimore beat Indianapolis, 41-23, in Minter's debut as coach, but in Week 2 the Ravens did many of the things that got John Harbaugh's staff fired — collapsing in the fourth quarter and dropping yet another home game. Baltimore was 3-6 at M&T Bank Stadium last season.

The Ravens were without top receiver Zay Flowers, but did have offensive linemen Ronnie Stanley and John Simpson after their status was in question. But Stanley (toe) left the game in the second half.

New Orleans lost left tackle Kelvin Banks Jr. to an ankle injury, but at the end the Saints moved the ball just fine.

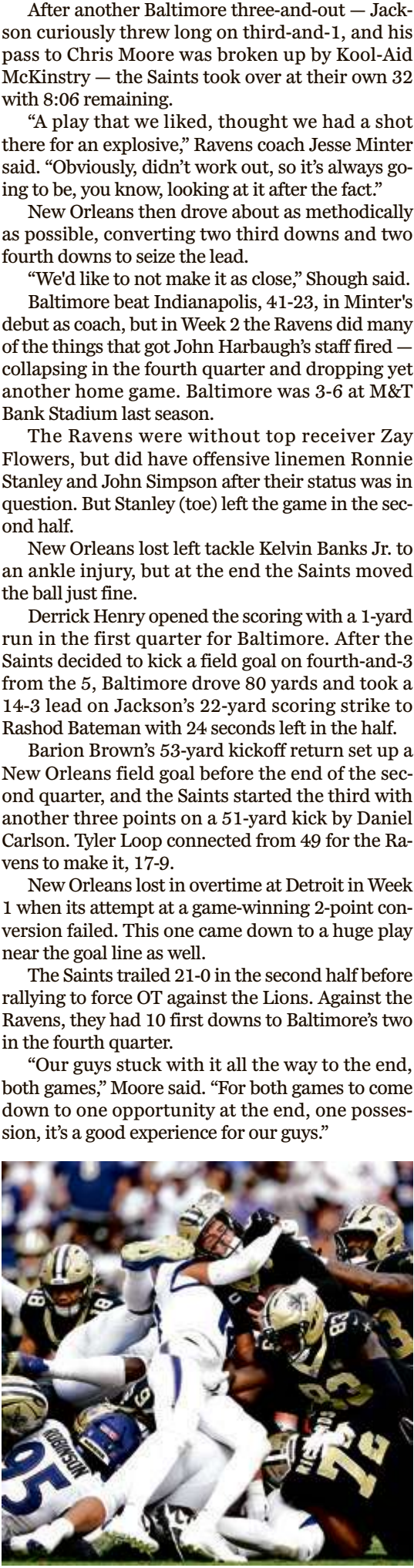
Derrick Henry opened the scoring with a 1-yard run in the first quarter for Baltimore. After the Saints decided to kick a field goal on fourth-and-3 from the 5, Baltimore drove 80 yards and took a 14-3 lead on Jackson's 22-yard scoring strike to Rashod Bateman with 24 seconds left in the half.

Barion Brown's 53-yard kickoff return set up a New Orleans field goal before the end of the second quarter, and the Saints started the third with another three points on a 51-yard kick by Daniel Carlson. Tyler Loop connected from 49 for the Ravens to make it, 17-9.

New Orleans lost in overtime at Detroit in Week 1 when its attempt at a game-winning 2-point conversion failed. This one came down to a huge play near the goal line as well.

The Saints trailed 21-0 in the second half before rallying to force OT against the Lions. Against the Ravens, they had 10 first downs to Baltimore's two in the fourth quarter.

"Our guys stuck with it all the way to the end, both games," Moore said. "For both games to come down to one opportunity at the end, one possession, it's a good experience for our guys."



NICK WASS/ASSOCIATED PRESS

**Quarterback Tyler Shough (with ball) and the Saints did just enough to earn a big victory.**



MELISSA TAMEZ/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Caleb Williams went down with a right hamstring injury in the fourth quarter Sunday in Chicago, further darkening a Bears loss to the Vikings.

# Williams injured as Bears stymied

By Jay Cohen  
ASSOCIATED PRESS

**Vikings 9** CHICAGO — Dallas Turn-  
**Bears 3** er threw Tyson Bagent to the ground, then took off down the field in celebration. It rained on his parade, for sure, but that was just fine with him.

Turner had two of Minnesota's four sacks, including his takedown of Bagent on the final play, and the Vikings shut down Caleb Williams and the Bears for a damp 9-3 victory on Sunday.

"I feel like, just preparing myself for these moments, ever since I was in college," said Turner, a third-year linebacker. "I feel like it's very important, just keep on showing up every single day to execute at a high level."

Isaiah Rodgers recovered a fumble and blocked a late field-goal attempt as Minnesota improved to 2-0 for the first time since it opened the 2024 season with five consecutive wins. Aaron Jones rushed for 105 yards and Will Reichard kicked three field goals, including a 39-yarder with 1:09 left.

The Vikings earned their seventh consecutive win at Soldier Field, matching the franchise record for consecutive road wins over a division opponent. They won seven straight at Detroit from 1968-74 and seven straight on the road against Green Bay from 1971-77.

## NOTEBOOK

# Commanders' Daniels again dislocates elbow

ASSOCIATED PRESS

**Jayden Daniels** was ruled out of what became a 37-20 Cowboys victory over his Commanders after the Washington quarterback suffered a gruesome-looking dislocated left elbow on a botched play to end the first half.

Daniels missed all but one game in the second half of last season after dislocating his left elbow in November. That injury occurred when Daniels used his non-throwing arm while trying to brace himself on a fall, and the same thing happened against the Cowboys.

The Commanders were trying to score from the Dallas 1-yard line with 3 seconds remaining before halftime when left guard **Chris Paul** stepped on Daniels's foot as he backed away from center. Daniels's left elbow appeared to bend the wrong way as he braced himself and threw a wild incomplete pass.

Commanders coach **Dan Quinn** confirmed the dislocation, but said imaging showed no fracture and that Daniels would fly home with the team.

**Dak Prescott** threw four TD passes — two each to **CeeDee Lamb** and tight end **Jake Ferguson** — to break **Tony Romo's** Dallas franchise record of 248.

## Chiefs take it to last second

**Harrison Butker** kicked two field goals in overtime, the second a 40-yarder that **Patrick Mahomes** and **Kenneth Walker III** set up as time expired, giving the Chiefs a 33-30 victory over the visiting Colts on Sunday night.

Mahomes finished with 382 yards passing and three touchdowns, Walker ran for 117 yards, and **Travis Kelce** looked like a younger version of himself with nine catches for 101 yards and a score as the Chiefs improved to 2-0.

**Daniel Jones** had 210 yards passing with a touchdown and a pick for the Colts (0-2). **Jonathan Taylor** had 92 yards rushing and two TDs.

## Jets fall apart, blow 2-0

The Jets were 11 minutes away from a 2-0 start, but a fourth-quarter collapse and a 20-17 overtime loss to the Packers had New York frustrated that their home opener ended in disappointment.

The Jets took a 17-7 lead with 11:04 remaining in the fourth quarter on **Ja-**

Williams left with a right hamstring injury midway through the fourth quarter, silencing a drenched crowd of 58,914. The No. 1 pick in the 2024 draft was 15 for 26 for 138 yards, and he had five carries for 42 yards.

"We'll see how bad it is tomorrow and we'll go from there," Bears coach Ben Johnson said.

Johnson called the plays as Chicago rolled to 291 yards rushing and 552 yards overall in a 59-37 victory at Carolina in Week 1.

But Johnson and the Bears were stymied by Vikings defensive coordinator Brian Flores and his aggressive approach. Led by Turner and Blake Cashman, Minnesota limited Chicago to 297 total yards. Cashman had 10 tackles and a sack, and Byron Murphy Jr. intercepted an ill-advised throw by Williams.

Bagent came in and passed to D'Andre Swift for 1 yard before throwing an incomplete pass on third down. Johnson then sent Cairo Santos on for a 23-yard field goal, but it was blocked by Rodgers.

After Wentz drove Minnesota to Reichard's third field goal, Chicago had one last opportunity. Bagent found Rome Odunze for 21 yards and Luther Burden for 8 to move the ball to the Vikings 12. Following a pair of incompletions, Bagent was wrapped up by Turner on the final play.

**son Sanders's** 32-yard field goal, then came unglued. **Jordan Love** marched Green Bay down the field 73 yards on seven plays, capped by a 3-yard touchdown pass to **Christian Watson**.

New York then stalled on offense, **Sky Moore** returned a punt 63 yards to the Jets 19, and **Trey Smack's** 34-yarder tied it with 2:59 left. The Jets' defense got the game to overtime, but Green Bay marched down the field after the hosts' punted to begin the extra session.

## Eagles sweat it out

**Jalen Hurts** threw a 3-yard touchdown pass to **Darius Cooper** with 9 seconds left in Nashville, and the Eagles beat the Titans, 24-20, on a steamy Sunday when the temperature on the artificial turf was measured at 157 degrees.

Philadelphia (2-0) opened with three straight drives of at least 11 plays, but the Titans (0-2) sacked Hurts three times and picked him off twice, turning those into 10 points. **Marcus Harris's** interception set up **Joey Slye's** 33-yard field goal with 1:56 left, putting Tennessee up, 20-17. Hurts then drove the Eagles 65 yards for the win.

## Watson puts it together

**Deshaun Watson** earned at least a few more starts for the Browns. His two touchdown passes, including a go-ahead 17-yarder to **Blake Whiteheart** in the fourth quarter, led a 23-19 comeback victory over the Buccaneers in a game that was delayed two hours, 12 minutes in the fourth because of lightning. . .

**Drew Lock** threw for 235 yards and three touchdowns to **Jaxon Smith-Njigba** in a stellar first start subbing for the injured **Sam Darnold** and the Seahawks continued their dominance over the Cardinals, 31-7. . . **Jaylen Waddle** had eight catches for 138 yards as he and **Jonah Coleman** led a big second-half comeback by the Broncos, who snapped the Jaguars' nine-game regular-season winning streak, 20-13. . . **Christian McCaffrey** became the fourth-fastest in the Super Bowl era with 100 touchdowns as the 49ers overwhelmed the Dolphins, 35-13. . . Longtime NFL executive **Ernie Accorsi**, general manager of the Giants from 1998-2006, died Saturday, according to his family. He was 84.

## Football Monday

# NFL

| AFC         |   |   |       |      |      |       |      |       |
|-------------|---|---|-------|------|------|-------|------|-------|
| EAST        | W | L | Pct.  | PF   | PA   | Conf. | Div. | Strk. |
| Buffalo     | 2 | 0 | 1.000 | 38.5 | 31.0 | 1-0   | 0-0  | W 2   |
| New England | 1 | 1 | .500  | 15.0 | 8.0  | 1-0   | 0-0  | W 1   |
| NY Jets     | 1 | 1 | .500  | 20.0 | 15.0 | 1-0   | 0-0  | L 1   |
| Miami       | 0 | 2 | .000  | 13.0 | 31.0 | 0-1   | 0-0  | L 2   |

| NORTH      | W | L | Pct.  | PF   | PA   | Conf. | Div. | Strk. |
|------------|---|---|-------|------|------|-------|------|-------|
| Cincinnati | 2 | 0 | 1.000 | 26.5 | 16.5 | 1-0   | 0-0  | W 1   |
| Baltimore  | 1 | 1 | .500  | 29.0 | 23.5 | 1-0   | 0-0  | W 2   |
| Pittsburgh | 1 | 1 | .500  | 11.5 | 16.5 | 0-1   | 0-0  | L 1   |
| Cleveland  | 1 | 1 | .500  | 16.5 | 26.5 | 0-1   | 0-0  | W 1   |

| SOUTH        | W | L | Pct. | PF   | PA   | Conf. | Div. | Strk. |
|--------------|---|---|------|------|------|-------|------|-------|
| Jacksonville | 1 | 1 | .500 | 23.5 | 15.0 | 1-1   | 0-0  | L 1   |
| Indianapolis | 0 | 2 | .000 | 26.5 | 37.0 | 0-2   | 0-0  | L 2   |
| Tennessee    | 0 | 2 | .000 | 15.0 | 23.5 | 0-1   | 0-0  | L 2   |
| Houston      | 0 | 2 | .000 | 18.5 | 28.0 | 0-2   | 0-0  | L 2   |

| WEST        | W | L | Pct.  | PF   | PA   | Conf. | Div. | Strk. |
|-------------|---|---|-------|------|------|-------|------|-------|
| Las Vegas   | 2 | 0 | 1.000 | 26.5 | 13.5 | 2-0   | 1-0  | W 2   |
| Kansas City | 2 | 0 | 1.000 | 32.0 | 20.0 | 2-0   | 1-0  | W 2   |
| Denver      | 1 | 1 | .500  | 15.0 | 22.0 | 1-1   | 0-1  | W 1   |
| LA Chargers | 0 | 2 | .000  | 14.0 | 26.0 | 0-1   | 0-1  | L 2   |

| NFC          |   |   |       |      |      |       |      |       |
|--------------|---|---|-------|------|------|-------|------|-------|
| EAST         | W | L | Pct.  | PF   | PA   | Conf. | Div. | Strk. |
| Philadelphia | 2 | 0 | 1.000 | 24.0 | 21.0 | 1-0   | 1-0  | W 2   |
| NY Giants    | 1 | 0 | 1.000 | 28.0 | 20.0 | 1-0   | 1-0  | W 1   |
| Dallas       | 1 | 1 | .500  | 28.5 | 24.0 | 1-1   | 1-1  | W 1   |
| Washington   | 0 | 2 | .000  | 21.0 | 30.5 | 0-2   | 0-2  | L 2   |

| NORTH     | W | L | Pct.  | PF   | PA   | Conf. | Div. | Strk. |
|-----------|---|---|-------|------|------|-------|------|-------|
| Minnesota | 2 | 0 | 1.000 | 24.0 | 12.5 | 2-0   | 2-0  | W 2   |
| Detroit   | 1 | 1 | .500  | 31.0 | 35.5 | 1-0   | 0-0  | L 1   |
| Chicago   | 1 | 1 | .500  | 31.0 | 23.0 | 1-1   | 0-1  | L 1   |
| Green Bay | 1 | 1 | .500  | 21.0 | 28.0 | 0-1   | 0-1  | W 1   |

| SOUTH       | W | L | Pct. | PF   | PA   | Conf. | Div. | Strk. |
|-------------|---|---|------|------|------|-------|------|-------|
| Carolina    | 1 | 1 | .500 | 35.5 | 31.0 | 1-1   | 1-0  | W 1   |
| New Orleans | 1 | 1 | .500 | 27.0 | 24.0 | 0-1   | 0-0  | W 1   |
| Tampa Bay   | 0 | 2 | .000 | 23.0 | 28.0 | 0-0   | 0-0  | L 2   |
| Atlanta     | 0 | 2 | .000 | 8.0  | 27.0 | 0-1   | 0-1  | L 2   |

| WEST          | W | L | Pct.  | PF   | PA   | Conf. | Div. | Strk. |
|---------------|---|---|-------|------|------|-------|------|-------|
| Seattle       | 2 | 0 | 1.000 | 22.0 | 8.5  | 1-0   | 1-0  | W 2   |
| San Francisco | 2 | 0 | 1.000 | 31.0 | 10.0 | 1-0   | 1-0  | W 2   |
| Arizona       | 1 | 1 | .500  | 16.5 | 22.5 | 0-1   | 0-1  | L 1   |
| LA Rams       | 0 | 1 | .000  | 7.0  | 27.0 | 0-1   | 0-1  | L 1   |

| SUNDAY'S RESULTS  |                    |                     |                      |
|-------------------|--------------------|---------------------|----------------------|
| At New England 20 | Pittsburgh 3       | Minnesota 9         | at Chicago 3         |
| Carolina 34       | at Atlanta 3       | Las Vegas 26        | at LA Chargers 14    |
| New Orleans 24    | at Baltimore 17    | At Denver 20        | Jacksonville 13      |
| Cincinnati 20     | at Houston 6       | At Dallas 37        | Washington 20        |
| Green Bay 20      | at NY Jets 17 (OT) | Seattle 31          | at Arizona 7         |
| Cleveland 23      | at Tampa Bay 19    | At San Francisco 35 | Miami 13             |
| Philadelphia 24   | at Tennessee 20    | At Kansas City 33   | Indianapolis 30 (OT) |

| MONDAY'S GAME               |   |                          |      |
|-----------------------------|---|--------------------------|------|
| NY Giants at LA Rams        |   | 8:15                     |      |
| THURSDAY'S GAME             |   |                          |      |
| Atlanta at Green Bay        |   | 8:15                     |      |
| NEXT SUNDAY'S GAMES         |   |                          |      |
| New England at Jacksonville | 1 | Kansas City at Miami     | 1    |
| Seattle at Washington       | 1 | LA Chargers at Buffalo   | 1    |
| Cincinnati at Pittsburgh    | 1 | Minnesota at Tampa Bay   | 4:05 |
| Tennessee at NY Giants      | 1 | Arizona at San Francisco | 4:05 |
| Houston at Indianapolis     | 1 | Las Vegas at New Orleans | 4:25 |
| NY Jets at Detroit          | 1 | Baltimorevs. Dallas*     | 4:25 |
| Carolina at Cleveland       | 1 | LA Rams at Denver        | 8:20 |

\* at Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

## Monday night's game

### NY Giants at LA Rams

**Time:** Monday, 8:15 p.m., ABC, ESPN. **Line (over/under):** LA Rams by 6½ (47½).

**Records:** Giants 1-0 (1-0 vs. spread), Rams 0-1 (0-1 vs. spread).  
**Injuries:** NY Giants: QUESTIONABLE: CB Deonte Banks (calf). LA RAMS: OUT: S Kamren Kinchens (hamstring), DOUBTFUL: WR Jordan Whittington (quadricep), QUESTIONABLE: WR Puka Nacua (hip).

| SEAHAWKS 31, CARDINALS 7 |        |              |    |       |                     |          |                       |
|--------------------------|--------|--------------|----|-------|---------------------|----------|-----------------------|
| Seattle (2-0)            | 7      | 0            | 10 | 14    | —                   | 31       |                       |
| Arizona (1-1)            | 0      | 7            | 0  | 0     | —                   | 7        |                       |
| Sea                      | —      | Smith-Njigba | 82 | pass  | from                | Lock     | (Myers kick), 12:25.  |
| Ari                      | —      | McBride      | 2  | pass  | from                | Brissett | (Ryland kick), 14:57. |
| Sea                      | —      | Smith-Njigba | 7  | pass  | from                | Lock     | (Myers kick), 12:27.  |
| Sea                      | —      | FG Myers     | 33 | 64:7. |                     |          |                       |
| Sea                      | —      | Smith-Njigba | 12 | pass  | from                | Lock     | (Myers kick), 12:40.  |
| Sea                      | —      | Barner       | 1  | run   | (Myers kick), 11:1. |          |                       |
| Attendance:              | 63,191 |              |    |       |                     |          |                       |

| First downs          | Sea   | Ari   |
|----------------------|-------|-------|
| Total yards          | 23    | 10    |
| Rushing-yards        | 40    | 162   |
| Passing              | 219   | 81    |
| Punt returns         | 3     | 29    |
| Kickoff returns      | 2     | 47    |
| Interception returns | 1     | 0     |
| Comp-att-int.        | 19-26 | 0-8   |
| Sacked-yards lost    | 1     | 16    |
| Punts-avg.           | 2     | 2     |
| Fumbles-lost         | 2     | 1     |
| Penalties-yards      | 3     | 26    |
| Time of possession   | 36:33 | 23:27 |

| INDIVIDUAL STATISTICS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|
| RUSHING—Sea, Lock 19-26-0-235; Ari, Brissett 17-28-1-95.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| RECEIVING—Sea, Smith-Njigba 9-155, Shaheed 3-35, Kupp 2-20, Arroyo 1-17, Barner 1-8, Pfey 1-8, Holani 1-2, Saubert 1-10, Wilson 0-0; Ari, McBride 1-0, LAC, McConkey 3-35; Kne 1-8, Bourne 2-11, Allgeier 2-9, Harrison Jr. 0-0.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| TACKLES-ASSISTS-SACKS—Sea, Witherspoon 4-4-0, Jones IV 4-4-0, D.Thomas 6-1-0, Williams 4-2-1, Mills 1-3-0, Love 3-0-0, Murphy II 0-2-0, Reed 1-0-1, Emmannor 1-0-0, Jobe 1-0-0, Neal 1-0-0, Hall 0-1-0, Nwosu 0-1-0, Pritchett 0-1-0; Ari, Baker 7-4-1, Wilson Sr. 4-5-0, Gibbens 1-8-0, Wingard 3-0-0, Stills 2-5-0, Robinson 3-3-0, Collins 2-2-0, Burch 2-1-0, Lopez 1-3-0, Johnson 1-3-0, Melton 2-1-0, B.Browning 2-0-0, Collier 1-1-0, K.Clark 1-0-0, Nolen III 0-2-0, Sweat 1-0-0, Burke 1-0-0. |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| INTERCEPTIONS—Sea, Love 1-0.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |

| RAIDERS 26, CHARGERS 14 |        |            |    |       |                      |           |                      |
|-------------------------|--------|------------|----|-------|----------------------|-----------|----------------------|
| Las Vegas (2-0)         | 0      | 7          | 0  | 9     | —                    | 26        |                      |
| LA Chargers (0-2)       | 0      | 7          | 0  | 0     | —                    | 14        |                      |
| LV                      | —      | Tucker     | 40 | pass  | from                 | Cousins   | (Gay kick), 11:51.   |
| LV                      | —      | Hampton    | 1  | run   | (Dicker kick), 5:26. |           |                      |
| LV                      | —      | FG Gay     | 59 | 60:4. |                      |           |                      |
| LAC                     | —      | Gadsden    | 10 | pass  | from                 | J.Herbert | (Dicker kick), 9:49. |
| LV                      | —      | White      | 13 | pass  | from                 | Cousins   | (Gay kick), 3:53.    |
| LV                      | —      | White      | 11 | pass  | from                 | Cousins   | (Gay kick), 2:59.    |
| LV                      | —      | xxx safety | 1  | 41.   |                      |           |                      |
| Attendance:             | 71,567 |            |    |       |                      |           |                      |

| First downs          | LV    | LAC   |
|----------------------|-------|-------|
| Total yards          | 305   | 310   |
| Rushing-yards        | 29    | 57    |
| Passing              | 248   | 183   |
| Punt returns         | 1     | 0     |
| Kickoff returns      | 2     | 35    |
| Interception returns | 2     | 29    |
| Comp-att-int.        | 19-29 | 11-27 |
| Sacked-yards lost    | 2     | 5     |
| Punts-avg.           | 2     | 3     |
| Fumbles-lost         | 1     | 0     |
| Penalties-yards      | 6     | 42    |
| Time of possession   | 27:43 | 32:17 |

| INDIVIDUAL STATISTICS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|
| RUSHING—LV, Hampton 17-48, Washington Jr. 3-7, Cousins 4-1, Hearty 2-11, LAC, Hampton 23-94, Mitchell 5-24, Johnston 1-7, J.Herbert 3-2.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| PASSING—LV, Cousins 19-29-1-253; LAC, J.Herbert 15-27-0-192.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| RECEIVING—LV, Tucker 5-119, Jentay 4-45, Mayer 3-23, Bech 2-25, White 2-24, Young 1-27, T.Thomas 1-11, Nailor 1-9, Benson 0-0, Washington Jr. 0-0; LAC, McConkey 3-35; Kne 1-8, Hampton 2-21, Gadsden 1-18, Thompson 1-3, Mitchell 1-15, Thompson 1-13, Njoku 1-9, Johnson 1-7, Davis 0-0.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| TACKLES-ASSISTS-SACKS—LV, Dean 7-3-5, Walker 5-5-0, Masses 4-1-0, Stokes 2-2-0, Stukes 1-2-0, Chinn 2-2-0, Pola-Mao 1-3-0, T.Johnson 3-0-0, Koonce 2-1-15, Eichenberg 0-2-0, Hemingway 0-3-0, McCoy 1-1-0, Payne 0-2-0, Fatukasi 0-2-0, Booker IV 1-0-0, Crosby 1-0-0, Laulu 1-0-0, Butler 0-1-0; LAC, Phillips 3-0-0, James Jr. 2-5-0, T.Jefferson 3-3-0, D.Jackson 3-0-2, Dye 3-2-0, Hart 3-1-0, Ebogbue 1-3-0, Tomlinson 0-4-0, Mack 2-1-1, Mickens 2-1-0, Mesidor 0-3-5, Henley 0-3-0, Tart 1-1-0, Caldwell 0-2-0, Still 0-2-0. |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| INTERCEPTIONS—LV, Masses 2-29; LAC, Hart 1-2.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| MISSED FIELD GOALS—LAC, Dicker, 58 (Hit Right Upright)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |

| SAINTS 24, RAVENS 17 |   |   |   |    |   |    |  |
|----------------------|---|---|---|----|---|----|--|
| New Orleans (1-0)    | 0 | 6 | 3 | 15 | — | 24 |  |



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

**Bruins winger Lukas Reichel shields the puck from Capitals center Justin Sourdif in a 3-2 shootout win to open Boston's preseason schedule Sunday.**

# Bruins preseason starts with shootout victory

►BRUINS  
*Continued from Page C1*

be there for each other and hopefully for a good start for something big.”

The 6-foot-2-inch, 198-pound Brunet combines excellent size, strength, and skill. Through three days of camp and against the Capitals, Brunet has shown he can play with physicality and intelligence. He plays with his head up, is stout in front of his net, and makes crisp outlet passes.

He’s shown in a small sample size that he has the speed to swim at the NHL level. He played critical minutes against the Capitals, including helping to kill two penalties in overtime.

“Oh, it felt great. I mean, that’s why you play a game and you want to be trusted in those moments,” said Brunet, who played just under 22 minutes across 24 shifts. “And I know it’s only a preseason, but for me it meant a lot. I mean, just to get out there and try to prove myself. So, I tried as hard as I can and I think I did a pretty good job at the end there.”

Brunet is one of 10 defensemen competing for six — maybe seven — spots with the big club. He would have to clear waivers — a dicey prospect given his skill set — to be assigned to Providence. He has embraced to competition.

“I mean, it is what it is. I can’t really control any of that,” said Brunet. “So, my job is just to go out there and prove myself. And I think I’m doing a pretty good job at that right now. And I mean, 10 Ds, six Ds, eight Ds, I think it doesn’t really matter for me. I have one goal in mind and I’m going to do everything I can to reach it this year.”

James Hagens decided things, scoring the lone goal in the shootout, tucking one past Logan Thompson. It’s the continuation of a strong start for the 19-year-old Hagens, who scored a half-dozen goals at the recent Prospects Challenge . . . Jake Schmaltz erased Washington’s 1-0 lead off a nice dish from behind the net from Woburn’s Riley Duran. Trailing, 2-1, McAvoy even things with a blue line

## Bruins 3, Capitals 2

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Washington                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 1 | 0 | 1 | 0 | - | 2 |
| Boston                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | - | 3 |
| Bruins win shootout, 1-0                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |   |   |   |   |   |   |
| First period — 1. Washington, Brodzinski 1 (Miroshnichenko, Dunne), 8:48. Penalties — Harris, BOS (tripping), 6:44. Abate, BOS (tripping), 6:44. Lakovic, WSH (illegal stick), 9:59. Deshar-nais, WSH (interference), 19:46.                                                                                   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
| Second period — 2. Boston, Schmaltz 1 (Duran), 15:32 (pp). Penalties — Brodzinski, WSH (hooking), 13:32. Kuraly, BOS (holding), 16:14. Roy, WSH (roughing), 18:48. Kuraly, BOS (roughing), 18:48.                                                                                                              |   |   |   |   |   |   |
| Third period — 3. Washington, Miroshnichenko 1, 5:34. 4. Boston, McAvoy 1 (Minten, Poirtras), 18:17. Penalties — McAvoy, BOS (holding), 3:30. Holl, WSH (hooking), 6:58. Jenner, WSH (tripping), 8:07. McIlrath, WSH (hooking), 13:24. McAvoy, BOS (interference), 14:40. Aspirot, BOS (delay of game), 18:48. |   |   |   |   |   |   |
| Overtime — None. Penalties — Poirtras, BOS (hooking), 1:44. Shootout — Washington 0 (Tuch NG, Dubois NG, Beauvillier NG), Boston 1 (Hagens G, Reichel NG).                                                                                                                                                     |   |   |   |   |   |   |
| Shots on goal — Washington 7-5-12-8 — 32. Boston 7-12-10-1 — 30.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |   |   |   |   |   |   |
| Power plays — Washington 0-7; Boston 1-6.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |   |   |   |   |   |   |
| Goalsies — Washington, Thompson 0-0-1 (30 shots-28 saves). Boston, DiPietro 1-0-0 (32 shots-30 saves).                                                                                                                                                                                                         |   |   |   |   |   |   |
| Referees — Austin Rook, Christopher Rooney. Linesmen — Andrew Smith, Onni Hautamaki.                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |   |   |   |   |   |   |
| A — 17,850 (17,565). T — 2:40.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |   |   |   |   |   |   |

bomb off a clean faceoff win by Matt Poirtras with 1:43 left and goalie Michael DiPietro pulled, setting the stage for extra hockey. “It felt good. Just try and go out there and do my job and get possession because that’s the first thing. It’s the hardest part, basically,” said Poirtras of his win on the draw. “Six on five, you don’t want to be chasing the puck. So yeah, I felt good to win the draw and see the puck go in.” . . . DiPietro played the entire game for the Bruins, making 30 stops and all three in the shootout . . . It was the first of four games in six days in this compacted run up to the 84-game regular season which starts Sept. 29 against the Rangers . . . McAvoy, Sean Kuraly, and Mark Kastelic served as the Boston’s alternate captains . . . Mascot love: Wally the Green Monster joined Blades during an on-ice fan contest between the second and third periods . . . The Bruins held a moment of silence for Alex Gimenez, who passed away suddenly last week. Gimenez had just joined the franchise in July as director of hockey operations/collective bargaining agreement . . . Nice touch: The late Dolly Parton was remembered with a pregame playing of her hit “9 to 5,” much to the delight of the crowd.

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# Legacy lose Pawtucket finale on late-half errors

**By Emma Healy**  
GLOBE STAFF

**Dash 2** PAWTUCKET, R.I. — Boston Legacy coaches and players have preached a culture of growth over the past six months, of getting better with each game, and laying a foundation for the club.

So Sunday’s rematch with one of Boston’s first opponents of the inaugural season was a litmus test for how much the club has actually improved since March.

Through 43 minutes at Centreville Bank Stadium, Boston looked entirely unlike the squad that suffered a mistake-laden, blowout loss in Week 2 of the NWSL season. The Legacy controlled the pace and kept their emotions in check despite a handful of early mistakes.

One unforced error tilted the game in the Dash’s favor, though. The Legacy responded, but another late mistake doomed Boston in a 2-1 loss.

The Legacy (7-13-5, 26 points) remain in the playoff hunt — just barely — with five games remaining, though coach Filipa Patão said the postseason could not be further from her mind.

“We never play a game inside the season thinking of playoffs,” she said. “We play games inside the season to get better every game, to win games. What happens after is going to be a consequence of that.”

Boston had Houston (8-12-5, 29 points) under its thumb until keeper Casey Murphy, looking to build out of the back, sent the ball to right back Jorelyn Carabalí, whose mis-hit curled it over the Legacy’s end line for a Houston corner.

Lisa Boattin sent the ball in on the set piece, and it rolled loose inside the 6-yard box before Danielle Colaprico drove it home for the Dash in the 44th minute.

The Legacy showed some frustration the rest of the half, taking unnecessary fouls as they played from behind. But when they emerged from the locker room, they had settled down and re-

sumed their offensive pressure from early in the first.

In the 59th minute, Nicki Hernández brought the ball up the left and sent a curling ball into the box, where Aissata Traoré met it with her shin to score her team-leading 10th goal and tie the game.

It was the earliest second-half goal of the season for Traoré, who has a habit of waiting until the final minutes to perform her heroics — as she did in the 81st of the Legacy’s win over Washington last week. The Malian striker has scored in five straight matches.

The goal also was, from Patão’s perspective, an indicator that the Legacy were a better team than they were six months ago. It proved her players know how to respond, and that one mistake is no longer their doom.

“Having the first game against Houston, and now performing that way, the result was not positive . . . but I need to be very proud of my players,” the coach said.

The Legacy out-shot Houston, 22-14, including 11-6 on goal, but another error cemented that negative result in a game they otherwise dominated.

In the 85th minute, Khyah Harper sent a cross into the box, and Legacy defender Deja Davis was there, but her header went straight at Murphy, who couldn’t keep it out of her net. Houston’s Messiah Bright, who went up for the header with Davis, got credit for the goal.

The error was unfortunate, Patão conceded, but didn’t indicate any systemic problems. As a whole, she said, her squad is much improved from those early days.

“I’m sure 100 percent that, in the next season, we’re going to see a team that is not just competitive, but one that is going to win games because of the way that we are playing,” she said.

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## HIGH SCHOOL FOOTBALL NOTEBOOK

# Defining stops result in Milford victory to savor

**By Nate Weitzer**  
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Every time it seemed like Milford had a chance to slay the dragon and beat Hockomock rival King Philip, something would set the Scarlet Hawks back.

Turnovers, huge plays called back by penalty, and other miscues plagued the young team on Friday night. But Milford was able to come up with a few defining stops in the second half, and then captured a 23-20 victory thanks to a 30-yard field goal by **Tyler Stewart** with 1:53 remaining.

“We’ve got to limit the turnovers going forward, but when we do make those mistakes, we all pick each other up no matter what,” said Milford junior quarterback **Vincent Loscerbo**, who finished 15-of-27 passing for 270 yards and three touchdowns.

Loscerbo’s top targets, **Jaxson Finnimore** and **Eli Rosenberg**, are two of three seniors that start for Milford. Both receivers came up huge in the program’s first win over KP since 2020, with Rosenberg breaking free for a 64-yard score in the first quarter, and Finnimore catching a back-shoulder fade for a 13-yard touchdown in the fourth to tie it, 20-20.

When Loscerbo tossed a pick early in the third quarter, the Scarlet Hawks defense picked him up.

Brothers **Wanderson** and **Weller-Dos Santos**, and **Kaua Reis** led the linebackers, sophomore **Quinn Deans** and junior **John Raney** wreaked havoc off the edge, and **Adam Tourtellot** recovered a game-sealing fumble to cap his strong performance.

Milford’s first play from scrimmage was a 66-yard run called back by a hold. Twice in the fourth quarter, the Scarlet Hawks had explosive plays erased by penalties, including a 55-yard TD strike to Finnimore. But Loscerbo and his receivers kept those drives alive.

“This is probably the most dynamic skill group I’ve had at Milford,” said **Dale Olson**, hired as coach in 2020 with his twin brother, **Dana**, as lead assistant. “We’re just very young up front. So Vince was running for his life a lot. He’s one tough son of a gun, though, and he made big plays in the pass and run game.”

Working with Finnimore and Rosenberg this offseason has paid off for Loscerbo, whose family owns a well-know restaurant, Pepperoncini’s, in town. Loscerbo was thrust into action last fall due to injuries, and now the junior is coming into his own.

“It’s huge to see how much one offseason can change chemistry on the field,” Loscerbo said. “Now I know where [Rosenberg and Finnimore] are going to be, and I just have



COURTESY OF HOCKOMOCK SPORTS

**Milford junior Vincent Loscerbo was 15-of-27 passing for 270 yards and three touchdowns in the huge win over King Philip.**

## Globe Top 20

| No. |                    | Rec. | Last |
|-----|--------------------|------|------|
| 1.  | Xaverian           | 2-0  | 1    |
| 2.  | St. John’s Prep    | 2-0  | 2    |
| 3.  | Catholic Memorial  | 2-0  | 3    |
| 4.  | Central Catholic   | 1-1  | 4    |
| 5.  | Scituate           | 2-0  | 6    |
| 6.  | Bishop Feehan      | 1-1  | 5    |
| 7.  | Mansfield          | 2-0  | 8    |
| 8.  | Tewksbury          | 2-0  | 9    |
| 9.  | St. John’s (S)     | 2-0  | 15   |
| 10. | North Attleborough | 0-1  | 7    |
| 11. | Marshfield         | 1-1  | 10   |
| 12. | Shawsheen          | 2-0  | 13   |
| 13. | Milford            | 2-0  | —    |
| 14. | Barnstable         | 2-0  | 14   |
| 15. | Milton             | 1-1  | 18   |
| 16. | Walpole            | 1-1  | 11   |
| 17. | Winchester         | 2-0  | 17   |
| 18. | Andover            | 1-1  | —    |
| 19. | Swampscott         | 2-0  | —    |
| 20. | Abington           | 2-0  | —    |

to put it in their vicinity.”

## Extra points

■ With his son, **Quinn**, powering the way (120 yards rushing, two TDs), **Billy Frazier** (Class of ’95) won his first game Friday as coach at his alma mater, Whitman-Hanson, 22-7, over Stoughton.

## CAPE COD NATIONAL INVITATIONAL

# McCormack, Xaverian roll to title

**By Matty Wasserman**  
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

BREWSTER — In the high-pressure environment of the Cape Cod National High School Invitational, rainy conditions provided yet another obstacle to throw golfers out of sync.

But for Xaverian senior Michael McCormack, Sunday’s rain was just another element he embraced.

McCormack birdied three of his final five holes to complete a 5-under-par round of 67, earning individual medalist honors by five strokes and setting the lowest score in the tournament’s 10-year history.

McCormack, along with a co-second place finish by junior Chris Morrow (72) and fourth-place totals of 73 by juniors Luke Edgar and Tucker Pierce, led Xaverian to a combined team total of 4-under 212, topping runner-up St. John’s (Shrewsbury) by 10 strokes.

The Hawks team score was the lowest in tournament history, breaking the previous mark of 223 set by Lincoln-Sudbury in 2016. Because only the top three cards count toward the team score, Pierce’s round was not part of the Hawks’ team effort.

“I’ve always been pretty good at playing in the rain. For some reason, I just get really focused and hit a lot of the fairways,” said McCormack. “These greens were outstanding, so I made a lot of putts. I knew I just had to get my ball rolling on the line, and it worked out well for me.”

The tournament — which began in 2016 in memory of Sioux Campbell, the late wife of former CCN head pro Jim Campbell — has evolved into the state’s marquee regular-season



MATTY WASSERMAN FOR THE GLOBE

**Xaverian golfers (from left) Chris Morrow, Tucker Pierce, Michael McCormack, and Luke Edgar, and coach Gerry Lambert, enjoy the win.**

high school golf event.

With nine of the state’s top teams in attendance, along with nine top players competing as individuals, it served as a benchmark ahead of next month’s MIAA state tournament.

“This [performance] definitely adds a lot of confidence,” said Morrow, who was medalist in Xaverian’s Division 1 state title victory last year. “It’s kind of like an early look at the state championship. . . . To shoot 4-under as a team, that’s pretty impressive.”

St. John’s (Shrewsbury) led Xaverian at the halfway mark, but it was the Hawks’ consistency that separated them down the stretch.

McCormack, Morrow, and Edgar combined for just six bogeys and did

Frazier, previously an assistant at various levels of high school football and who coached youth football in the community, was named Panthers coach following the abrupt resignation of **Bradley Leal**.

“To be the head coach of Whitman-Hanson is an honor,” Frazier said. “To get our first win as a staff and team was amazing. The support of the community has been unreal. I’m so thankful to the coaching staff, and the outstanding student athletes on this team. As a staff, we’ll continue to work hard and do everything we can for this program.”

■ Attleboro nearly upset cross-town rival Bishop Feehan on Friday, capitalizing on a pair of early turnovers to take a 13-10 halftime lead. But sophomore kicker **Jameson Pilling** booted field goals of 39 and 26 yards to give the Shamrocks a late lead, and **Dexter Izzo** sealed a 22-13 win with a pick.

■ Senior **Brady Shuffain** (14 of 21, 270 yards) passed for a program-record five TDs while leading the Sharon/Dedham co-op to a 40-18 win at Wareham. **Joseph Seaman** (7 receptions, 192 yards, 3 TDs) was his main target.

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ANDREW REDINGTON/GETTY IMAGES

J.J. Spaun celebrates after winning the BMW PGA Championship at Wentworth Golf Club in Virginia Water, England, on Sunday.

# SportsLog

## Ole Miss moves up to No. 4 in national poll

It's a good day for Ole Miss in the AP Top 25 rankings. The Rebels — who held off **Lane Kiffin** and LSU, 32-24, on Saturday night — jumped over the Tigers and three other teams to land at No. 4. Making their season debut in the poll are No. 21 Florida, which is 3-0 for the first time since 2019, and No. 24 Mississippi State. That leaves the Southeastern Conference with 10 ranked teams this week. Texas A&M took the biggest fall, going from No. 9 to No. 23 after its 31-21 home loss to unranked Kentucky. Louisville was the biggest gainer, rising seven spots to No. 16 after its 41-31 victory over SMU. Texas was No. 1 for the second straight week, followed by Georgia, Notre Dame, Ole Miss, and Indiana.

### W N B A

## Miles breaks Clark's rookie scoring record

**Napheesa Collier** scored 23 points, **Olivia Miles** added 21, and the Lynx beat the Sun, 101-89, to get closer to clinching the top seed in the WNBA playoffs. Minnesota (32-10) moved within one win or a Golden State loss from earning home-court advantage throughout the postseason. The Lynx close with a home-and-home set against Indiana. Miles broke the WNBA rookie record for points in a season that was held by **Caitlin Clark**. Miles got her 770th on a free throw in the second quarter, one more than Clark had for Indiana in 2024. The Sun honored former coach **Mike Thibault** before the game, its second-to-last in Connecticut before relocating to Houston next season. He led the franchise from its inception in 2003 until 2012. The Sun (10-32) have lost five games in a row. Connecticut, which has been plagued by injuries all season, lost **Saniya Rivers** to one in the first quarter.

## Stewart eighth on all-time scoring list

**Breanna Stewart** scored 27 points to help the New York Liberty rout the Toronto Tempo, 106-69, and stay in the hunt for homecourt in the opening round of the playoffs. New York (26-16) could finish anywhere from fourth to eighth in the playoff standings with two games remaining. Stewart moved into eighth place on the WNBA's all-time scoring list, passing **Capie Pondexter's** 6,811 points . . . **Nneka Ogumike** had 20 points, 12 rebounds, and 5 assists to help the Los Angeles Sparks beat the Portland Fire 105-84. Ogumike became the fourth player in WNBA history to reach 8,000 points, joining **Diana Taurasi** (10,646), **Tina Charles** (8,396), and **DeWanna Bonner** (8,217).

### GOLF

## Spaun wins BMW PGA Championship

**J.J. Spaun** responded to his disappointment of being left off the US Presidents Cup team by winning the BMW PGA Championship, making four birdies on the last five holes for a 5-under-par 67 and a two-shot victory in his debut at the European tour's flagship event. Spaun, last year's US Open champion at Oakmont, made it three Americans winning at Wentworth in the last six years. As well as he finished, Spaun needed plenty of help from **Manuel Elvira**. The 30-year-old Spaniard made a 9-foot eagle on the par-5 17th to tie Spaun for the lead and head to the par-5 closing hole needing birdie to win. Elvira chose iron off the tee, leaving him 254 yards from the green. He decided to lay up, but hit that into a bunker. He hit his next shot over the green, dumped a chip into a bunker and finished with a double bogey for a 70 . . . **Jacob Bridgeman** rallied from a five-shot deficit with the lowest round of his young PGA Tour career, a 10-under 61 that carried him to a two-shot victory in the Biltmore Championship Asheville . . . **Zach Johnson** won the Pure Insurance Championship on Sunday at foggy Pebble Beach for his second straight PGA Tour Champions victory and the sixth in his first season on the 50-and-over circuit.

### SOCCER

## Atletico beats Real in Madrid derby

Atletico Madrid won the first capital derby of the season in Spain's La Liga with a 2-1 triumph against 10-man Real Madrid. **Alejandro Grimaldo** and **Jonathan David** scored second-half goals for Atletico, which moved to second place behind Barcelona . . . Manchester City beat Sunderland, 5-3, to open a 3-point lead over defending champion Arsenal atop the English Premier League . . . **Lionel Messi** scored his 101st goal for host Inter Miami, but **Anders Dreyer** scored twice for San Diego FC as the teams played to a 2-2 draw. It was the fourth consecutive tie in MLS play for Inter Miami (12-4-10, 46 points), keeping it third in the Eastern Conference behind the Revolution (14-8-4, 46 points) on a tiebreaker.

### TENNIS

## Zverev, Germany advance in Davis Cup

**Alexander Zverev** sent Germany through to the Davis Cup quarterfinals, outclassing **Dino Prizmic** to secure a 3-1 victory over Croatia. Britain also advanced, with doubles pair **Henry Patten** and **Neal Skupski** beating **Gonzalo Escobar** and **Diego Hidalgo**, 6-3, 6-4, to secure a 3-0 win over Ecuador. Spain, without **Carlos Alcaraz**, secured an unassailable 3-0 lead over Chile after **Pedro Martínez** and **Jaume Munar** defeated **Tomás Barrios Vera** and **Alejandro Tabilo**, 6-0, 6-3.

## Colleges

### FOOTBALL

#### AP Top 25 poll

The poll as of Sept. 20, with first-place votes in parentheses, records, total points based on 25 points for a first-place vote through 1 point for 25th, and last week's rankings:

|                         | Rec. | Pts.  | LW |
|-------------------------|------|-------|----|
| 1. Texas (58).....      | 3-0  | 1,706 | 1  |
| 2. Georgia (3).....     | 3-0  | 1,590 | 2  |
| 3. Notre Dame.....      | 3-0  | 1,517 | 3  |
| 4. Mississippi (3)..... | 3-0  | 1,488 | 8  |
| 5. Indiana (4).....     | 3-0  | 1,467 | 4  |
| 6. Miami (1).....       | 3-0  | 1,445 | 5  |
| 7. Ohio State.....      | 2-1  | 1,415 | 6  |
| 8. Alabama.....         | 3-0  | 1,182 | 10 |
| 9. BYU.....             | 3-0  | 1,090 | 11 |
| 10. LSU.....            | 2-1  | 1,078 | 7  |
| 11. Texas Tech.....     | 3-0  | 1,067 | 13 |
| 12. USC.....            | 4-0  | 907   | 12 |
| 13. Penn State.....     | 3-0  | 850   | 14 |
| 14. Tennessee.....      | 3-0  | 826   | 15 |
| 15. Utah.....           | 3-0  | 752   | 17 |
| 16. Louisville.....     | 2-1  | 692   | 23 |
| 17. Iowa.....           | 3-0  | 561   | 18 |
| 18. Michigan.....       | 3-0  | 432   | 19 |
| 19. Missouri.....       | 3-0  | 369   | 20 |
| 20. Oregon.....         | 2-1  | 364   | 21 |
| 21. Florida.....        | 3-0  | 345   | 12 |
| 22. SMU.....            | 2-1  | 212   | 16 |
| 23. Texas A&M.....      | 2-1  | 202   | 9  |
| 24. Mississippi St..... | 3-0  | 179   | 32 |
| 25. Houston.....        | 2-1  | 127   | 22 |

**Also receiving votes:** Washington 107, Kentucky 93, West Virginia 93, Oklahoma 91, Oklahoma St. 50, Boise St. 48, Virginia Tech 46, W. Michigan 27, Duke 20, Tulsa 18, Arizona 12, Pittsburgh 10, UCLA 10, James Madison 7, North Dakota St. 6, Kansas St. 3, Nebraska 2.

#### FBS Coaches poll

The poll as of Sept. 20, with first-place votes in parentheses, records, total points based on 25 points for a first-place vote through 1 point for 25th, and last week's rankings:

|                        | Rec. | Pts.  | LW |
|------------------------|------|-------|----|
| 1. Texas (46).....     | 3-0  | 1,807 | 1  |
| 2. Georgia (16).....   | 3-0  | 1,742 | 2  |
| 3. Notre Dame (2)..... | 3-0  | 1,636 | 3  |
| 4. Indiana (9).....    | 3-0  | 1,613 | 4  |
| 5. Miami (1).....      | 3-0  | 1,552 | 5  |
| 6. Mississippi.....    | 3-0  | 1,551 | 6  |
| 7. Ohio State.....     | 2-1  | 1,473 | 6  |
| 8. Alabama.....        | 3-0  | 1,309 | 10 |
| 9. BYU.....            | 3-0  | 1,089 | 12 |
| 10. Texas Tech.....    | 3-0  | 1,079 | 12 |
| 11. LSU.....           | 2-1  | 1,067 | 7  |
| 12. USC.....           | 4-0  | 1,057 | 11 |
| 13. Tennessee.....     | 3-0  | 833   | 14 |
| 14. Penn State.....    | 3-0  | 803   | 15 |
| 15. Utah.....          | 3-0  | 743   | 17 |
| 16. Oregon.....        | 2-1  | 594   | 18 |
| 17. Iowa.....          | 3-0  | 580   | 20 |
| 18. Michigan.....      | 3-0  | 545   | 19 |
| 19. Louisville.....    | 2-1  | 519   | 27 |
| 20. Texas A&M.....     | 2-1  | 447   | 8  |
| 21. Missouri.....      | 3-0  | 382   | 22 |
| 22. Florida.....       | 3-0  | 370   | 26 |
| 23. Washington.....    | 2-0  | 251   | 24 |
| 24. Oklahoma.....      | 2-1  | 213   | 21 |
| 25. SMU.....           | 2-1  | 162   | 16 |

**Also receiving votes:** Houston 116, Mississippi St. 114, Duke 70, West Virginia 54, Kentucky 54, Oklahoma St. 36, Pittsburgh 35, Virginia Tech 30, Vanderbilt 29, Boise St. 29, Tulsa 20, Kansas St. 18, UCLA 18, W. Michigan 17, Nebraska 11, North Dakota St. 8, North-western 4, Clemson 3, UMass 2, James Madison 2, Arizona 1.

### SATURDAY'S SCORES

| ATLANTIC COAST         |                   |
|------------------------|-------------------|
| Alabama 50.....        | Florida St. 36    |
| Boston College 22..... | Maine 15          |
| California 49.....     | Stanford 7        |
| Clemson 28.....        | North Carolina 20 |
| Duke 35.....           | Stanford 7        |
| Georgia Tech 44.....   | Mercer 11         |
| Louisville 41.....     | SMU 31            |
| North Carolina 35..... | N.C. St. 6        |
| Virginia Tech 35.....  | Maryland 26       |
| West Virginia 38.....  | Virginia 27       |

| COASTAL             |                       |
|---------------------|-----------------------|
| Bryant 21.....      | Princeton 14          |
| Castelli 42.....    | North Carolina A&T 14 |
| Elon 24.....        | Sacred Heart 21       |
| Harvard 31.....     | UNH 7                 |
| Monmouth 28.....    | Albany 20             |
| UConn 41.....       | Towson 26             |
| Norfolk St. 48..... | Hampden 21            |
| Stony Brook 56..... | URI 24                |

### IVY LEAGUE

|                  |               |
|------------------|---------------|
| Brown 17.....    | New Haven 10  |
| Colgate 20.....  | Cornell 1     |
| Columbia 40..... | Lafayette 34  |
| Lehigh 24.....   | Dartmouth 10  |
| Penn 20.....     | Bucknell 7    |
| Yale 38.....     | Holy Cross 28 |

### NORTHEAST 10

|                         |               |
|-------------------------|---------------|
| Assumption 34.....      | Pace 27       |
| Bentley 29.....         | Post 7        |
| Franklin Pierce 56..... | St. Anselm 28 |
| Southern Conn. 21.....  | AIC 14        |

### CONFERENCE OF N.E.

|                      |                       |
|----------------------|-----------------------|
| Castleton 49.....    | Maine Maritime 0      |
| Coast Guard 49.....  | Nichols 42            |
| Endicott 28.....     | Mary Hardin-Baylor 27 |
| Ham-Sudbury 43.....  | U. New England 41     |
| N.E. College 23..... | Fitchburg 22          |
| Northwestern 51..... | Castleton 51          |
| Western N.E. 42..... | Worcester St. 40      |
| WPI 13.....          | Husson 7              |

### MASCAC

|                         |                |
|-------------------------|----------------|
| Bridgewater St. 35..... | Plymouth St. 7 |
| Westfield St. 26.....   | Dean 8         |

### NESAC

|                   |               |
|-------------------|---------------|
| Amherst 24.....   | Bates 14      |
| Trinity 41.....   | Colby 14      |
| Tuffs 42.....     | Hamilton 28   |
| Austeylan 35..... | Middlebury 13 |
| Williams 17.....  | Bowdoin 7     |

### NEWMAC

|                       |                    |
|-----------------------|--------------------|
| Salve Regina 41.....  | William Paterson 6 |
| WV-Plattville 37..... | Springfield 14     |

### OTHER NEW ENGLAND

|                      |                  |
|----------------------|------------------|
| Gettysburg 34.....   | Western Conn. 28 |
| Montana St. 35.....  | Central Conn. 20 |
| Tarleton St. 45..... | Merrimack 20     |
| UConn 48.....        | Southern Miss 20 |
| UMass 36.....        | Stonewall 14     |

### OTHER EAST

|                    |                     |
|--------------------|---------------------|
| Delaware 27.....   | Coastal Carolina 14 |
| Mercyhurst 49..... | Glenville St. 10    |
| Penn State 55..... | Buffalo 13          |
| UConn 42.....      | Rutgers 35          |
| Villanova 20.....  | LIU 16              |

### SOUTH

|                            |                              |
|----------------------------|------------------------------|
| Alabama A&M 45.....        | Bowie St. 21                 |
| Appalachian St. 26.....    | Charlotte 21                 |
| Belmont 62.....            | W. Virginia 3                |
| Charleston So. 65.....     | Point University 0           |
| Chattanooga 40.....        | University of Chattanooga 21 |
| Chattanooga 40.....        | University of Chattanooga 21 |
| Richmond 24.....           | Georgetown 21                |
| St. Louisiana 38.....      | La.-Monroe 35                |
| South Alabama 41.....      | Ohio 36                      |
| South Carolina St. 20..... | Furman 17                    |
| South Florida 59.....      | Delaware 17                  |
| Southern 50.....           | Louisiana Christian 13       |
| Tennessee 42.....          | Kennesaw St. 9               |
| Tennessee St. 29.....      | Florida A&M 26               |
| UCF 44.....                | Georgia St. 30               |
| W. Carolina 58.....        | Presbyterian 14              |

### MIDWEST

|                            |                   |
|----------------------------|-------------------|
| Arizona St. 24.....        | Kansas 17         |
| Butler 47.....             | Chicago State 20  |
| Central Mich. 24.....      | Wyoming 14        |
| Cincinnati 35.....         | Miami (Ohio) 31   |
| Illinois 48.....           | Illinois 31       |
| Illinois St. 49.....       | Eastern Ill. 13   |
| Indiana 38.....            | Western Ky. 0     |
| Indiana St. 39.....        | Valparaiso 16     |
| Iowa 55.....               | Northern Iowa 0   |
| Iowa State 55.....         | Bowling Green 7   |
| Kansas St. 31.....         | Tulane 20         |
| Marshall 30.....           | Missouri St. 24   |
| Michigan 52.....           | UTEP 17           |
| Minnesota 41.....          | Akron 17          |
| Missouri 27.....           | Trinity 17        |
| Nebraska 34.....           | North Dakota 7    |
| North Dakota St. 31.....   | Sacramento St. 10 |
| Northwestern 41.....       | Colorado 27       |
| Notre Dame 27.....         | Michigan 17       |
| Ohio State 59.....         | Kent State 3      |
| S.E. Missouri St. 27.....  | Cent. Arkansas 9  |
| S.Dakota St. 27.....       | Youngstown St. 20 |
| St. Thomas (Minn.) 28..... | So. Utah 26       |
| Teledale 49.....           | Temple 48         |
| Western Illinois 59.....   | Morehead St. 2    |
| Wisconsin 54.....          | E. Michigan 10    |

### SOUTHWEST

|                           |                      |
|---------------------------|----------------------|
| Arizona 42.....           | Northern Illinois 17 |
| Ark.-Pine Bluff 41.....   | Cent. St. 15         |
| Baylor 36.....            | Louisiana Tech 19    |
| Georgia 45.....           | Arkansas 17          |
| Houston Christian 23..... | UIW 30               |
| Kentucky 31.....          | Texas A&M 21         |
| Louisiana 14.....         | New Mexico 6         |
| Oklahoma St. 59.....      | Murray St. 0         |
| Sam Houston St. 59.....   | Nicholls 0           |
| S.F. Austin 31.....       | Prairie View A&M 10  |
| Texas 30.....             | Arkansas St. 5       |
| Texas State 49.....       | North Texas 35       |
| Tulsa 42.....             | Texas A&M-Commerce 0 |
| W. Michigan 28.....       | Rice 21              |

### WEST

|                          |                  |
|--------------------------|------------------|
| Abilene Christian.....   | Idaho 39         |
| Boise St. 38.....        | South Dakota 24  |
| BYU 41.....              | Colorado St. 23  |
| Fresno State 26.....     | San Jose St. 0   |
| Northwestern St. 20..... | Weber St. 49     |
| San Diego 38.....        | Cal Poly 35      |
| UCLA 52.....             | Purdue 38        |
| Utah 33.....             | Utah State 0     |
| Washington 48.....       | E. Washington 16 |
| Washington St. 48.....   | Duquesne 7       |

## Golf

### BMW PGA CHAMPIONSHIP

At Wentworth Club, Virginia Water, England  
Yardage: 7,267; par: 72

|                         |                 |     |
|-------------------------|-----------------|-----|
| J.J. Spaun.....         | 70-66-68-67-271 | -17 |
| Manuel Elvira.....      | 69-66-68-70-273 | -15 |
| Rory McIlroy.....       | 69-67-69-68-273 | -15 |
| Aaron Rai.....          | 66-69-72-66-273 | -15 |
| Adam Scott.....         | 67-67-71-68-273 | -15 |
| Filippo Colli.....      | 69-66-69-71-274 | -14 |
| Matt Fitzpatrick.....   | 72-68-67-67-274 | -14 |
| Ryan Fox.....           | 68-68-70-68-274 | -14 |
| Joost Luiten.....       | 70-71-69-64-274 | -14 |
| J. Lagergren.....       | 66-72-71-66-275 | -13 |
| R. MacIntyre.....       | 68-72-66-69-275 | -13 |
| Guido Migliorini.....   | 70-69-69-67-275 | -13 |
| Andy Sullivan.....      | 69-70-72-64-275 | -13 |
| Matt Wallace.....       | 71-66-69-69-275 | -13 |
| A. Del Rey.....         | 69-71-64-72-276 | -12 |
| Ross Fisher.....        | 69-67-73-67-276 | -12 |
| Alex Noren.....         | 71-67-69-69-272 | -12 |
| Sepp Straka.....        | 71-67-72-66-276 | -12 |
| J. Veerman.....         | 68-72-64-72-276 | -12 |
| Jeff Winther.....       | 71-68-70-67-276 | -12 |
| Alex Fitzpatrick.....   | 72-70-68-67-277 | -11 |
| E. Lopez-Chacón.....    | 70-69-70-68-277 | -11 |
| Shane Lowry.....        | 71-69-69-68-277 | -11 |
| Joaquin Niemann.....    | 71-67-67-72-277 | -11 |
| Jordan Smith.....       | 71-67-69-70-277 | -11 |
| Paul Waring.....        | 71-69-69-68-277 | -11 |
| Ludvig Åberg.....       | 67-72-67-72-278 | -9  |
| M. Arncliffe.....       | 70-68-71-69-278 | -11 |
| Sam Bairstow.....       | 72-68-66-72-278 | -10 |
| Davis Bryant.....       | 68-70-67-73-278 | -10 |
| Ryan Gerard.....        | 67-65-75-71-278 | -10 |
| Tyrell Hattori.....     | 70-70-71-67-278 | -10 |
| Viktor Hovland.....     | 68-71-69-70-278 | -10 |
| Y. Katsuragawa.....     | 73-67-68-70-278 | -10 |
| Freddy Schott.....      | 68-74-69-67-278 | -10 |
| Daniel Hillier.....     | 71-70-69-69-279 | -9  |
| R. Neeson.....          | 68-72-72-67-279 | -9  |
| Jayden Schaper.....     | 70-70-69-70-279 | -9  |
| Sean Crocker.....       | 69-71-72-68-280 | -8  |
| M. Hellikilke.....      | 69-69-72-70-280 | -8  |
| Adrian Otaegui.....     | 70-68-70-72-280 | -8  |
| David Puig.....         | 71-70-71-68-280 | -8  |
| Kristoffer Reitan.....  | 71-70-64-75-280 | -8  |
| R. Cabrera Bello.....   | 73-67-72-69-281 | -7  |
| Nacho Elvira.....       | 67-69-72-73-281 | -7  |
| Charley Hoffman.....    | 73-68-70-70-281 | -7  |
| Frederic LaCroix.....   | 69-70-75-67-281 | -7  |
| David Law.....          | 69-71-70-281    | -7  |
| Shaun Norris.....       | 71-71-72-67-281 | -7  |
| Danny Willett.....      | 71-69-73-68-281 | -7  |
| Angel Ayora.....        | 70-68-72-72-282 | -6  |
| Ricardo Gonzalez.....   | 69-70-71-72-282 | -6  |
| Matthew Jordan.....     | 70-71-71-72-282 | -6  |
| R. Langasque.....       | 72-70-68-72-282 | -6  |
| Justin Rose.....        | 73-68-70-71-282 | -6  |
| Martin Couvra.....      | 71-69-75-68-283 | -5  |
| Joe Dean.....           | 69-69-76-69-283 | -5  |
| Ewen Ferguson.....      | 69-72-70-72-283 | -5  |
| Kazuma Kobori.....      | 70-72-69-72-283 | -5  |
| Niklas Lemke.....       | 69-62-69-73-283 | -5  |
| Yuta Kurematsu.....     | 70-71-71-71-283 | -5  |
| Rory McIlroy.....       | 70-71-75-68-284 | -4  |
| Adam Minihill.....      | 70-70-70-70-284 | -4  |
| Laport.....             | 72-70-72-70-284 | -4  |
| Adrian Meronik.....     | 72-69-73-73-284 | -4  |
| Adrian Soddier.....     | 71-70-71-72-284 | -4  |
| Alex Smalley.....       | 70-71-73-70-284 | -4  |
| Junghwan Lee.....       | 70-70-70-70-284 | -4  |
| Adam Scott.....         | 69-67-70-75-285 | -3  |
| Niklas Norgaard.....    | 74-65-70-75-286 | 0   |
| O. Guillamond.....      | 73-69-71-74-287 | 1   |
| N. de. Dellingsham..... | 68-74-72-75-289 | 3   |

LivingArts

By Stuart Munro  
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Charlie Musselwhite is one of the last men standing from the golden era of electric Chicago blues. His latest project is a collaboration with GA-20, the Boston band dedicated to carrying on that musical tradition. The album they made together, “Blues Now,” came out at the end of July and has enjoyed quick success; it debuted at No. 6 on the Billboard blues album chart and rose to No. 1 on both the iTunes Top US Blues Albums and the Amazon Top 100 New Blues Albums charts. Musselwhite and the band have done a limited run of shows in support of the album; they come to Portsmouth, N.H., and Fall River later this week.

Musselwhite has had a long-running association with GA-20 cofounder and guitarist Matt Stubbs; Stubbs has played guitar in his touring band since 2008. But other than Musselwhite playing on GA-20’s very first single, “Naggin’ on My Mind,” in 2018, it hadn’t occurred to them to join forces until their new record. So what precipitated the collaboration?

“It was my idea a few years ago. I’d always wanted to produce a record with Charlie, and once we got GA-20 going and I started producing our records, it just seemed like an idea that could be a lot of fun,” said Stubbs during a recent joint Zoom conversation with Musselwhite. He presented the idea to Musselwhite and his wife/manager Henrietta, and they were on board.

It took a few years for both parties to find time where they could bring the idea to fruition, however, and they had to give some space to a record that Musselwhite put out in 2025. That time gave them the opportunity to deliberate and “just marinate the idea of how we were going to do it and what the concept was going to be,” Stubbs recalled.

The overall concept wasn’t complicated: They wanted to make a GA-20 record with Charlie Musselwhite on it. It wouldn’t be a departure from the sound of the albums



ELIZABETH ELLENWOOD

GA-20 and Charlie Musselwhite (far right) have upcoming shows together in Portsmouth, N.H. (Sept. 24), and Fall River (Sept. 26).

Charlie Musselwhite was pals with Howlin’ Wolf and Muddy Waters. His newest collaborators? Boston band GA-20.

GA-20 had made in the past, but would go a little deeper.

“We love Chicago blues, and Charlie was *in* it, you know what I mean?” Stubbs said. “He’s been part of Chicago blues since the ’60s.”

He surely was in it: Not only did Musselwhite play with those blues luminaries, they were also his friends.

**GA-20 AND CHARLIE MUSSELWHITE**  
At Jimmy’s Jazz & Blues Club, 135 Congress St., Portsmouth, N.H., Thursday, Sept. 24, 7:30 p.m. Sold out. jimmysoncongress.com  
At Narrows Center for the Arts, 16 Anawan St., Fall River, Saturday, Sept. 26, 8 p.m. Tickets: \$77. narrowscenter.org

“I knew all those guys,” he remarked. “We were all pals, you know? I knew [Howlin’] Wolf, and Muddy [Waters], and Sunny Boy [Williamson], and Little Walter, and on and on and on. I’d sit in with them, or just talk,

hang out with them.” Musselwhite has endless stories about

When fire razed her childhood home, Empress Of built another in music

By Carolina Abbott Galvão  
NEW YORK TIMES

Inked on the inside of Lorely Rodriguez’s left wrist is the word “Altadena.” The singer-songwriter and producer, who performs as Empress Of, got the tattoo after the Eaton fire blazed through the Los Angeles neighborhood in January 2025, destroying properties including her childhood home.

“I’m just really proud of the resilience of my town,” she said in a video interview. Her brown hair, streaked with a few beige and golden strands, fell in ringlets onto the shoulders of her pale blue top.

Rodriguez was thinking, in particular, of her mother, Reina, who decided to rebuild the house from the ground up. “She’s a very driven person,” the musician said. “Once she puts her mind to something, it happens.”

Still, the process wasn’t easy. In the months after the fire, the family dealt with a number of issues: Would they get a permit to rebuild? Had the soil underneath the house been contaminated? If everything worked out, how would they make the new place a home? On her latest LP, “Dream House,” out Friday, Rodriguez considers some of those questions and grapples with what it means to create anew.

The album lies within the electronic pop style she’s been known for since her debut in 2015, music filled with fizzy soundscapes and breezy melodies that also flirts with the counterintuitive or unfamiliar. “Dream House” expands that vision into something more structured, more conceptual.

“I feel I’ve done a lot,” she said, “but I’ve never made a record like this.”

Rodriguez, 36, first started making music as a kid in Altadena. Her mother, who immigrated to the United States from Honduras, worked as a cleaner and nanny, and she had always dreamed of buying property.

“You know,” Rodriguez said, “to just have safety and a home for her family.”

Eventually, her mother purchased a one-level, three-bedroom, 1960s-style house — “modest,” according to Rodriguez. But Rodriguez loved it and everything around it: the midcentury library where her dad took her after school several times a week, the mountains and hiking trails that flanked the town, the roses her mother planted in the garden.

Looking back, Rodriguez also loved that her school valued the arts. Yes, it was public

school and the classes were crowded, but “there was always a teacher who was like, ‘This girl can sing,’ or, ‘This kid can draw.’”

Rodriguez stayed in Altadena until she left for Boston to attend Berklee College of Music. In 2011, she moved to New York, where she became involved with the DIY scene. “That’s when my education really started as a musician,” she said.

Back then, she spent her evenings at warehouses watching artists perform. Chairlift, the synth-pop band, was on the rise, as were acts like Blood Orange — the musician Dev Hynes, who features on “Dream House” — Grimes and Unknown Mortal Orchestra. Rodriguez recalled meeting Hynes on the street outside Webster Hall in Manhattan and getting to know Chairlift at 285 Kent and Glasslands Gallery, two performance spaces in Brooklyn that have since closed.

“It felt like we were in this vortex of cultivating music, and just hungry — or at least I was hungry,” Rodriguez said wryly. “I was broke in New York.”

One evening during that era, a friend was giving Rodriguez a tarot reading when he pulled out a card depicting the Empress, one of 22 archetypes in a deck. Rodriguez was still trying to figure out what she wanted to call her project, and the name — which she said evoked femininity, creativity, and birth — stuck with her.

She found herself returning to those themes last year after the fire as she worked on her album while watching her mother make plans to rebuild. Their joint endeavors signaled a period of renewal.

“I’ve just been building the idea of a house within the music,” she said, “and now there’s a physical house that represents the album.”

Among the first tracks she wrote for the project was “Dream House,” which imagines the home she hoped for her mother to inhabit. “The windows are open, breezes are blowing,” she sings over a trip-hop beat, describing with touching specificity what life could look like. “There’s lavender rose tea on the stove.”

“My mom’s built such a dream for me, where I get to pursue my dreams and make music,” she said in our interview. “I was just thinking about her and, like, filling this house with all the stuff that she wanted.”

For Rodriguez and her collaborators, finishing the song felt like a turning point of



MAIWENN RAOULT/NEW YORK TIMES

**Singer-songwriter and producer Lorely Rodriguez performs as Empress Of.**

sorts. “Like, ‘Oh, we’ve got something real here,” said Caila Thompson-Hannant, known as Cecile Believe, who was a co-writer of several tracks on the album.

James Harmon Stack — who is known as Jim-E Stack and has produced Bon Iver, Lorde, and Olivia Rodrigo — first worked with Rodriguez on her 2018 song “When I’m With Him.” He said he grew emotional watching her perform it last year while opening for Lorde in Los Angeles.

Rodriguez “is the kind of artist who takes different influences, takes very personal parts of herself — and her history as a human being,” he said, “and mashes that up with a beautiful, poppy top line that breaks your heart.”

Rodriguez builds a similar mosaic of evocative themes and melodies on “Dream House.” Interspersed with the story of the fire are Rodriguez’s own concerns about instability and impermanence. She moves from yearning for the ephemeral on “Blue Light” to seeking the familiarity of home in new places on “Trainsong.” On “Machete,” an ode to her independence, she finds it within herself: “Finally,” she sings, breathless, “I’m nobody’s baby.”

Interludes featuring her mother, Reina, narrating stories about the house and her own life bind those elements together. Rodriguez made video recordings of her mother in the past year, and said using the footage helped her “paint a picture” of her mom’s feelings and made the project less about her own experience.

Rodriguez said making “Dream House” ultimately cemented her conviction in humanism and human-made art.

“My hope is that by making this for myself, I can help someone process something — whatever it is — and we can celebrate, or cry, or dance together,” she said.

National Book Awards: Marlon James, Louise Erdrich, and Karl Ove Knausgaard on long lists

By Hillel Italie  
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — Marlon James’s “The Disappearers,” his deeply personal novel about the persecution and perseverance of gay men in Jamaica in the 1980s, is among the nominees on the long lists for the National Book Awards.

Other works cited last week by National Book Foundation judges include a story collection by Louise Erdrich, the latest novel from Norway’s Karl Ove Knausgaard, and a middle grade novel by Chanel Miller.

The foundation released lists of 10 nominees in five competitive categories: fiction, nonfiction, poetry, books in translation, and young people’s literature. Judges will pare the finalists to five in each category, to be announced Oct. 6. Winners will be revealed during a Nov. 18 ceremony in Manhattan, when honorary medals will be presented to Salman Rushdie for Distinguished Contribution to American Letters and Perri Klass for Outstanding Service to the American Literary Community.

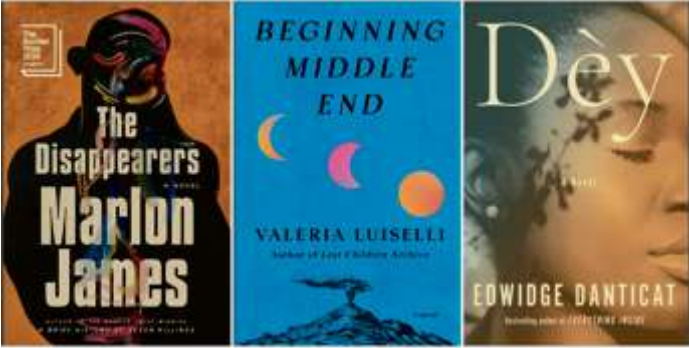
James’s novel, which also

was on the long list for the Booker Prize, is a fiction nominee for the National Book Award, with others including Erdrich’s “Python’s Kiss,” Edwidge Danticat’s “Dèy,” Valeria Luiselli’s “Beginning Middle End” and Alexander Maksik’s “Passengers.”

Miller, whose other books include her acclaimed memoir about being a victim of sexual assault, “Know My Name,” is a young adult nominee for “The Moon Without Stars.”

Knausgaard’s “The School of Night,” translated from the Norwegian by Martin Aitken, is on the translation long list, along with Taiwanese author Ping Lu’s “To the East of the East” and Indonesian Intan Paramaditha’s “Night of a Thousand Hells,” among others.

Nonfiction nominees include Colin Asher’s “The Midnight Special: The Secret Prison History of American Music” and Camonghne Felix’s “Let the Poets Govern: A Declaration of Freedom.” Layli Long Soldier’s “We,” Victoria Chang’s “Tree of Knowledge,” and Richie Hofmann’s “The Bronze Arms” were among the poetry nominees.



RIVERHEAD/KNOPF/KNOPF VIA AP

“The Disappearers” by Marlon James, “Beginning Middle End” by Valeria Luiselli, and “Dèy” by Edwidge Danticat are among the nominees on the long lists for the National Book Awards. Nominees will be pared down on Oct. 6 and winners will be revealed on Nov. 18.



GENE J. PUSKAR/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Cars lined up at a station on the Massachusetts Turnpike.

## Volatile region, markets make it tough to know when gas prices will stabilize

By Elizabeth Mehler  
BOSTON.COM

Drivers across Massachusetts are facing rapidly rising gas prices, with averages of \$4.39 a gallon statewide as of Thursday, according to AAA.

Gas prices have risen 13 cents per gallon within the last week, more than 30 cents in a month, and more than \$1.25 in a year. While fall is typically when gas prices drop, AAA Northeast spokesperson Mark Schieldrop said this fall is an “unusual” situation.

“This is generally when prices cool down with the end of the summer driving season,” he said. “Usually we’re on a slow and fairly steady descent toward the lowest prices of the year [in late winter].”

Another concern, Schieldrop said, is the price of diesel. Currently diesel is at \$6.24 a gallon in the state, which will add to the financial strain for Massachusetts residents.

“Diesel prices really tell us what home heating oil prices are going to look like this year, and that’s going to

be a big challenge for people as they’re figuring out their winter budget,” he said. “It’s not just [that] we’re paying more at the pump for gasoline; fuel and energy costs are pretty elevated.”

What’s driving these rising prices? Schieldrop said it’s largely the war with Iran, now in its seventh month, which is causing global disruption and supply concerns.

“We’re in a really tough spot because there doesn’t seem to be much

**GAS, Page D2**

## For Black leaders, AI threat isn’t hypothetical. It’s here now.

By Hiawatha Bray  
GLOBE STAFF

In Washington last week, an extraordinary coalition — Republican and Democratic lawmakers, labor leaders, scientists, movie stars, and even a Roman Catholic archbishop — gathered to demand government action to rein in artificial intelligence systems.

The group running the event touted its remarkable diversity. But almost none of those onstage were Black. And of the seven members of Congress who spoke at the event, not one came from the 62-member Congressional Black Caucus, which represents every Black Democrat in Congress.

Their absence might suggest that Black powerbrokers are not at the table amid what’s quickly become a ferocious political controversy, even as public skepticism over the rapidly advancing technology intensifies weeks before congressional elections.

But a spokesperson for the Future of Life Institute, which sponsored the event, said several Black legislators were invited but declined because it conflicted with the Congressional Black Caucus’s annual legislative conference.

In fact, Black lawmakers said they have been calling out dangers and prob-



ALEX WONG/GETTY IMAGES

**Congressional Black Caucus Chairperson Yvette Clarke proposed a law to root out racial biases in AI in 2019, long before anyone had heard of ChatGPT.**

lems with AI for some time. But those efforts have not been targeting the latest apocalyptic fears that AI could wipe out all human life. Instead, Black politicians have tended to focus on present-day concerns, such as AI systems with built-in racial biases or inadequate privacy protections. They’re also calling for tougher regulation of AI data centers, to ensure they don’t bring air pollution, noise, and higher electric bills to Black communities.

“I certainly have been sort of the canary in the coal mine,” said New York Democratic Representative and Black Caucus Chair Yvette Clarke, who proposed a law to root out racial biases in AI in 2019, long before anyone had heard of ChatGPT.

A 2025 bill drafted by Clarke and co-sponsored by Massachusetts Democratic Representative Ayanna Pressley would require that AI systems not be biased against humans based on race, sex, age, national origin, or religion. Clarke and Pressley also have proposed a bill requiring “impact assessments” of AI software used in critical industries including health care, public utilities, and banking.

“Congress can’t stand idly by while AI and billionaires threaten humankind, gamble with our lives, and exploit Black, brown, and other marginalized communities,” Pressley said in an email. “We need comprehensive, federal AI regulations now that prioritize our

**AI, Page D3**



JUAN DIEGO REYES/THE NEW YORK TIMES

The number of people receiving drugs such as Wegovy or Ozempic through their insurance for obesity plunged by half after insurers largely stopped automatically covering it for that purpose in January.

## Private health insurers covered 112,000 fewer Massachusetts residents’ GLP-1 weight-loss drugs this year, new report finds

By Marin Wolf  
GLOBE STAFF

Private health insurers paid for over 100,000 fewer Massachusetts residents’ GLP-1 drugs for obesity earlier this year, after they restricted coverage, according to a recent state report.

The number of people receiving the blockbuster drugs such as Wegovy or Zepbound through their insurance for obesity plunged by half after insurers largely stopped automatically covering that purpose in January. Between the end of 2025 and the first quarter of 2026, 112,000 fewer commercial insurance customers had a GLP-1 prescription covered for weight loss, according to the Sept. 17 report by the Massachusetts Health Policy Commission, a state agency.

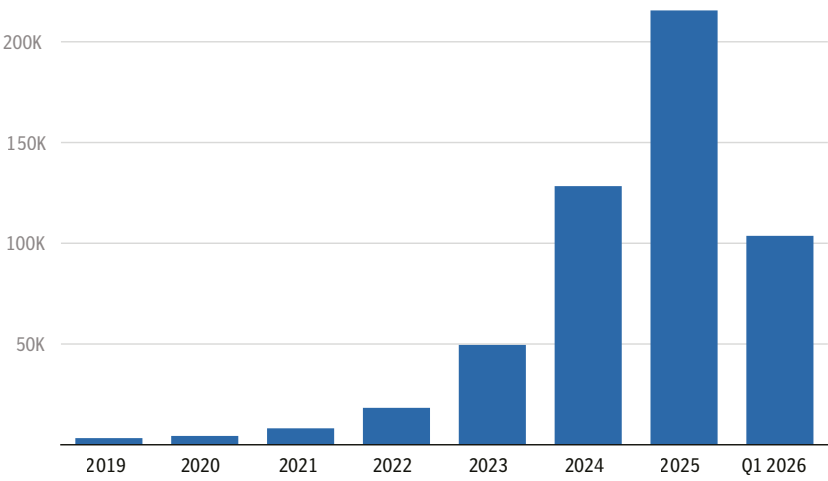
The widespread discontinuation of coverage for GLP-1s this year came after Massachusetts insurers blamed years of record losses on surging use of the expensive drugs.

Blue Cross Blue Shield of Massachusetts, Point32Health, and other private insurers ended blanket coverage of the drugs for obesity, which is linked to myriad poor health conditions and outcomes and af-

**INSURANCE, Page D2**

### Mass. residents on GLP-1s through insurance plummets

Number of Mass. insurance customers with a GLP-1 prescription for weight loss.



Data includes commercially-insured patients only.

Chart: CHRISTINA PRIGNANO/GLOBE STAFF • Source: Mass. Health Policy Commission

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

MICROSOFT AI CHIEF: CHINA ISN'T EXCUSE TO FOREGO REGULATION

Microsoft Corp. artificial intelligence chief Mustafa Suleyman said concerns about China's progress on AI shouldn't be used as an argument against putting guardrails around the rapidly advancing technology. "I don't think we should use China as the bogeyman for not making progress on our own efforts" on AI safety, Suleyman said on CNN's Fareed Zakaria GPS. His comment contrasts with those from President Trump, who has increasingly called for largely unfettered development of AI and called fears of potentially catastrophic consequences of out-of-control artificial intelligence a hoax. "We will not in any way hinder or stifle the Growth of this incredible Industry," he said in a social post Saturday. Suleyman's Microsoft AI team on Tuesday published a manifesto guiding its own AI development with the goal of keeping humans in control of future AI systems developed by the company. He also released an essay last week that took aim at some of the language in the guiding documents behind Claude, Anthropic PBC's family of large language models — a high-profile rebuke of a firm that has positioned itself as a more responsible steward of AI. AI developers should give models goals that are "bounded by the humanist code that I think everyone in the industry should set for them, which is that they should have clear guardrails," Suleyman told CNN. Regulation shouldn't be viewed as "a bad thing," but rather as "creating shared norms and standards to increase safety," he said. "It shouldn't have to slow us down." Trump said Saturday he plans to name an AI czar and rejected concerns that technology may pose risks to humans. "We are leading China, and the rest of the World, and I intend to keep it that way!" he said.

— BLOOMBERG NEWS

AEROSPACE & DEFENSE

AS CARNEY HOPES FOR STRONGER EU ALLIANCE, CANADA AND FRANCE LOOK TO DEVELOP SPACE SYSTEMS, DEFENSE

Canada and France have asked their space agencies and defense departments to develop and share infrastructure including space-launch systems, Prime Minister Mark Carney said on a visit to a French territory near Newfoundland and Labrador. The prime minister made the announcement Sunday alongside French President Emmanuel Macron at Saint-Pierre, the capital of Saint-Pierre and Miquelon, a French archipelago that sits just off Canada's Atlantic coast. No timelines or funding commitments were disclosed. The measure illustrates Canada's push to deepen its ties with European partners as it tries to reduce its economic dependence on the US. Carney framed the effort in terms of sovereignty. "Today to be sovereign goes beyond being able to feed, fuel, and defend ourselves," he said. "It requires secure access to artificial intelligence, to space, semiconductors, critical minerals, clean energy." On Wednesday, European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen proposed making Canada the first associate member of the European Union. Carney said Canada wants a "far stronger, more ambitious alliance" with the EU, including cooperation in several areas. Canada's move to strengthen its European links comes as its relations have soured with the US, its largest trading partner. President Trump imposed 50 percent tariffs on \$20 billion of goods imported from Canada last month — adding to existing tariffs on autos, steel, lumber, and other items. Canada retaliated with tariffs on a roughly equal amount of US-made products.

— BLOOMBERG NEWS

# Middle East war has lead to volatile market, high costs

►GAS

Continued from Page D1

indication that we're going to have negotiations," he said. "Diplomacy doesn't seem to be in the headlines right now, and we're seeing escalation and some spillover throughout the Middle East."

Because of this, Schieldrop said, the demand for US oil has also remained unusually high for this time of year, further contributing to the rising prices.

"It's really having an impact on output [in the Middle East], and as a result, we are becoming the replacement source for many countries around the world," he said. "Generally this time of year demand cools down and there's a little bit of surplus production and that helps boost inventories a little bit ... right now all the domestic production is running at full bore, and every drop is basically being exported."

Schildrop said prices will "level off at some point" and the price of a barrel of oil is the best indicator.

"It really depends on how long this war continues and how that disruption continues, and then what the price of oil is," he said. "If we see oil prices start to go back down to the 90s [per barrel] and then the 80s, we'll start to see prices cool off at the pump relatively quickly."

"Will we level off at \$4.50, \$4.60, or \$4.45? I don't know," he added. "The market will find a place, but we've seen a lot of volatility too, and things can change on short notice, so it's really hard to predict where things will go long term."

Until then, Schildrop said lower-income people will be affected the most.

"People are feeling it, especially people with less-fuel-efficient vehicles and people with lower incomes, because those are the people who are paying a much higher percentage of their overall budget," he said. "When gas prices go up they feel the pain much more severely than for affluent folks."

# Private insurance spending on GLP-1s drastically falls

►INSURANCE

Continued from Page D1

fects 27 percent of Massachusetts residents, according to Massachusetts Department of Public Health data.

The drugs have been shown to reduce body weight by between 15 and 25 percent on average after about a year of treatment.

Starting in January, many plans gave employers the option to cover the drugs for obesity for a higher charge. At a time when health care costs are top of mind, many opted against it.

Some public insurers, including MassHealth and the Group Insurance Commission — which provides health coverage to public employees, retirees, and their families — also limited GLP-1 coverage for weight loss, although those plans are not included in the Health Policy Commission's report.

The insurers all continue to cover the drugs for people who have diabetes or other conditions, but people with obesity alone largely no longer have coverage.

The report does not include data on whether commercial insurance members continued to get GLP-1s by paying out-of-pocket, which can cost from \$150 to upward of \$400 per month.

"I do wonder a lot about what happened to those folks" and how many had to stop taking the medications, said Amanda Katchmar, senior research analyst at the Health Policy Commission's Office of Pharmaceutical Policy and Analysis. "We know that that's expensive, and folks' ability to pay for that out of pocket might vary based on their circumstances."

Susan Ellsbree, 55, who lives in Jamaica Plain, said she lost 42 pounds on Zepbound, which she began taking last year, before her insurer, Harvard Pilgrim Health Care, ended coverage for obesity in January.

The GLP-1 cost her \$50 a month and helped ease her arthritis in her knees as a result of her weight loss, reducing how much medication she needed for it. It also enabled her to halve the dosage of her blood pressure medication.

After Harvard Pilgrim stopped covering Zepbound, Ellsbree, an executive vice president at lobbying and communications firm Benchmark Strategies, switched to Mochi Health, a telehealth platform. Mochi sells her a compounded GLP-1 medication for \$199 a month. She has lost five more pounds on that drug but doesn't want to lose any more weight.

She's lucky she can afford Mochi's product but is still angry because of "the inequality of health care for people who can't privately pay," she said.

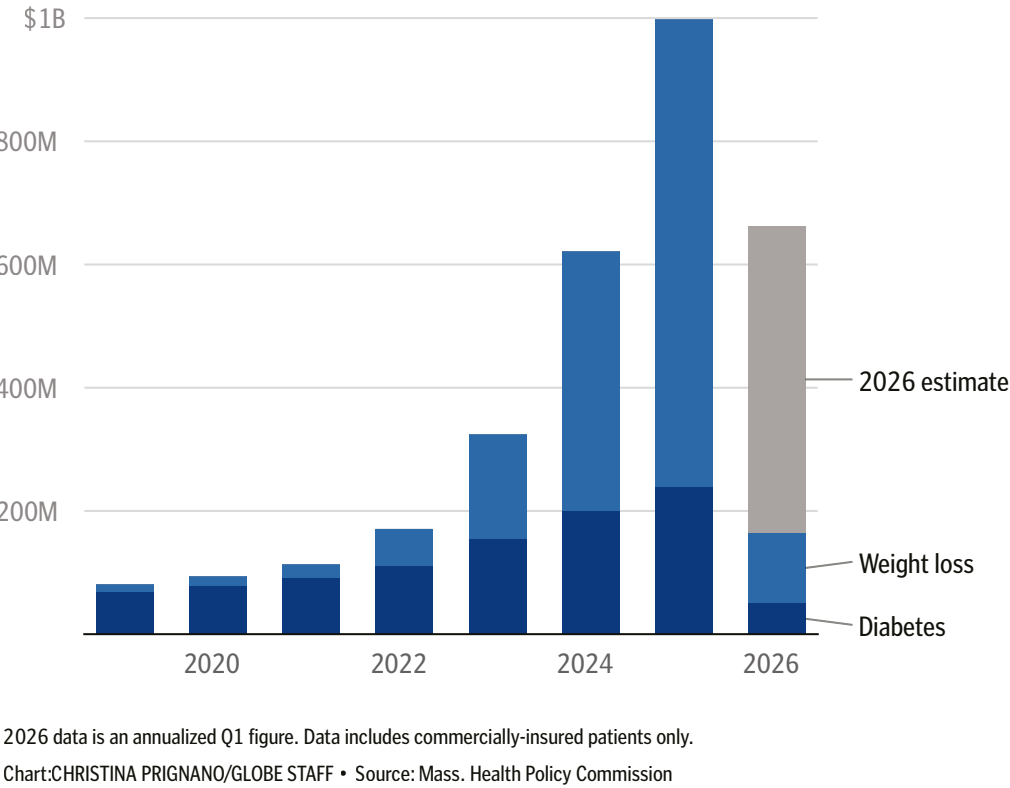
"It's a terrible injustice," said Ellsbree. "I feel like I'm very fortunate that I can still be on it and get the health benefits. But there are so many more people who can't. I feel it's very unfair."

Ellsbree is skeptical that health insurers will save money in the long run by ending coverage of GLP-1s for obesity, given the many health benefits of shedding weight.

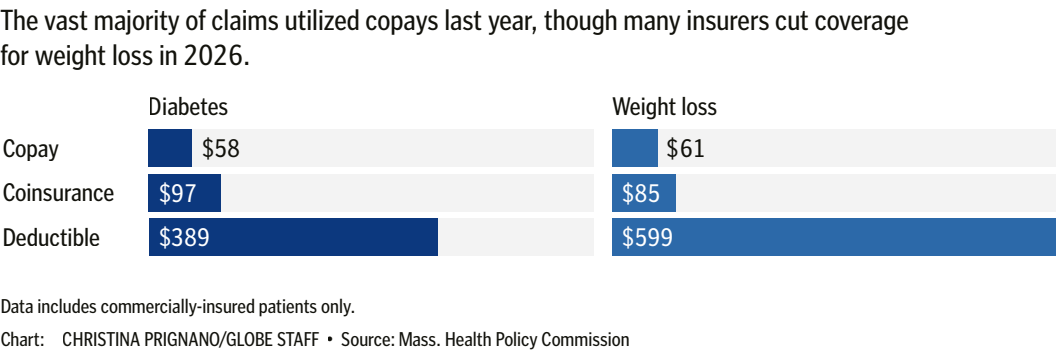
"I think in the long run they're going to end up paying more money because obesity is a serious health issue," she said.

During a presentation of the report at the Health Policy Commission board meeting on

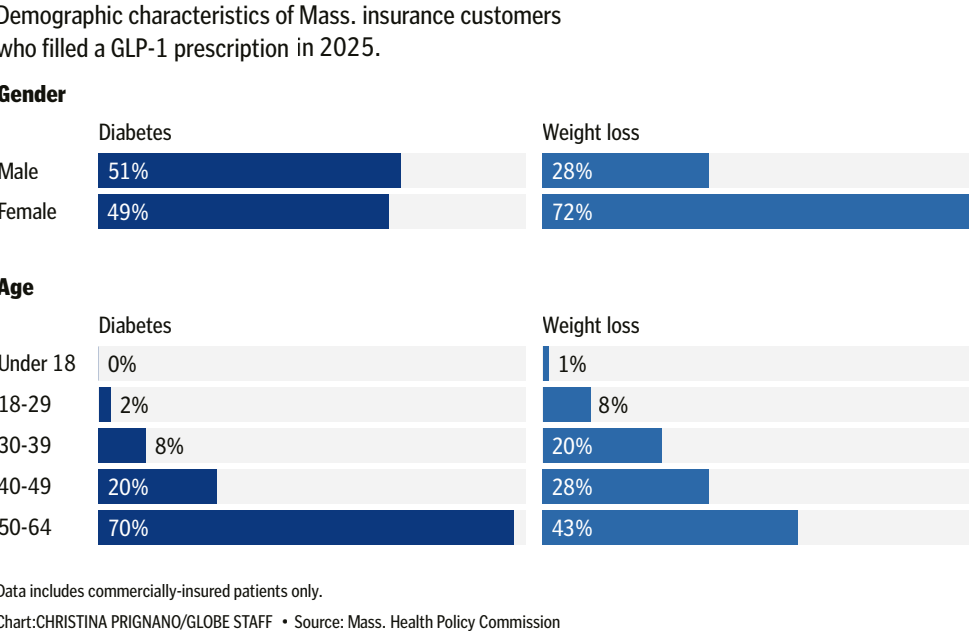
## Private insurance spending on GLP-1s for weight loss dropped after coverage changes



## Average monthly cost in 2025 for GLP-1s by cost-sharing type



## Patients on GLP-1 drugs for weight loss skew female, older



Thursday, board member Chris Leibman said he hopes to see future analysis of how much benefit these drugs offer the broader health care system.

"Health care is an investment, and purchasing these types of products and medicines and providing coverage for them is an investment," Leibman said. "There are few areas like obesity that have higher linkages to higher medical costs, premature mortality, loss of workforce."

Commercial health insurers in Massachusetts appear to have rebounded from their GLP-1 losses. Blue Cross reported operating income of \$53 million in the first half of this year, after two years of losses.

Point32Health, which owns Harvard Pilgrim and Tufts Health Plan, reported operating income of nearly \$125 million for the first half of the year, after losing \$96 million in the first half of 2025.

Those companies — the two largest commercial insurers in the state — each saw their GLP-1 use to manage obesity drop dramatically this year.

Blue Cross now pays for 3.7 percent of its members to receive the drugs to treat obesity, down from about 6 percent of members in the last quarter of 2025.

Point32Health now pays for 3.3 percent of its members' GLP-1s for that purpose, compared to 6.5 percent at the end of last year, according to the report.

Private insurers spent nearly \$1 billion on Massachusetts residents' GLP-1s for both weight loss and diabetes in 2025.

The Health Policy Commission projected that spending will fall to \$662 million for this year, closer to the \$621 million spent in 2024.

While the weight loss injectables and pills are still out-of-budget for many Massachusetts residents, buying GLP-1s directly from drug manufacturers is becoming easier — and cheaper. Telehealth companies also widely prescribe and sell people with the drugs, along with a federal government website, TrumpRx.

The GLP-1 market has changed rapidly in recent years, and will continue to evolve as new products are approved and released. At least 12 new GLP-1s are expected to launch by 2030, according to the report.

How those medications are sold will likely change as well, said Sarah Shoemaker-Hunt, deputy director of the Health Policy Commission's Office of Pharmaceutical Policy and Analysis.

"Manufacturers keep coming up with new direct-to-consumer models," Shoemaker-Hunt said. "It's constantly shifting."

Lora Pellegrini, CEO of the Massachusetts Association of Health Plans that includes insurers such as Tufts Health Plan and Mass General Brigham Health Plan, said that the decision by many insurers nationally and locally to stop covering GLP-1s for weight loss put pressure on pharmaceutical manufacturers.

"The drug companies need to lower their prices, and the fact that they did lower it for direct-to-consumer options really says something," Pellegrini said.

Jonathan Saltzman of the Globe staff contributed to this report.

Marin Wolf can be reached at [marin.wolf@globe.com](mailto:marin.wolf@globe.com).

# US, China consumers belly up for course of gastrodiploamacy

By Dee-Ann Durbin and Chan Ho-Him

ASSOCIATED PRESS

China and the United States are divided on many issues, from tariffs and technology to Taiwan. But there is one thing tying them together: fast food.

American restaurant and beverage chains are expanding rapidly in China, drawn by the potential customer pool in a country with four times the US population. China's languishing economy and cutthroat industry competition, meanwhile, have Chinese chains trying their luck in the US, turning crumbs and straws into a two-way cultural bridge between the two super-powers.

The bilateral trade in burgers and bubble tea is business- and consumer-led gastrodiploamacy in action, said Yaling Jiang, the founder of ApertureChina, a market research company with headquarters in Shanghai and London. In China, recent American arrivals of Popeyes and Five Guys are seen as a guilty pleasure, she said, while the increasingly international palates of Americans have created space for Chinese brands to serve as their nation's unofficial ambassadors.

“Consumerism builds a safe, introductory channel for contemporary Chinese culture and can be a great way to elevate China's soft power,” Jiang said.

The White House has not revealed the menu for the state dinner that President Trump is hosting for Chinese President Xi Jinping on Thursday. But a taste for a cheap, crowd-pleasing meal may be something the two leaders share.

In 2013, Xi made a rare public visit to a steamed-bun restaurant in Beijing. He waited in line and ordered a 21-yuan (\$3) meal featuring six pork-and-scallion buns, vegetables, and a bowl of stewed pork liver and intestines. Trump's love of fast food is legendary; he even manned a fry station at a Pennsylvania McDonald's during his 2024 campaign.

Last month, Chinese customers lined up in the rain for the opening of the first Church's Texas Chicken in Shanghai. Church's plans at least 600 more across China.

Wendy's says it anticipates opening 1,000 restaurants there over the next decade.

Established players are deep-



MARK AVERY/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

A Chinese woman wiped a statue of Colonel Sanders, founder of KFC, in front of the restaurant in Beijing in May 1991.

ening their reach as well. McDonald's plans 1,000 more Chinese restaurants this year and 10,000 total by 2028. Burger King, which arrived in China in 2005, says it expects to triple its store count to 4,000 by 2035.

“Despite political tensions between the US and China, Chinese actually still go crazy for American brands,” said Shaun Rein, founder and managing director of the Shanghai-based China Market Research Group.

KFC became the first major American fast-food chain to enter mainland China when it opened a Beijing restaurant in 1987. At the time, it was viewed as a premium destination worth taking a date to, Rein said. McDonald's and Pizza Hut arrived in 1990.

“McDonald's and KFC were a beacon of health and hygiene compared to what you had in the rest of the market,” Rein said.

China is now KFC's largest market by far. The Kentucky-born fried chicken chain counts about 13,000 restaurants in China, compared with around 3,750 in the US.

American brands see room for further growth.

Much of China's population lives in the smaller, inland cities where brands such as McDonald's and Starbucks are rolling out stores, said Sory Park, a project manager at China-focused market research and strategy firm Daxue Consulting.

That doesn't make China a cakewalk for foreign restaurant companies. Most American chains now rely on Chinese partners to find locations and share the financial risk. Earlier this year, a Chinese investment firm acquired a 60 percent stake in

Starbucks's China operation after several years of falling store traffic.

Meanwhile, Chinese fast-food chains are seeking new opportunities in the US.

Mixue, one of the world's largest fast-food chains with more than 53,000 locations, opened its first three US stores in December. Mirroring the Shanghai crowd outside Church's Texas Chicken, New York customers waited in the cold to sample soft-serve ice cream, fruit teas, and milk tea with toppings like coconut jelly and taro balls at a store in Herald Square.

Mixue has announced at least two dozen more planned locations across four states. At least nine other mainland Chinese chains have made their US debuts since 2023, all but one specializing primarily in drinks and snacks. They include Heytea, with 40 US locations, and Luck-in Coffee, which overtook Starbucks as China's biggest coffee brand and has 20 stores in New York.

Wallace, a chain founded in 2000, grew to more than 20,000 restaurants by selling American-style chicken and hamburgers in China. In California, where the second US Wallace opened last month, the company tweaked its chicken sandwich recipe to appeal to American diners.

Before entering the US, many major Chinese food-and-beverage chains expanded in Southeast Asia. A real estate slump and weak consumer spending made growth harder to find at home. The average life span of China's 16 million restaurants and chains was expected to fall to 15 months last year, according to a US government report.



boston.com/classifieds

## LEGAL NOTICES

BOSTON HOUSING AUTHORITY  
REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS  
Boston Housing Accelerator Fund Construction Lending and Investment Opportunities  
BHA Job No.: 2463-01

The Boston Housing Authority (BHA) is furthering our mission to build and support healthy, sustainable communities by embarking on a new effort to spur housing production through publicly backed social lending and investment. The Housing Accelerator Fund, a project in collaboration with the City of Boston, was established to invest in the creation of mixed-income housing. The Fund supports three distinct types of projects: mixed-income rental projects (privately owned), mixed-income rental projects (publicly owned), and mixed-income homeownership projects. In order to unlock construction, the BHA will make available various products to facilitate reduced borrowing costs for construction and development firms.

The Boston Housing Authority (BHA) is currently seeking proposals from firms seeking construction loans or investments by the BHA. The BHA anticipates making available up to \$35M for this purpose in its initial offering at competitive rates. The BHA reserves the right to negotiate loan or investment amount, rate, term or duration for compelling projects and to roll construction lending and investment into a permanent loan or investment product.

**Inquiries Deadline:** Inquiries or requests for modification to any provision of this RFP must be submitted by 2:00 PM on September 28, 2026 (the "Inquiry Deadline") via email to bids@bostonhousing.org.

**Proposal Deadline:** Proposers responding to this RFP shall submit one (1) original and four (4) copies of their Proposal no later than 2:00 PM on Friday, October 23, 2026 (the "Proposal Deadline") by mail or hand delivery to:

Director of Procurement  
Boston Housing Authority  
52 Chauncy Street, 6th floor  
Boston, MA 02111

Each proposal shall be in a sealed envelope marked with the Proposer's name, address, and telephone number. In addition to the five hard copies of the proposal, Proposers shall provide one (1) electronic copy of their proposal on USB media. This submission should be in Adobe PDF format. Proposers shall submit the fee and non-fee portions of their proposal under separate cover as follows:

1. One envelope shall be marked "BHA Job No 2463-01 Technical Proposal for Accelerator Fund Construction Lending".  
2. The second envelope shall be marked "BHA Job No 2463-01 Fee Proposal for Accelerator Fund Construction Lending".  
Details and requirements are described in the RFP. To obtain a copy of the RFP, please go to <https://www.bostonhousing.org/en/bid-Opportunities/Current-Bid-Opportunities.aspx>.

## LEGAL NOTICES

ADVERTISMENT FOR BIDS  
NEW GARDEN PARK, INC.  
REDEVELOPMENT OF C STREET AND INSTALLATION OF UTILITIES  
WORCESTER, MA 01606

Sealed bids for the Redevelopment of C Street and Installation of Utilities will be received by New Garden Park, Inc. (NGP), 89 Shrewsbury Street, Worcester, Massachusetts 01604, until 4:00 PM, Wednesday, October 21, 2026. Work includes redevelopment and upgrade of the existing roadway network and associated public and private utilities. Contract Plans, specifications, and proposal forms are available at <https://www.thewbdc.com/new-garden-park>. For technical questions, please contact Bids@worcesterbdc.com. Each bid shall include a 5% proposal guarantee, payable to NGP in the form of cash, or bid bond, or certified check, or a treasurer's or cashier's check issued by a responsible banking institution. This guarantee will become the property of NGP if the bidder fails to execute the contract and satisfactory bond within 10 days of contract award. The successful bidder shall furnish a 100% Performance Bond and Payment Bond from a surety listed in U.S. Treasury Circular 570. The Contractor shall comply with all applicable federal, state, and local requirements, including M.G.L., c. 149, §§ 26-27H, Massachusetts prevailing wage requirements, the Federal Davis-Bacon Wage Act, workers' compensation, applicable veteran/resident hiring preferences, Executive Order 11246, M.G.L. c. 149, §§ 26-37, the Federal Equal Employment Opportunity Act, as well as goals for women and minority employment. Certified weekly payrollable to New Garden Park, Inc. and the Office of the Attorney General, pursuant to an advisory dated April 8, 1994, shall be submitted as required. The Contractor shall furnish labor, materials, facilities, equipment, services, employee training and personnel testing, permits and agreements necessary to complete the scope of work. Required OSHA training shall be completed by all applicable personnel. Insurance and OSHA training documentation shall be provided as required by the contract documents. Permanent products installed must comply with Build America, Buy America (BABA) requirements under the infrastructure investment and jobs Act, as applicable. This project is partially funded by the U.S. Department of Commerce, Economic Development Administration (EDA), including \$2,596,888 in federal funding toward project costs. Neither the United States nor any federal department, agency, or employee is a party to this advertisement or any resulting contract.

A pre-bid conference will be held at 11:00 AM, Monday, October 5, 2026 at 351 Stores Street, Worcester, MA 01606. Attendance is not mandatory but highly encouraged. All bids shall be submitted in accordance with all applicable Federal, State, and Local procurement requirements. NGP reserves the right to reject any or all proposals, waive informalities in the bidding procedure, and accept the proposal deemed best for NGP. The successful bidder shall commence work within 7 calendar days following contract acceptance by NGP.



## notices & more

Per MGL c 30B §6, Brookline Housing Authority is seeking a development consultant to close out the construction period and complete the conversion to permanent financing for its 32 Marion project. To obtain a copy of the RFP email [ayoungstrom@brooklinehousing.org](mailto:ayoungstrom@brooklinehousing.org).

## LEGAL NOTICES

City of Watertown Administration Building  
149 Main Street,  
Watertown, Massachusetts 02472

### Conservation Commission

**LEGAL NOTICE**  
Pursuant to the provisions of Massachusetts Wetlands Protection Act (G.L. ch. 131, § 40) and the Watertown Wetlands Ordinance, the Watertown Conservation Commission will hold a public hearing on **October 7, 2026, at 7 p.m.** on the Notice of Intent submitted for 580 Mount Auburn Street, Cambridge, MA 02138 for the proposed ecological restoration of Willow Pond within the State jurisdictional 100 foot Buffer Zone, local 150 foot Buffer Zone and other associated resource areas including Inland Bank, Bordering Vegetated Wetland, and Land Under Waterbodies and Waterways. Confirm meeting link on the agenda 48 hours before the scheduled meeting.  
Applicant: Ronnit Bendavid-Vai, 580 Mt. Auburn Street, Cambridge, MA 02138

Representative: Naomi Valentine, SWCA Environmental Consultants, Inc., 15 Waterbodies Drive, Amherst, MA 01002

The Notice of Intent application is available by contacting the Conservation Commission Office, Parker School Building, 124 Watertown Street, Watertown, MA by contacting Katherine Swan, Conservation Agent, or by contacting Naomi Valentine, SWCA Environmental Consultants, Inc.

This notice can also be found on the Massachusetts Newspaper Publishers Association website at <http://www.masspublicnotices.org/>

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# find it

**Boston**  
MAGAZINE

# Greater Boston's Private Schools

Explore *Boston* magazine's trusted recommendations for the region's leading professionals and services.



# Black lawmakers seek action to prevent AI discrimination

►AI  
*Continued from Page D1*  
rights and safety.”

Other Black lawmakers also have sought action on AI. New Jersey Democratic Representative LaMonica McIver has filed a bill that would set federal standards for transparency when developers seek permission to build massive AI data centers.

Democratic Senator Cory Booker of New Jersey has taken a more positive approach to AI. In February he filed legislation to award prizes of \$1 million or more to individuals or businesses that use AI to solve hard problems in medicine, manufacturing, or other technical fields.

But last Thursday, just seven months later, Booker urged President Trump to call a special session of Congress to enact AI safety laws.

“The safety of artificial intelligence systems demands urgent attention,” Booker said. “This is not a moment for panic or despair. It is a moment for government to govern.”

To date, little of the Black Caucus's advocacy has resulted in legislative action. The group is a powerful part of the Democratic coalition but has considerably less sway during periods of Republican control.

Clarke said AI reform bills would be much further along if Congress was under Democratic control. “The Democrats have been really leading the way in this space,” she said. “We’re just not in the majority to be able to put anything into motion.”

GOP congressional leadership hasn’t been in a hurry to tackle AI.

While Booker called for a special session on the matter, GOP House Speaker Mike Johnson has adjourned the House early, and it won’t resume work until after the November midterm elections.

While Republican lawmakers haven’t been silent on AI, they have usually favored modest reforms, in keeping with the party’s free-market principles.

The most dramatic GOP-backed idea is a law requiring that advanced AI systems include a “kill switch” so the federal government could order an immediate shutdown in an emergency. A bipartisan kill switch bill was introduced in the House in July, and GOP Senator John Kennedy of Louisiana has said he will introduce a similar bill in the Senate.

Another GOP bill would require electric utilities to ensure that AI data centers would pay the full cost of necessary upgrades to the electrical grid — and not put those costs on consumers.

Outside of Congress, The NAACP’s “Stop Dirty Data Centers” campaign has challenged projects in Memphis; Bessemer, Ala.; Fort Wayne, Ind.; Southaven, Miss.; and Prince George’s County, Md.

While many at the Washington AI conference fretted over the prospect that smart machines might someday wipe out the human race, Clarke is more worried about the harms that today’s AI might cause to Black and low-income people.

“There are certain populations that’s far more vulnerable in different spaces to what these

machine-driven models can do,” she said, “whether it’s discriminating against who gets a job and who doesn’t. Whether it’s discriminating against who gets a mortgage and who doesn’t.”

This makes perfect sense to computer scientist Timnit Gebru, cofounder of Black in AI, who thinks talk of genocidal AI systems is a distraction ginned up by the AI companies.

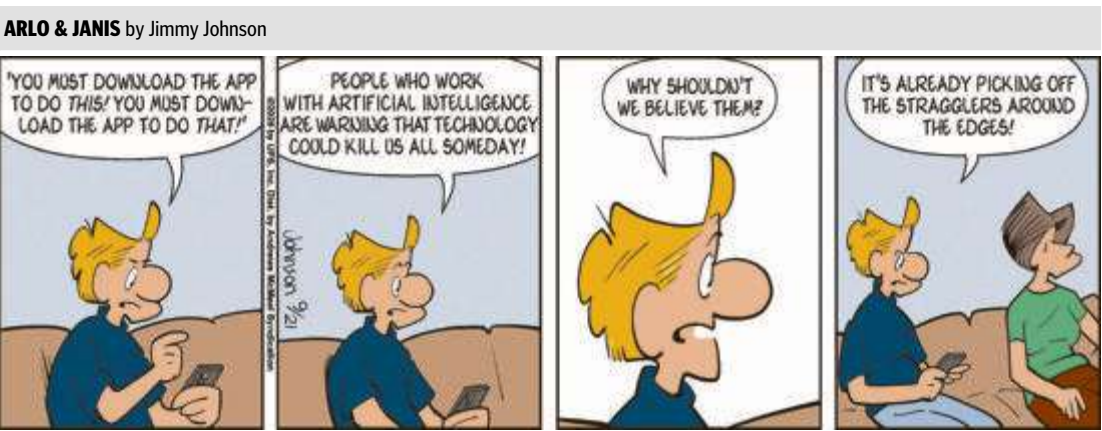
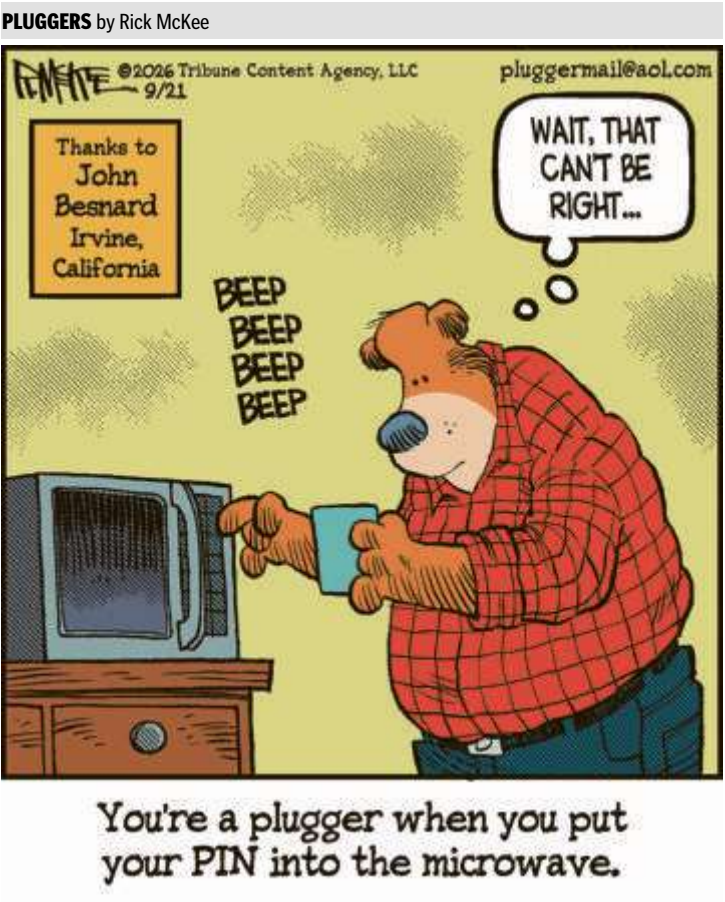
“When you talk about specific issues affecting Black people, they tell you ‘Oh, but that’s not big enough to discuss,’” Gebru said, “because we have bigger issues, like AI can kill every single human being in the world. So why are you talking about racism and discrimination?”

While an AI apocalypse is a risk, Gebru said AI systems are already harming people today.

“I’ve been talking about facial recognition being used to over-criminalize and over-police people,” she said. “I’ve been talking about discriminatory algorithms used in hiring, used in health care. I’ve been talking about large language models that have outputs that are racist ... but right now that’s not on the news because the news is about some fictional super intelligent being supposedly rendering every single person extinct.”

For Gebru, the legislation proposed by lawmakers like Clarke and Pressley focuses on what really matters — making sure that existing AI systems are safe and fair.

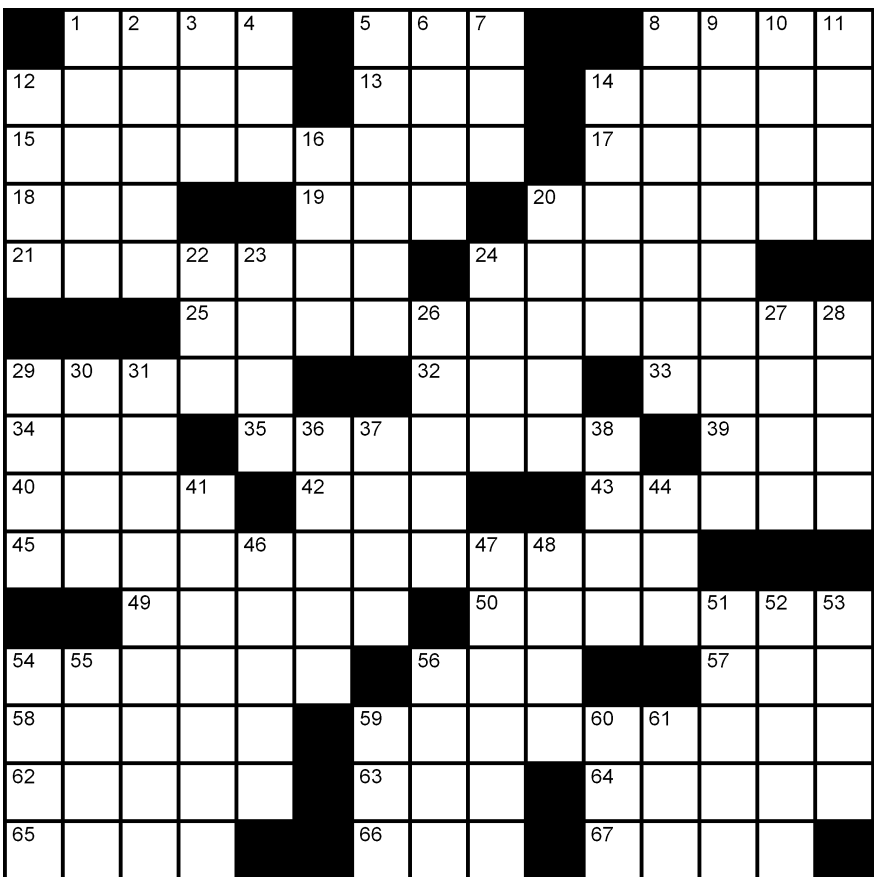
*Hiawatha Bray can be reached at [hiawatha.bray@globe.com](mailto:hiawatha.bray@globe.com). Follow him @GlobeTechLab.*



## UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD PUZZLE

ABCS OF MAGIC BY FREDERICK LAVOIE | EDITED BY DAVID STEINBERG

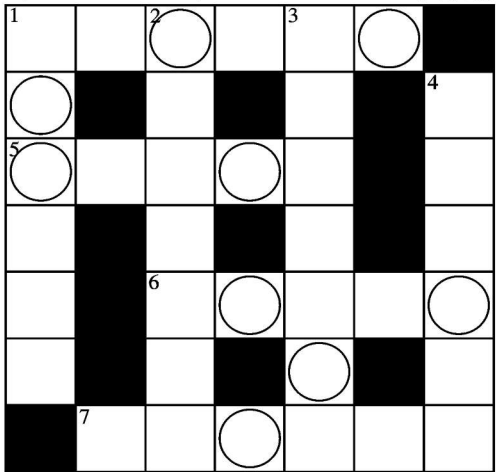
- ACROSS**
- Look toward
  - Brief dispute
  - Impressive variety
  - \_\_\_ cream truck
  - Amplify on social media
  - \*Tower of London guardian
  - Roughly
  - Eponymous 10-year-old superhero
  - "ARIRANG" K-pop group
  - Thirds of quarters
  - "Generally speaking ..."
  - Like this clue: Verbose and not at all laconic
  - \*Comedic free-for-all
  - Referenced
  - "Roughly"
  - "Prince of Soul" Marvin
  - Memento from an old flame?
  - \*Porridge base
  - UFC combat sport
  - Sound of a high five
  - Christopher who played Saruman
  - Autonomous software system
  - \*Supremely decorated female swimmer
  - Beats without help, in gaming
  - Grannies, in Georgia
  - Crunchy bit in a brownie
  - Sports injury letters
- DOWN**
- Liberates
  - The Colosseum, for example
  - "Half" of some coffee orders
  - Pupil's place
  - Hand warmer
  - Solitaire starters
  - According to
  - Lively bash
  - Apples to Apples or Wavelength
  - Curved doorway
  - Drinks served with scones
  - Band that reunited for "Voyage"
  - Indignant dislike
  - Like one who can
  - Latte's chocolaty relative
  - Fish eggs
  - Top-heavy hairstyle
  - Sage
  - Went through the motions?



- 27 Religious song  
28 Spot for a suckling pig  
29 Literary container for amontillado  
30 Stop on a Spanish cruise  
31 "Them's the breaks"  
36 Divvy up
- 37 Most tie-dye shirts  
38 Ontario or Tahoe  
41 Trailblazing figure  
44 Place to pump iron  
46 Avoid capture by  
47 Event hosts  
48 Portable phone  
51 Roughly  
52 Put pen to paper
- 53 See 67-Across  
54 Sailboat "fuel"  
55 Succulent known for its gel  
56 Small plates, for short  
59 "Me day" milieu  
60 Pull far ahead of in a race  
61 Ancient date abbr.

## JUMBLE CROSSWORDS™

by David L. Hoyt 9-21-26



### CLUE ACROSS ANSWER

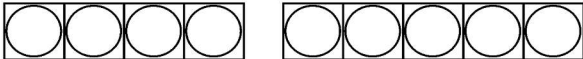
1. New \_\_\_  
5. \_\_\_ pedal  
6. Hockey no-no  
7. Candice \_\_\_
- ANSWER**
- EUGAN  
EBKRA  
NICIG  
RNEEBG

### CLUE DOWN ANSWER

1. Fancy drinking glass  
2. Picture  
3. Monday \_\_\_  
4. Motto
- ANSWER**
- GTBELO  
MEIGAIN  
NVEGEIN  
SNGALO

**CLUE:** It's a strong swimmer and often found near water.

### BONUS



### How to play

Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.

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ANSWERS: 1A-Guinea 3D-Evening 3D-Evening 4D-Slogan 7A-Bergen 1D-Globet 2D-Image 3D-Evening 4D-Slogan 7A-Bergen  
Send comments to DLHoyt@HoytInteractiveMedia.com



## TV CRITIC'S CORNER

BY LISA WEIDENFELD

From left: Taylor Bloom as Russ Hollingsworth, Tommy O'Brien as Mike Jr. "Micah" Hollingsworth, Kat Cunning as Clare Hollingsworth, Hope Davis as Jane Hollingsworth, Peter Krause as Mike Hollingsworth in "Line of Fire."



SPENCER PAZER/NBC

## New and streaming TV: Peter Krause, Hope Davis in 'Line of Fire,' Jasmine Guy in 'A Different World'

Thank you to the many kind readers who wrote after I asked for your thoughts on "Reacher" last week. I really enjoyed reading them, and I'm going to add it to my (admittedly long) to-watch list.

Many families are in the same line of work, whether it's acting, or running a restaurant or a crime syndicate. In "Line of Fire," out Monday at 10 p.m. on NBC, the whole family works in law enforcement, from dad Peter Krause and mom Hope Davis down to their daughter and two sons. After a killer targets members of law enforcement, the family has to pool their collected expertise across various parts of the federal government to figure out what happened.

If you didn't catch the dawdling end to the Emmy ceremony last week, you might have missed that the show ran a few minutes short, and actors Matthew McConaughey and Woody Harrelson were asked to riff for a few minutes before announcing the final award. The resulting banter was more than a bit strained, but the TV show they tried to promote was "Brothers," out Wednesday on Apple TV. The show is a fictionalized docuseries, in which the two actors, playing themselves, learn they might actually be brothers. Expect Hollywood satire, and a number of celebs looking to lightly spoof themselves.

Ali Hazelwood's romance novel "The Love Hypothesis" began its life as Reylo fanfiction — that is, an imagined romance between the "Star Wars" characters Rey and Kylo Ren. But from those beginnings, it has now become a Prime Video movie, out Wednesday, starring Lili Reinhart of "Riverdale" and Tom Bateman of "Death on the Nile" and "Murder on the Orient Express." They're both scientists who decide to pretend to date, each for reasons of their own, only to discover that spending a lot of time with a good-lucking peer may help you find them attractive.

The 13th season of Ryan Murphy's "American Horror Story" arrives Thursday at 9 p.m. on FX and Hulu. Murphy's developed quite the stable of actors to appear across the seasons of the show; prepare for regulars Jessica Lange, Emma Roberts, Angela Bassett, Billie Lourd, and Evan Peters to return, as well as the unofficial (maybe official at this point) queen of the Murphy-verse, Sarah Paulson. John Waters is also on hand to comment drolly on the proceedings, and Paul Anthony Kelly, who made his debut in the moderately less gory "American Love Story" side of the Murphyverse as JFK Jr., here turns to the horror franchise.

The 1990s young adult comedy gets the reboot treatment in "A Different World," out Thursday on Netflix. The new series focuses on Deborah Wayne (Maleah Joi Moon), the daughter of original characters Dwayne (Kadeem Hardison) and Whitley (Jasmine Guy), as she attends Hillman College, as her parents did. The original series was a spinoff of "The Cosby Show" and aired from 1987-93, and if you're picturing Dwayne's awesome flip-up glasses right now, the sequel series may be for you. Hillman is a fictional HBCU, and Boston native Guy and Hardison are both set to return (and if you're on a Hardison kick, check out his prematurely canceled "Teenage Bounty Hunters" on Netflix. It's unusual and good, and got totally lost in 2020).

The new Netflix movie "Unabomber," out Friday, explores Ted Kaczynski's time at Harvard, where he took part in controversial psychological experiments. Jacob Tremblay plays the young Kaczynski, Russell Crowe plays Henry Murray, the Harvard researcher, and Shailene Woodley plays an FBI agent years later who begins to look into Kaczynski's Harvard years.

Lisa Weidenfeld can be reached at [lisa.weidenfeld@globe.com](mailto:lisa.weidenfeld@globe.com).

## ASKING ERIC

## Husband's poor hygiene mars otherwise great marriage

**Q.** My husband and I have been married for 30-plus years. He's a great guy in most aspects, except for his hygiene. He doesn't brush his teeth enough, he doesn't take enough showers, he doesn't use deodorant.

For some reason he has taken to wearing hoodies even when it's warm out contributing even more to this "smelly" issue. His hands are even sticky when I try holding his hand.

I say something every so often, but he accuses me of criticizing him too much. This has caused a cessation of intimate feelings from my end as you might well understand.

Please advise me as to what to do about this "sticky" situation.

NOT SO SMELLY SPOUSE

**A.** While there is room in many relationships for slight differences in personal hygiene preferences, your husband's habits are more extreme, at least from your description.

Setting aside the danger he could be putting himself in, health-wise (the lack of dental care is especially concerning), this isn't something you simply have to accept about him.

There may be underlying issues or traumas that cause him to neglect personal hygiene practices. He doesn't have to just live with this, if he doesn't want to. Wearing the hoodie in all temperatures, for instance, suggests there could be something else going on, but he has to want to look into it. You can encourage it but if he's not open to feedback, you may not be able to make him get help.

However, as with any other point of contention in your relationship, he needs to hear what you're communicating and communicate effectively back to you. He's free to do what he wants with his body, of course. But his choice is impacting you and your marriage, and it behooves you both to find common ground.

Talk to him again using this framing. You can acknowledge his bodily autonomy and tell him that you're not trying to criticize him but rather you need his help with this issue that you share.

You might point out that you've wanted to express intimacy physically but have been unable to and ask if he's noticed that. Then have a conversation about what you can both do to reach each other again.

The benefit of this kind of conversation is that it de-personalizes the issue a little bit, which is helpful in the short term. Also, it can show you areas where you're not communicating well, which can help in the long term. Lastly, it invites

you both to think creatively.

There is more here that's on his side of the street, but by sharing your experience you invite him to at least meet you in the middle.

**Q.** Recently a friend of mine sent me a clipping of an obituary of my ex's father. We divorced a long time ago and I am now happily married. However, my ex cheated on me, which she admitted to after we were divorced.

Now I keep having visuals of her cheating in the back seat of her car while I waited on her to get back from nursing class. This happened many years ago but seeing her father's obituary triggered these unpleasant memories. What to do?

BAD MEMORIES

**A.** It's unpleasant but not uncommon for the vestiges of old traumas to float back up to the top of our minds unbidden, especially when triggered by something like the obituary.

You might feel the impulse to resist them as a way of getting them to go away. But it's possible that that resistance is the thing that keeps these mental images coming back.

There may be something still unresolved for you about the dissolution of your relationship and your ex's cheating. This would make sense; it was an awful betrayal and likely created shockwaves throughout your life.

There may also be a question lingering about what you're supposed to do with the information about your ex's father. An empathic impulse may want to send condolences, even as the rest of you suspects that maintaining the distance you have is the best option.

It may be healthiest, then, to acknowledge that there is old grief and new grief intermingling. Something as simple as saying to yourself, "I wish what happened hadn't happened; it changed me; this new information makes me sad but there's nothing I can do about it" may take some of the power out of these memories. It may even be helpful for you to mentally wish your ex peace, wherever she is and whatever she's going through. This doesn't mean condoning what she did in the past; it's just releasing her and these new mental images.

Unpleasant thoughts are sometimes a part of our brain asking for attention, but we can determine what kind of attention to give.

R. Eric Thomas can be reached at [eric@askingeric.com](mailto:eric@askingeric.com).

## Monday September 21, 2026

Movies Sports

|    | 7 pm                                            | 7:30          | 8 pm                                                                                 | 8:30        | 9 pm                                                   | 9:30      | 10 pm                             | 10:30       | 11 pm                     | 11:30               |
|----|-------------------------------------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------------------------------|-------------|---------------------------|---------------------|
| 2  | WGBH PBS<br>BBC News                            | R. Steves     | Antiques Roadshow (N)                                                                |             | New York: A Documentary Film "Shadows of the Past" (N) |           |                                   |             | Amanpour and Company (N)  |                     |
| 4  | WBZ CBS<br>Wheel (N)                            | Jeopardy! (N) | FBI "3 Up, 3 Down"                                                                   |             | CIA "Forbidden Eye"                                    |           | FBI "Shahadah"                    |             | News (N)                  | (:35) Comics        |
| 5  | WCVB ABC<br>News (N)                            | Chronicle     | Kickoff (N) (Live) (:15) NFL Football New York Giants at Los Angeles Rams (N) (Live) |             |                                                        |           |                                   |             | (:15) News (N)            | (:50) J. Kimmel     |
| 6  | WLNE ABC<br>Videos                              |               | Whose                                                                                | Whose       | Whose                                                  | Whose     | Saturday Night Live               |             | Saturday Night Live       |                     |
| 7  | WHDH<br>Inside (N)                              | Extra (N)     | Family Feud                                                                          | Family Feud | 7 News at 9PM (N)                                      |           | 7 News at 10PM (N)                |             | 7 News at 11PM (N)        | Inside              |
| 9  | WMUR ABC<br>Chronicle                           | News (N)      | Kickoff (:15) Football New York Giants at Los Angeles Rams                           |             |                                                        |           |                                   |             | (:15) News                | J.Kimmel            |
| 10 | NBC Boston<br>NBC 10 Boston News at 7pm (N)     |               | The Voice "The Blind Auditions Season Premiere" (N) (SP)                             |             |                                                        |           | Line of Fire "Pilot" (N) (P)      |             | Boston News (N)           | (:35) J. Fallon (N) |
| 10 | WJAR NBC<br>News (Live)                         | Extra (N)     | The Voice "The Blind Auditions Season Premiere" (N) (SP)                             |             |                                                        |           | Line of Fire "Pilot" (N) (P)      |             | News (N)                  | (:35) J. Fallon (N) |
| 11 | WENH PBS<br>Week-ends                           | Rosendo       | Antiques Roadshow (N)                                                                |             | New York: A Documentary Film "Shadows of the Past" (N) |           |                                   |             | Amanpour and Company (N)  |                     |
| 12 | WPRI CBS<br>Wheel (N)                           | Jeopardy! (N) | FBI "3 Up, 3 Down"                                                                   |             | CIA "Forbidden Eye"                                    |           | FBI "Shahadah"                    |             | 12 News at 11 (N)         | (:35) Comics        |
| 25 | WFXT FOX<br>ET (N)                              | TMZ (N)       | Name That Tune Ice-T (N) (SP)                                                        |             | The Weakest Link Omarosa Manigault                     |           | Boston 25 News at 10PM (N) (Live) |             | News (Live)               | MLS Soccer          |
| 27 | WUNI<br>Rosa "Mi amigo Teo" (N)                 |               | Tan cerca "Secretos sin retorno" (N)                                                 |             | Tierra de amor y "El enemigo cerca" (N)                |           | Corazón de oro (N)                |             | Noticias Univisión        | (:35) Noticiero     |
| 36 | WSBE PBS<br>R. Steves                           | Week-ends     | Nature                                                                               |             | Martin Clunes: Islands of America                      |           | TURN: Washington's Spies          |             | PBS News Hour             |                     |
| 38 | WSBK<br>Big Bang                                | Big Bang      | WBZ News 8p (N)                                                                      |             | Phantom Gourmet                                        | Jeopardy! | Perfect (N)                       | Perfect (N) | Flip Side (N)             | Flip Side (N)       |
| 44 | WGBX PBS<br>Test Kitchen                        | Antiques      | Midsomer "Bad Tidings: Part 1"                                                       |             | Foyle's War "The Russian House"                        |           | Antiques                          |             | PBS News Hour (N)         |                     |
| 50 | WWJE<br>Murder USA                              |               | Heartland Homicide                                                                   |             | Killer Cases                                           |           | Crime Stories                     |             | Unusual Suspects          |                     |
| 56 | WLVI CW<br>Young Sheldon                        | Young Sheldon | All American "Finish Line" (N)                                                       |             | Penn "Magic Socks Big Time"                            |           | 7 News at 10PM on CW56 (N)        |             | Modern Family             | Modern Family       |
| 64 | WNAC FOX<br>Family Feud                         | Family Feud   | Name That Tune Ice-T (N) (SP)                                                        |             | The Weakest Link Omarosa Manigault                     |           | 12 News on Fox Pr (N)             |             | Seinfeld                  | Seinfeld            |
| 68 | WBXP ION<br>(:55) Chicago P.D. "Buried Secrets" |               | Chicago "Silence of the Night"                                                       |             | Chicago P.D. "Fighting Ghosts"                         |           | Chicago P.D. "White Knuckle"      |             | Chicago P.D. "Tender Age" |                     |

## PREMIUM CABLE

|               |                                                                     |                                                                                |                                                                                            |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cinemax       | (5:50) ★★ Magnolia ('99) Julianne Moore, Tom Cruise, Jason Robards. | (:55) ★★ The Last Samurai ('03) Ken Watanabe, Timothy Spall, Tom Cruise.       | Cleaner ('25)                                                                              |
| Flix          | (6:25) ★★ Rumpelstiltskin                                           | ★ ★ Piranha ('10) Steven R McQueen, Elisabeth Shue.                            | (:25) Bodygua...                                                                           |
| HBO           | Youth (:25) Youth                                                   | Earth, Wind & Fire (To Be Celestial vs. That's the Weight of the World) ('26)  | ★ ★ ★ Game Night ('18) Rachel McAdams, Jason Bateman.                                      |
| HBO 2         | (6:40) Lanterns                                                     | (:35) ★★ Fuze ('25) Theo James, Aaron Taylor-Johnson.                          | (:10) Jay-Z in 8 (:55) Jay-Z in 8 ★ ★ ★ Zombieland ('09) Jesse Eisenberg, Woody Harrelson. |
| Paramount-Sho | (6:00) ★★ Homestead ('24)                                           | Lioness (N)                                                                    | MobLand "I Wanna Be Your Dog" (N)                                                          |
| Showtime 2    | (6:15) ★★ Tommy Boy ('95)                                           | ★ ★ ★ My Cousin Vinny (1992) Marisa Tomei, Ralph Macchio, Joe Pesci.           | You're Dating a Narcissist! ('25) Marisa Tomei.                                            |
| Starz!        | ★ ★ John Q ('02) Robert Duvall, James Woods, Denzel Washington.     | Outlander: Blood of my Blood                                                   | (:05) Dreams ('25) Isaac Hernández, Jessica Chastain.                                      |
| TMC           | (5:40) ★★ Shutter Island ('10)                                      | ★ ★ ★ Out of the Furnace ('13) Woody Harrelson, Casey Affleck, Christian Bale. | ★ ★ Faster ('10) Billy Bob Thornton, Dwayne Johnson.                                       |

## SPORTS

|              |                                                      |                                                                                                               |             |                      |                          |                                         |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|----------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| CBSSN        | Course Record With Michael Breed (N)                 | Golf (N)                                                                                                      | Club Life   | My World With (N)    | Poker Night (N)          | Athletes Unlimited Pro Softball         |
| ESPN         | (6:00) Monday Night (Live)                           | Kickoff (N) (Live) (:15) NFL Football New York Giants at Los Angeles Rams (N) (Live)                          |             |                      |                          | (:15) Monday SportsC. (Live)            |
| ESPN2        | SportsCenter                                         | Kickoff (N) (:15) Football Monday Night Football with Peyton and Eli: New York Giants at Los Angeles Rams (N) |             |                      |                          | (:15) Monday 30 for 30                  |
| Fox Sports 1 | (6:30) Suárez                                        | NHRA Drag Racing Great Lakes Nationals Coverage of drag racing action from the National Hot Rod Association.  |             |                      |                          | All (N) SPEED With Harvick & Buxton (N) |
| Golf         | DP World Tour Golf BMW PGA Championship, Final Round |                                                                                                               |             |                      |                          | PGA Tour PGA Tour Live from the         |
| NBA          | WNBA                                                 | Stories                                                                                                       | Stories     | NBA Playback         |                          | WNBA Playback                           |
| NBC Sports   | (6:30) Early Edition                                 | The Break                                                                                                     | The Break   | The Break            | Boston Sports (N) (Live) | Boston Sports                           |
| NESN         | David Ortiz                                          | The David Ortiz Era                                                                                           | David Ortiz | Red Sox: On This Day |                          |                                         |

## FAMILY

|               |                            |                               |                  |                  |           |                  |                  |                               |           |           |
|---------------|----------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------|------------------|-----------|------------------|------------------|-------------------------------|-----------|-----------|
| Cartoon       | Burgers                    | Burgers                       | Burgers          | FamilyGuy        | FamilyGuy | FamilyGuy        | FamilyGuy        | FamilyGuy                     | RickMorty | RickMorty |
| Disney        | Big City Greens            | Big City Greens               | Phineas and Ferb | Phineas and Ferb | Vampirina | Phineas and Ferb | Phineas and Ferb | Kiff                          | Ladybug   | Ladybug   |
| Encore Family | (6:40) A.R.C.H.I.E. 2: ... | (:05) ★★ Instant Family ('18) |                  |                  |           |                  |                  | (:05) Lena and Snowball ('21) |           | Movie     |
| Nickelodeon   | Friends                    | Friends                       | Friends          | Friends          | Friends   | Friends          | Friends          | Big Bang                      | Big Bang  | Big Bang  |
| Nick Jr.      | PAWPatr..                  | PAWPatr..                     | PAWPatr..        | PAWPatr..        | Peppa Pig | Peppa Pig        | Peppa Pig        | Peppa Pig                     | PAWPatr.. | PAWPatr.. |

Content Ratings: TV-Y Appropriate for all children; TV-Y7 For children age 7 and older; TV-G General audience; TV-PG Parental guidance suggested; TV-14 May be unsuitable for children under 14;

TV-MA Mature audience only Additional symbols: D Suggestive dialogue; FV Fantasy violence; L Strong language; S Sexual activity; V Violence; HD High-Definition; (CC) Close-Captioned

News Specials

|                     | 7 pm                                                                        | 7:30                                              | 8 pm                                                        | 8:30             | 9 pm                                               | 9:30          | 10 pm                                                      | 10:30         | 11 pm                               | 11:30           |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------|-----------------|
|                     | BASIC CABLE                                                                 |                                                   |                                                             |                  |                                                    |               |                                                            |               |                                     |                 |
| A&E                 | Live PD: Greatest Shifts "Episode 37"                                       |                                                   | Live PD: Greatest Shifts "Episode 33"                       |                  | Live PD: Great. "Episode 38" (N)                   |               | Live PD: Great. "Episode 39" (N)                           |               | (:05) Live PD: Great. "Episode 36"  |                 |
| AMC                 | (6:00) ★★ Jack Reacher ('12) Tom Cruise.                                    |                                                   | ★ ★ Man on Fire ('04) Dakota Fanning, Denzel Washington.    |                  |                                                    |               |                                                            |               |                                     |                 |
| Animal Planet       | Alaskan "Now or Never"                                                      |                                                   | Alaskan "A Wolfpack Divided"                                |                  | Alaskan "Rise of Browntown"                        |               | Alaskan "Divide and Conquer"                               |               | Alaskan Bush People "Bloodlines"    |                 |
| BBC America         | (5:30) ★★ Tombstone ('93)                                                   |                                                   | ★ ★ The Patriot Heath Ledger, Joely Richardson, Mel Gibson. |                  |                                                    |               |                                                            |               |                                     |                 |
| BET                 | Celebrity Kathie Lee Gifford, Ricki Lake                                    |                                                   | (:10) Celebrity Fam. Joel McHale                            |                  | (:20) Celebrity Family Feud Macklemore, Lil Yachty |               | Martin                                                     | Martin        | Martin                              |                 |
| Bravo               | Below Deck "Chips on the Shoulders"                                         |                                                   | Below Deck Mediterranean "The Babysitter's Club" (N)        |                  | Housewives SLC "Chosen Family"                     |               | Below Deck Mediterranean                                   |               | Next Gen NYC                        |                 |
| CMT                 | Mama's                                                                      | Mama's                                            | Reba                                                        | (:35) Reba       | (:10) Reba                                         | (:40) Reba    | (:15) Reba                                                 | (:50) Reba    |                                     | GoldGirls       |
| CNN                 | OutFront                                                                    | (Live)                                            | Cooper 360                                                  | (N)              | The Source With                                    |               | CNN NewsNight                                              |               | Laura                               | (Live)          |
| Comedy Central      | The Office                                                                  | (:35) The Office                                  | The Office                                                  | (:45) The Office | (:20) The Office                                   |               | (:55) The Office                                           |               | The Daily Show (N)                  |                 |
| CSPAN               | (6:00) Public Affairs                                                       |                                                   | C-SPAN Primetime                                            |                  |                                                    |               | C-SPAN Primetime                                           |               |                                     |                 |
| CSPAN2              | (6:00) Public Affairs                                                       |                                                   | Public Affairs Events                                       |                  |                                                    |               | Public Affairs Events                                      |               |                                     |                 |
| Dest. America       | Lakefront                                                                   | Lakefront                                         | Lakefront                                                   | Lakefront        | Lakefront                                          | Lakefront     | Lakefront                                                  | Lakefront     | Lakefront                           | Lakefront       |
| Discovery           | Contraband: Seized                                                          |                                                   | Contraband (N)                                              |                  | Behind Bars (N)                                    |               | Behind Bars                                                |               | Behind Bars                         |                 |
| Discovery Life      | Dr. Pimple Popper                                                           |                                                   | Dr. Pimple Popper                                           |                  | Dr. Pimple Popper                                  |               | Dr. Pimple Popper                                          |               | Dr. Pimple Popper                   |                 |
| E!                  | ★ ★ How to Lose a Guy in 10 Days ('03)                                      |                                                   |                                                             |                  | ★ ★ How to Lose a Guy in 10 Days ('03)             |               |                                                            |               |                                     |                 |
| Encore              | (6:40) ★★ Coach Carter ('05)                                                |                                                   |                                                             |                  | ★ ★ Scream 3 David Arquette.                       |               |                                                            |               | ★ ★ Scary Movie                     |                 |
| Food                | Halloween Baking Championship "The Museum of Unnatural History, Part 1" (N) |                                                   |                                                             |                  | Halloween Baking Championship "Into the Wild" (N)  |               |                                                            |               | Kids Baking Championship            |                 |
| Fox News            | Ingraham                                                                    | (Live)                                            | Jesse (N) (Live)                                            |                  | Hannity                                            | (Live)        | Gutfeld!                                                   |               | Fox News                            | (Live)          |
| Freeform            | (6:30) ★★ Monsters, Inc.                                                    | (:35) ★★ Monsters University ('13) Billy Crystal. |                                                             |                  |                                                    |               |                                                            |               | The 700 Club                        |                 |
| FUSE                | Fatal Addiction: Michael Jackson                                            | Jackson-Truth                                     |                                                             |                  | Cheaters                                           | Cheaters      | Cheaters                                                   | Cheaters      | Cheaters                            | Cheaters        |
| FX                  | (6:00) ★★ Deadpool ('16)                                                    |                                                   | Sunny                                                       | Adults           | ★ ★ Prometheus ('12) Noomi Rapace.                 |               |                                                            |               |                                     |                 |
| FXM                 | (6:25) The French Dispatch                                                  | (:40) ★★ Once Upon a Time...                      |                                                             |                  | In Hollywood ('19) Leonardo DiCaprio.              |               |                                                            |               |                                     |                 |
| Hallmark            | (6:00) Love on the M...                                                     | A Country Wedding ('15) Jesse Metcalfe.           |                                                             |                  | Gold Girls                                         | Gold Girls    | Gold Girls                                                 | Gold Girls    | Gold Girls                          | Gold Girls      |
| Hallmark Myst.      | (6:00) Murder, She ...                                                      | ★ Murder, She Wrote: The Celtic Riddle            |                                                             |                  | Murder, She Wrote                                  |               | Murder, She Wrote                                          |               | Murder, She Wrote                   |                 |
| HGTV                | Love It or List It "Growing Pains"                                          | Love It or List It "Level It Out"                 |                                                             |                  | House Hunters                                      | House Hunters | House Hunters                                              | House Hunters | Roast My Rental                     | Roast My Rental |
| History             | History's Greatest Mysteries                                                | Mysteries "The Hunt for Hitler"                   |                                                             |                  | Mysteries "The Lost Gold of WWII"                  |               | (:05) Mysteries "Foo Fighters"                             |               | (:05) History's Greatest Mysteries  |                 |
| HLN                 | Forensic                                                                    | Forensic                                          | Forensic                                                    | Forensic         | Forensic                                           | Forensic      | Forensic                                                   | Forensic      | Forensic                            | Forensic        |
| HSN                 | Beekman                                                                     |                                                   | Beekman                                                     |                  | The Real Deal                                      |               | The Real (N) (Live)                                        |               | The Real (N) (Live)                 |                 |
| ID                  | Obsession: Dark Desires                                                     | Fatal Vows "Hell on Wheels"                       |                                                             |                  | Married to Evil "The Devil of Denver"              |               | Married to Evil (N)                                        |               | Fear Thy Neighbor "Deadly Turn"     |                 |
| IFC                 | Raymond                                                                     | Raymond                                           | Raymond                                                     | Raymond          | Raymond                                            | Raymond       | Raymond                                                    | Raymond       | Raymond                             | Raymond         |
| Lifetime            | NCIS                                                                        |                                                   | NCIS "Defiance"                                             |                  | NCIS "Kill Screen"                                 |               | (:05) NCIS                                                 |               | (:05) NCIS                          |                 |
| LMN                 | (6:00) Dating Hell                                                          |                                                   | A Widow Seduced ('23) Natalie Brown.                        |                  | Dating App Killer: Monica White Story              |               |                                                            |               |                                     |                 |
| MAGN                | Maine                                                                       |                                                   | Maine                                                       |                  | Maine                                              |               | Maine                                                      |               | Maine                               |                 |
| MSNBC               | The Weeknight                                                               | All in                                            | (Live)                                                      |                  | The Rachel                                         |               | Last Word                                                  | (Live)        | The 11th                            | (Live)          |
| MTV                 | Ridiculous                                                                  | Ridiculous                                        | Ridiculous                                                  | Ridiculous       | Ridiculous                                         | Ridiculous    | Ridiculous                                                 | Ridiculous    | Ridiculous                          | Ridiculous      |
| National Geographic | Construction Fails "Sudden Impact"                                          |                                                   | Construction Fails "Condo Collapse"                         |                  | Fails "Glass Half Shattered" (N)                   |               | Construction Fails (N)                                     |               | Construction Fails "Condo Collapse" |                 |
| NatGeoWild          | Dr. Oakley, Vet                                                             |                                                   | Escape the Amazon                                           |                  | Escape the Amazon                                  |               | Escape the Amazon                                          |               | Primal (N)                          |                 |
| NECN                | Vann                                                                        | News                                              | Dateline                                                    |                  | Dateline                                           |               | Rescue                                                     | OpenHou...    | 1st Look                            | Rescue          |
| NewsNation          | Vargas Report                                                               |                                                   | Cuomo                                                       |                  | On Balance                                         |               | Katie Pavlich                                              |               | Jesse Web                           |                 |
| Ovation             | Murdoch Mysteries                                                           |                                                   | Hope Street                                                 |                  | Murdoch Mysteries                                  |               | Murdoch Mysteries                                          |               | Murdoch Mysteries                   |                 |
| OWN                 | Videos                                                                      |                                                   | Videos                                                      |                  | Videos                                             |               | Videos                                                     |               | Videos                              |                 |
| Oxygen              | Snapped                                                                     |                                                   | Snapped                                                     |                  | Real Murders                                       |               | Snapped                                                    |               | Snapped                             |                 |
| Paramount           | (6:00) Indiana Jones & the Kingdom of the ...                               |                                                   | ★ ★ ★ Raiders of the Lost Ark ('81) Harrison Ford.          |                  | Movie                                              |               |                                                            |               |                                     |                 |
| QVC                 | (6:00) PM Style (N)                                                         |                                                   | Peace Love (N)                                              |                  | ★ ★ (N) (Live)                                     |               | Get un (N) (Live)                                          |               | Nicole                              | (N) (Live)      |
| Science             | Unexplained                                                                 |                                                   | Unexplained                                                 |                  | Unexplained                                        |               | Unexplained                                                |               | Unexplained                         |                 |
| Sundance            | NCIS "Dagger"                                                               |                                                   | NCIS "Road Kill"                                            |                  | NCIS "Silent Night"                                |               | NCIS "Caged"                                               |               | NCIS "Broken Bird"                  |                 |
| SyFy                | ★ ★ Drive Angry 3D ('11) Nicolas Cage.                                      |                                                   | ★ ★ Ghost Rider ('07) Eva Mendes, Nicolas Cage.             |                  |                                                    |               |                                                            |               |                                     | Movie           |
| TBS                 | Big Bang                                                                    | Big Bang                                          | Big Bang                                                    | Big Bang         | Big Bang                                           | Big Bang      | Office                                                     | Office        | Office                              | Office          |
| TCM                 | (6:00) East of Eden                                                         |                                                   | ★ ★ Across the Wide Missouri                                |                  | ★ ★ Mark of the Renegade                           |               | The Saracen Blade                                          |               |                                     |                 |
| TLC                 | Last Resort                                                                 |                                                   | Last Resort "Tell All Part 1" (N)                           |                  |                                                    |               | Last Resort (N)                                            |               | Double Lives                        |                 |
| TNT                 | (6:00) ★★ The Martian ('15)                                                 |                                                   | High Value (N)                                              |                  | High Value Target                                  |               | ★ ★ ★ The Martian                                          |               |                                     |                 |
| Travel              | (6:00) Mysteries                                                            |                                                   | Mysteries of the Unknown                                    |                  |                                                    |               | Mysteries of the Unknown                                   |               |                                     |                 |
| TruTV               | ★ ★ For Love of the Game ('99) Kelly Preston, Kevin Costner.                |                                                   |                                                             |                  | ★ ★ For Love of the Game ('99)                     |               |                                                            |               |                                     |                 |
| TV Land             | Raymond                                                                     | Raymond                                           | Raymond                                                     | Raymond          | Raymond                                            | Raymond       | Raymond                                                    | Raymond       | (:10) King                          | (:50) King      |
| TV One              | CosbySh..                                                                   | CosbySh..                                         | Fatal Attraction                                            |                  | Fatal Attraction (N)                               |               | For My Man                                                 |               | For My Man                          |                 |
| USA                 | Law-SVU "Rapist Anonymous"                                                  |                                                   | Law & Order: SVU "Jersey Breakdown"                         |                  | Law & Order: SVU "Betrayal's Climax"               |               | WNBA Basketball Dallas Wings at Phoenix Mercury (N) (Live) |               |                                     |                 |
| VH-1                | Chris                                                                       | Chris                                             | ★ ★ Guess Who ('05) Ashton Kutcher, Bernie Mac.             |                  | ★ ★ The Photograph ('20)                           |               |                                                            |               |                                     |                 |
| WE                  | Criminal Minds                                                              |                                                   | Criminal Minds                                              |                  | Criminal Minds                                     |               | Criminal Minds                                             |               | Criminal Minds                      |                 |